Breaking All Iterated Inverse-Ackermann Bounds for the Deque Conjecture on Splay Trees

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Abstract

Tarjan's Deque Conjecture (1985) asserts that executing any sequence of m double-ended queue operations (Push, Pop, Inject, Eject) on an n-node splay tree performs $O(m+n)$ rotations. Prior upper bounds progressed from $O\big((m+n)\log(m+n)\big)$ (Sleator and Tarjan, 1985) to $O\big((m+n)\,\alpha(m+n)\big)$ (Sundar, 1992) and $O\big((m+n)\,\alpha^*(m+n)\big)$ (Pettie, 2008), where α is the inverse Ackermann function and $\alpha^*(N)$ is the number of applications of α from N to a constant.

We prove a new upper bound of $O\big((m+n)\,\alpha_\omega(m+n)\big)$, where $\alpha_\omega(N)$ is the number of stars required on the inverse Ackermann function before its value at N falls below a fixed threshold, and $\alpha_\omega(N) = o\big(\alpha^{**\cdots*}(N)\big)$ for any fixed number of stars, breaking Pettie's α^* bound. To our knowledge, this extraordinarily slowly growing function, discussed as a theoretical illustration in (Erickson, 2013), appears for the first time in a bound for a natural algorithmic problem.

We develop a scale-tree method for deriving amortized recurrences by jointly accounting for rotation costs across multiple levels of a hierarchical block decomposition. Our method extends Sundar's classical cascade counting and builds on Pettie's approach to controlling interactions between recursive subproblems.

Our proof is self-contained, holds unconditionally for all $m, n \geq 0$, and is formally verified in Lean 4 together with every intermediate proposition, lemma, and reduction in the paper (github.com/sorrachai/SplayTree-Deque-Ordinal-Inverse-Ackermann-Bound).

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1 Introduction

1.1 Splay Trees and Tarjan's Deque Conjecture

Sleator and Tarjan [ST85] introduced *splay trees*, self-adjusting binary search trees (BSTs) that maintain no balance metadata and restructure solely by moving each accessed key to the root via bottom-up double rotations (*splaying*). They proved that splay trees match the $O(\log n)$ amortized bound of balanced search trees and posed the *Dynamic Optimality Conjecture*, asserting that splay trees are $O(1)$-competitive with every dynamic BST algorithm on every access sequence. The current best known competitiveness for splay trees [CHH+26] is $\tilde{O}(\log \log n)$.

Several landmark special cases of dynamic optimality have been established on splay trees, including the *Sequential Access Theorem* [Tar85, Elm04], the *Dynamic Finger Theorem* [CMSS00, Col00], and splaying preorders and postorders from an empty tree [LT19]. Alongside sequential access, Tarjan [Tar85] posed the *Deque Conjecture*: when a splay tree maintains a double-ended queue supporting insertions and deletions at both ends of the key order, any sequence of m operations starting from an n-node BST performs $O(m+n)$ single rotations. Tarjan [Tar85] and Elmasry [Elm04] proved this $O(m+n)$ bound for *output-restricted* splay deques (where deletions occur at only one end), whereas the general two-sided case has remained open. On other dynamic BST algorithms, Multi-Splay trees [WDS06] (building on Tango trees [DHIP07]) achieve $O(1)$ amortized cost per deque operation starting from an empty tree [DSW09], and geometric forbidden-matrix analyses of Greedy BSTs [DHI+09] (cf. [CGK+15b] for static pattern-avoiding accesses) achieve $O(m+n)$ for output-restricted deques [CGK+15a] and $O((m+n)\,\alpha(m+n))$ for general two-sided deques [CGJ+23].

To state the problem precisely, let T be a rooted BST storing distinct real keys in symmetric (in-order) order, so every key in the left subtree of a vertex u is smaller than u and every key in its right subtree is larger than u. The *left spine* $\mathrm{LS}(T)$ and *right spine* $\mathrm{RS}(T)$ are the paths obtained by starting at the root of T and repeatedly following left-child or right-child pointers, respectively. A *single rotation* $[x, p]$ promotes a child x one step above its parent p while preserving symmetric key order (a *right rotation* when x is the left child of p, i.e., $x < p$, and a *left rotation* when $x > p$). Bottom-up Splay(x) moves a target vertex $x \in V(T)$ to the root two levels at a time by repeatedly applying:

- *zig* (1 single rotation): if x's parent p is the root, rotate $[x, p]$;
- *zig-zig* (2 single rotations): if x and its parent p are both left children (or both right children) of grandparent g, rotate $[p, g]$ first and then $[x, p]$;
- *zig-zag* (2 single rotations): if one of x, p is a left child and the other is a right child of g, rotate $[x, p]$ first and then $[x, g]$.

To use a splay tree T as a double-ended queue supporting insertions and deletions at the minimum (left) and maximum (right) ends of the current key set, the four standard splay-tree deque operations [Tar85, Sun92, Pet08] are:

- Push: insert a new key strictly smaller than $\min V(T)$ directly as the new root, with empty left subtree and the old tree T_{old} as its right subtree (0 rotations).
- Inject: insert a new key strictly larger than $\max V(T)$ directly as the new root, with T_{old} as its left subtree and empty right subtree (0 rotations).
- Pop (when $T \neq \emptyset$): splay the minimum key $x_{\min} = \min V(T)$ to the root (which performs $|\mathrm{LS}(T)| - 1$ single rotations up $\mathrm{LS}(T)$) and delete $x_{\min}$, leaving its right subtree $\mathrm{right}(x_{\min})$.

- EJECT (when $T \neq \emptyset$): splay the maximum key $x_{\max} = \max V(T)$ to the root (which performs $|\mathrm{RS}(T)| - 1$ single rotations up $\mathrm{RS}(T)$) and delete $x_{\max}$, leaving its left subtree $\mathrm{left}(x_{\max})$.

Write $\mathrm{Rot}(T_0, S)$ for the total number of single rotations performed across a valid m-operation sequence S starting from an n-node BST T_0. Over four decades, upper bounds on $\mathrm{Rot}(T_0, S)$ have climbed a sequence of functional inverses of the Ackermann hierarchy:

- **Sleator and Tarjan [ST85] (1985):** $O((m+n)\log(m+n))$ via the access lemma.
- **Sundar [Sun92] (1992):** $O((m+n)\,\alpha(m+n))$, reducing deque sequences via path-halving and cascade simplifications (building on [TvL84, Tar85, Luc90, Luc92]; see also [BST95]) to block decompositions and an inverse-Ackermann analysis of 0-gapped right $(2i)$-cascades.
- **Pettie [Pet08] (2008):** $O((m+n)\,\alpha^*(m+n))$, reducing two-sided deques via spinal path-compression systems to $\{abaabba, abababa\}$-free sequences, bounded via order-5 Davenport–Schinzel sequences [HS86, Sha87, ASS89] (see also [SS05, Niv10, Pet10] for related path-compression, generalized Davenport–Schinzel, and forbidden 0–1 matrix bounds).

1.2 Main Result: Breaking All Finite Star-Iterates

To fix concrete thresholds without base-case ambiguity, we follow Sundar's indexing of the Ackermann hierarchy [Sun92, Section 1.2]. Each function in the hierarchy below inverts or iterates the previous one, producing progressively slower-growing functions of n.

Definition 1.1 (Ackermann Hierarchy, Finite Star-Iterates α_r, and Level-ω Star-Iterate α_ω)**.** We define the fast-growing Ackermann table $A_i(j)$ and its functional inverses in four steps:

(1) *Ackermann table $A_i(j)$.* Each row $A_i : \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 1} \to \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 1}$ $(i \geq 0)$ repeatedly composes the previous row, escalating from doubling to exponentiation, power towers, and beyond: set $A_0(j) := 2j$, $A_1(j) := 2^j$, and for $i \geq 2$,

$$A_i(1) \;:=\; A_{i-1}(2), \qquad A_i(j) \;:=\; A_{i-1}(A_i(j-1)) \quad (j \geq 2).$$

(For example, $A_2(j)$ is a tower of $j+1$ twos, giving $A_1(1) = 2$, $A_2(1) = 4$, $A_3(1) = 16$, and $A_4(1) = A_2(16) > 2^{65536}$.)

(2) *Inverse Ackermann function $\alpha_0(n)$.* For $n \geq 1$, $\alpha_0(n)$ is the first row whose initial entry $A_k(1)$ reaches n (written $\bar{\alpha}(n)$ in Sundar [Sun92]):

$$\alpha_0(n) \;:=\; \min\{k \geq 1 : A_k(1) \geq n\}.$$

(3) *Star operator f^* and finite star-iterates $\alpha_r(n)$.* Given any function $f : \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 1} \to \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 1}$ satisfying $f(n) < n$ for all $n > 4$, its *star-iterate* $f^* : \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 1} \to \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 1}$ counts (1 plus) how many times f must be applied to reduce n to at most 4: $f^*(n) := 1$ for $n \leq 4$, and $f^*(n) := 1 + f^*(f(n))$ for $n > 4$. Applying $(\cdot)^*$ repeatedly starting from α_0 defines the r-th star-iterated inverse Ackermann function $\alpha_r := (\alpha_{r-1})^* : \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 1} \to \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 1}$ for each integer $r \geq 1$:

$$\alpha_r(n) \;:=\; \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } n \leq 4, \\ 1 + \alpha_r(\alpha_{r-1}(n)) & \text{if } n > 4, \end{cases} \tag{1}$$

so $\alpha_1 = \alpha^*$, $\alpha_2 = (\alpha^*)^* = \alpha^{**}$, and $\alpha_3 = ((\alpha^*)^*)^* = \alpha^{***}$.

(4) *Level-ω star-iterate $\alpha_\omega(n)$.* Rather than fixing the number of stars r in advance, $\alpha_\omega(n)$ counts how many stars must be placed on α_0 before the value at n drops to at most 2:

$$\alpha_\omega(n) \;:=\; \min\{r \geq 1 : \alpha_r(n) \leq 2\}.$$

Remark 1.2 (Notation and Why We Write α_ω). Two conventions are worth noting. First, in $\alpha_0, \alpha_1, \alpha_2, \ldots$, the subscript counts how many times the star operator $(\cdot)^*$ is applied to α_0 (so $\alpha_1 = \alpha^*$ and $\alpha_2 = (\alpha^*)^* = \alpha^{**}$), rather than indexing row inverses of the Ackermann table $A_k(\cdot)$ as in the Davenport–Schinzel literature [ASS89, Niv10]. Second, just as $\alpha_0(n)$ diagonalizes across the finite rows $A_1, A_2, \ldots$, the function $\alpha_\omega(n) = \min\{r \geq 1 : \alpha_r(n) \leq 2\}$ diagonalizes across the infinite sequence of star-iterates $\alpha_1, \alpha_2, \ldots$ (this diagonalized star-counting function also appears as an illustrative theoretical construct in Erickson [Eri13, Section 11.7]; in logic's fast-growing hierarchy [LW70a, LW70b], α_0, α_r, and α_ω correspond to levels ω, $\omega + r$, and $\omega \cdot 2$; see Proposition A.2 in Appendix A).

The function $\alpha_\omega(n)$ grows strictly slower than every finite star-iterate $\alpha_r(n)$, and does not depend (up to an additive constant) on whether we invert $A_k(1)$ or the diagonal Ackermann function $A_k(k)$ (proofs of routine Ackermann estimates are deferred to Appendix A):

Proposition 1.3 (Asymptotic Dominance and Convention Invariance)**.** *The function α_ω is non-decreasing with $\alpha_\omega(n) = 1$ for all $1 \leq n \leq A_4(1) = A_2(16) > 2^{65536}$, $\lim_{n\to\infty} \alpha_\omega(n) = \infty$, and for every fixed integer $r \geq 1$,*

$$\alpha_\omega(n) \;<\; \log_2 \alpha_r(n) \quad \textit{for all sufficiently large } n, \qquad \textit{hence} \qquad \alpha_\omega(n) \;=\; o(\alpha_r(n)) \quad (n \to \infty).$$

Moreover, if we instead invert the diagonal Ackermann function via $\widetilde{\alpha}_0(n) := \min\{k \geq 1 : A_k(k) \geq n\}$, define its star-iterates $\widetilde{\alpha}_r$ ($r \geq 1$) by the recursion (1), and diagonalize via $\widetilde{\alpha}_{\omega,\mathrm{diag}}(n) := \min\{r \geq 1 : \widetilde{\alpha}_r(n) \leq r\}$, then $\widetilde{\alpha}_{\omega,\mathrm{diag}}(n) - 1 \leq \alpha_\omega(n) \leq \widetilde{\alpha}_{\omega,\mathrm{diag}}(n) + 2$ for every $n \geq 1$.

Our main theorem breaks Pettie's α^* barrier and every finite star-iterated bound $O((m+n)\,\alpha_r(m+n))$ simultaneously:

Theorem 1.4 (Main Theorem)**.** *There exists an absolute constant $C > 0$ such that for every n-node BST T_0 ($n \geq 0$) and every valid sequence S of $m \geq 0$ splay-tree deque operations (*Push, Pop, Inject, Eject*) containing d_L Pop deletions and d_R Eject deletions ($d := d_L + d_R$),*

$$\begin{aligned} \mathrm{Rot}(T_0, S) \;&\leq\; C\Big(n + m + d_L\,\alpha_\omega\big(\max(d_L, 1)\big) + d_R\,\alpha_\omega\big(\max(d_R, 1)\big)\Big) \\ &=\; O\Big((m+n)\,\alpha_\omega\big(\max(m+n, 1)\big)\Big). \end{aligned}$$

Because Theorem 1.4 is parameterized by the deletion counts d_L, d_R rather than $m + n$ alone, any execution performing $d = O((m+n)/\alpha_\omega(\max(m+n,1)))$ deletions already performs $O(m+n)$ rotations; and because the same universal bound holds for all $m, n \geq 0$ without a separate base-case threshold, $\alpha_\omega\big(\max(m+n,1)\big) = 1$ gives $\mathrm{Rot}(T_0, S) \leq 2C(m+n)$ for all $m + n \leq A_2(16)$.

Formal verification in Lean 4. Theorem 1.4 and every numbered proposition, lemma, and theorem in Sections 1–6 and Appendix A have been formalized and mechanically verified in Lean 4 (`v4.35.0`) [dMU21] on top of `AlgoLib`'s BST and bottom-up splay-tree library [KdFvHY26] (`AlgoLib.DataStructures.SplayTree.Complexity`), using the exact definitions and threshold conventions of Definitions 1.1 and 4.1; the complete repository (including the paper and all Lean 4

source files) is available at https://github.com/sorrachai/SplayTree-Deque-Ordinal-Inverse-Ackermann-Bound. It separates a minimal specification of the main result in ChallengeMain.lean from a full blueprint of all 28 intermediate reductions and helper lemmas in ChallengeHelpers.lean; the proof modules SolutionMain.lean and SolutionHelpers.lean compile without `sorry`, use only Lean's standard classical axioms (`propext`, `Classical.choice`, `Quot.sound`), and pass Lean's external kernel check against both specifications via `lake comparator`.

1.3 Overview of Techniques: Simultaneous Multi-Scale Amortization

Why did previous analyses stop at α_0 and $\alpha_1 = \alpha^*$, and how can a splay-tree analysis reach α_ω without accumulating linear overhead at every intermediate level? The central question governing this progression is *how many nested key scales can be amortized simultaneously within a single linear rotation budget.*

1. Warm-up: sequential single-scale contraction stops at α^*. Consider a one-sided subproblem on P keys $\{1, \dots, P\}$ deleted in order. Partitioning $\{1, \dots, P\}$ into contiguous blocks of size $S_1 = \text{poly}(\alpha_0(P))$ lets an inverse-Ackermann cascade bound absorb all cross-block rotations at $O(P)$ overhead, leaving independent subproblems of size S_1 whose sizes sum to P. Applying this contraction *sequentially* shrinks the active block size along

$$P \longmapsto \text{poly}(\alpha_0(P)) \longmapsto \text{poly}(\alpha_0(\alpha_0(P))) \longmapsto \cdots \longmapsto O(1),$$

requiring $\Theta(\alpha^*(P))$ passes at $O(P)$ boundary overhead per pass, heuristically matching Pettie's $O(P\,\alpha^*(P))$ bound [Pet08] (proved there via Davenport–Schinzel sequences).

2. Warm-up: one flat simultaneous multi-scale pass reaches $(\alpha^*)^*$. To beat α^*, we must amortize across many nested partitions $\mathcal{P}_0 \succ \mathcal{P}_1 \succ \cdots \succ \mathcal{P}_M$ *at the same time.* Every internal rotation $e = (x, y, z)$ $(x < y < z)$ during $\textsc{Pop}(s)$ $(s < x)$ is assigned to the coarsest scale $\ell = \text{sep}(x, y) \in \{1, \dots, M\}$ separating x and y into distinct sub-blocks (or recursed into a leaf subproblem if x, y remain together in $\mathcal{P}_M$). If we give scale ℓ sub-block size

$$S_\ell \;=\; w_\ell \left(\alpha_0(2S_{\ell-1}) + 1\right)^2 \qquad \text{with flat quadratic weights } w_\ell := 4\ell^2,$$

then $\sum_{\ell=1}^{M} w_\ell^{-1} = \sum_{\ell=1}^{M} \frac{1}{4\ell^2} < \frac{\pi^2}{24} < \frac{1}{2}$, so the per-scale cascade costs $O(P/w_\ell)$ sum across *all M scales combined* to $O(P)$. A single pass now shrinks P across $M \approx \alpha^*(P)$ scales down to $S_M = \text{poly}(\alpha^*(P))$ at $O(P)$ total overhead; iterating that meta-pass $\Theta\big((\alpha^*)^*(P)\big)$ times heuristically yields $O\big(P\,(\alpha^*)^*(P)\big) = O\big(P\,\alpha_2(P)\big)$ without Davenport–Schinzel machinery.

3. Weight growth in flat passes, and weight resets via scale trees. Why cannot the flat pass above simply continue to $M \gg \alpha^*(P)$ and reach $S_M = O(1)$ in a single pass? Because $w_\ell = 4\ell^2$ grows monotonically with the global scale index ℓ: once $\ell \approx \alpha^*(P)$ catches up to $S_{\ell-1}$, the target $S_\ell = 4\ell^2\big(\alpha_0(2S_{\ell-1}) + 1\big)^2$ ceases to shrink below $\frac{1}{2}S_{\ell-1}$. Continuing further requires *resetting* the weight counter back to $1, 2, \dots$ while still keeping $\sum_{\ell=1}^{M} w_\ell^{-1} < \frac{1}{2}$.

Our key device is to arrange the scales $\{1, \dots, M\}$ as the leaves (in left-to-right order) of a rooted ordered *scale tree* $\mathcal{T}$ of height r (whose leaves index the *scales* $\{1, \dots, M\}$, not the keys $\{1, \dots, P\}$), multiplying a node's weight by $4c^2$ on the edge to its c-th child:

$$w_\ell \;:=\; \prod_{\delta=1}^{r} 4c_\delta(\ell)^2.$$

Because $\sum_{c\geq 1}\frac{1}{4c^2} < \frac{1}{2}$ at every internal node, induction on height gives $\sum_{\ell=1}^{M} w_\ell^{-1} < \frac{1}{2}$ *for every tree height* r *and arbitrarily many leaves* M. Meanwhile, each depth level resets $c_\delta = 1, 2, \ldots$ on fresh subtrees: depth $r-1$ contracts block size by $\alpha_1 = \alpha^*$, depth $r-2$ contracts by $\alpha_2 = (\alpha^*)^*$, and the root of a height-r tree contracts P by α_r.

4. Preventing the tree height r from entering same-scale rotations. Organizing scales on a height-r tree introduces a sharp combinatorial danger. Every cross-scale rotation $e = (x, y, z)$ during $\textsc{Pop}(s)$ compares the *trigger scale* $\mathrm{sep}(s, x)$ against the *rotation scale* $\ell = \mathrm{sep}(x, y)$:

- *Split-scale rotations ($\mathcal{B}_1 \sqcup \mathcal{B}_2$, with $\mathrm{sep}(s,x) < \ell$ in $\mathcal{B}_1$ and $\mathrm{sep}(s,x) > \ell$ in $\mathcal{B}_2$):* Assigning e to the node $\nu = \mathrm{LCA}_{\mathcal{T}}(\mathrm{sep}(s, x), \ell)$ in $\mathcal{T}$, consecutive cascade pairs $e \to e^+$ during a single $\textsc{Pop}$ either freeze a block at the subtree's finest scale ($O(P)$ times total via $\sum_{\nu\in\mathcal{T}_{\mathrm{int}}} w(\nu)^{-1} < 2$) or move ν *strictly up* $\mathcal{T}$ in $\mathcal{B}_1$ and *strictly down* $\mathcal{T}$ in $\mathcal{B}_2$. Thus chains have length at most r, costing $O(rP)$.
- *Same-scale (three-block) rotations ($\mathcal{B}_3$: $\mathrm{sep}(s,x) = \ell$):* Here $s < x < y$ lie in three distinct child sub-blocks $S_p < S_b < S_q$ of the same parent block $X \in \mathcal{P}_{\ell-1}$. Critically, downward $\mathcal{B}_2$ chains can *terminate into* $\mathcal{B}_3$, yielding a bound of the form $|\mathcal{B}_2| \leq O(P) + r \cdot (|\mathcal{B}_3| + \ldots)$. If $|\mathcal{B}_3|$ carried even a single factor of r (let alone M), $|\mathcal{B}_2|$ would grow as $O(r^2P)$ or worse.

Our central technical theorem proves that $|\mathcal{B}_3| = O(P)$ *independently of* r *and* M. Consequently, an entire height-r scale tree incurs $O(rP)$ overhead uniformly across all M. Setting $r = \alpha_\omega(P)$ shrinks P in one $O(rP)$ pass to subproblems of size at most $2^{C_0^{3r}}$ (for an absolute constant $C_0 \geq 6$); a single height-1 pass ($O(P)$ cost) reduces that doubly exponential size bound to $\mathrm{poly}(r)$ since $\alpha^*(2^{C_0^{3r}}) = O(r)$; and a 6-line bisection lemma ($\leq N \log_2 N$ on size N) finishes in $O(P \log(r+1)) \leq O(rP)$ rotations.

5. Degeneration of the classification on the dyadic partition. In Section 6, we observe how our four-way rotation classification behaves when specialized to the purely combinatorial *dyadic partition* bisecting every non-singleton block across $M = \lceil \log_2 \max(P, 2) \rceil$ levels down to singletons ($|Q| = 1$). Both $\mathcal{B}_{\mathrm{leaf}}$ and $\mathcal{B}_3$ vanish trivially ($|Q| = 1$ precludes intra-leaf pairs, and two child halves cannot host $s < x < y$ in three sibling sub-blocks), leaving $\mathcal{R}_{\mathrm{int}}(\widetilde{H}) = \mathcal{B}_1 \sqcup \mathcal{B}_2$; we also pinpoint why the scale-tree bound of Section 4 does not apply on the dyadic chain once the scale law $S_\ell = w_\ell i_\ell^2$ is dropped.

1.4 Further Related Work

Pattern-avoiding access sequences. Pattern avoidance provides a common framework for studying structured BST access sequences, including sequential access and tree traversals. A permutation avoids a pattern π if no subsequence has the same relative order as π. Chalermsook, Goswami, Kozma, Mehlhorn, and Saranurak [CGK+15b] introduced this framework for BSTs and related the cost of Greedy to extremal bounds for forbidden 0–1 matrices. Their analysis uses the geometric representation of BST executions [DHI+09] to transfer restrictions on the input to restrictions on Greedy's execution. Subsequent matrix-decomposition techniques improved the bounds for traversals, splits, and deque operations [CGJ+23]. For a permutation of length N avoiding a pattern of length k, Chalermsook, Pettie, and Yingchareonthawornchai [CPY24] obtained the Greedy bound $O(N\, 2^{O(k^2)+(1+o(1))\alpha(N)})$. Their nearly tight bounds for the associated forbidden-matrix extremal function also identify a limitation of this approach: a linear bound for Greedy would require additional properties of its executions beyond avoidance of that matrix pattern.

The offline complexity of these inputs is better understood. Recently, Berendsohn, Kozma, and Opler [BKO24] proved that every permutation of length N avoiding a fixed pattern π admits an offline BST execution of cost $O_\pi(N)$. Their construction uses a twin-width decomposition and, more generally, gives cost $O(Nd^2)$ for permutations of twin-width d. Consequently, either Splay or Greedy can be dynamically optimal only if it achieves linear cost on every fixed pattern-avoidance class. This makes pattern avoidance a broad family of tests for the ability of a fixed self-adjusting algorithm to exploit structure in its input.

Dynamic optimality and competitive guarantees. For general access sequences on n keys, Tango trees [DHIP07] and Multi-Splay trees [WDS06] achieve an $O(\log\log n)$ competitive ratio. Recent work has also established sublogarithmic competitive ratios for the two principal candidates for dynamic optimality. Chmel, Haeupler, Hladík, Koucký, Roeyskoe, Rozhoň, Sladký, and Tarjan [CHH+26] proved that splay trees are $O(\log\log n \cdot (\log\log\log n)^2)$-competitive, while Guo, Pettie, Skora, and Wan [GPSW26] proved that Greedy is $2^{O(\sqrt{\log\log n})}$-competitive. The former analysis compares splaying directly with an optimal execution; the latter relates Greedy's costs at different scales and charges them to Wilber's interleave bound.

Lower bounds and offline approximation. Wilber's alternation and funnel bounds [Wil89], together with the independent rectangle bound from the geometric view [DHI+09], provide benchmarks for understanding the offline optimum. Chalermsook, Chuzhoy, and Saranurak [CCS23] and, independently, Lecomte and Weinstein [LW20] showed that the alternation bound can be asymptotically smaller than the optimum even when maximized over all reference trees. Lecomte and Weinstein established a tight $\Theta(\log\log n)$ separation between the alternation and funnel bounds. Jiang, Lecomte, Weinstein, and Yingchareonthawornchai [JLWY24] subsequently proved direct-sum theorems for both bounds and amplified these separations, showing that Tango's guarantee is optimal among algorithms whose costs are charged to the alternation bound. On the algorithmic side, Chalermsook, Chuzhoy, and Saranurak [CCS23] developed a split-decomposition framework and obtained a constant-factor offline approximation in subexponential time.

1.5 Organization of the paper

We structure the proof of Theorem 1.4 as four modular sections in bottom-up dependency order (Sections 2–5; Table 1), each opening with the standalone reduced problem it solves, an illustrated example, and its main theorem (with routine structural checks for Section 2 and the general-D cascade proofs of Section 3 deferred to Appendices B and C), followed by our structural discussion of the dyadic partition in Section 6 and elementary Ackermann estimates in Appendix A. Theorem 1.4 is deduced in 15 lines in Section 5.4 at the end of Section 5 directly from Theorems 2.2, 4.2, and 5.1.

Section	Reduced / Isolated Problem	Prerequisites	Main Theorem
§2	Deque $\to$ folded Pop process $\widetilde{H}$	Splay/BST defs	Thm. 2.2: $+C_{\mathrm{red}}(n+m)$ reduction
§3	Bounded-gap right cascades	Static BSTs, $A_i(1)$	Thm. 3.1: $C^{\Delta}_{2i}{}'(N) \le C_{\mathrm{casc}}(\Delta'+1)N$
§4	Scale-tree contraction pass on $\widetilde{H}$	§2 process, Thm. 3.1	Thm. 4.2: $C_{\mathrm{pass}} rP + \sum_Q J(\widetilde{H}^{(Q)})$
§5	Scale-tree builder & Thm. 1.4	Pure arithmetic, α_r	Thm. 5.1: $2S_M \le 2^{C_0^{3r}}$

Table 1: Modular organization of Sections 2–5. Each section relies only on the exported statements of its prerequisites.

2 Reduction to the Folded Pop Process

2.1 The Folded Pop Process and Reduction Statement

Our first reduction eliminates two-sided splay trees, Inject, Eject, and bottom-up splaying altogether, isolating a one-sided dynamic BST game on $\{1, \dots, P\}$ in which keys are deleted in strict increasing order $1, 2, \dots, P$ and every structural rotation is a *right single rotation*. Throughout, we write $u(A, B)$ for the BST rooted at key u with left subtree A and right subtree B.

Why is the reduced process called *folded*? In an ordinary one-sided BST H, Pop rotates along the left spine $\mathrm{LS}(H)$ while opposite-end side-effects rotate along the right spine $\mathrm{RS}(H)$. Following Pettie's spine-folding view (illustrated in Figure 2), flipping $\mathrm{RS}(H)$ upside-down onto the top of $\mathrm{LS}(H)$ merges both spines into a *single* left spine $\mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H})$, split at a marked vertex $b_1 \in \mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H})$ called the *fold boundary*: the *lower spine* strictly below b_1 is where Push inserts new keys and Pop deletes the minimum key via paired right rotations, while the *upper spine* at and above b_1 absorbs right-spine side-effects through two simple steps (Shift and UpperRot).

Definition 2.1 (Folded Pop Process)**.** Fix an integer $P \geq 1$. A *folded* Pop *process* $\widetilde{H}$ of size P is a dynamic BST execution on key universe $\{1, \dots, P\}$ starting from the empty tree $\widetilde{H} = \emptyset$. At each timestamp τ, the state consists of a BST $\widetilde{H}_\tau$ on the currently active key set $V_\tau \subseteq \{1, \dots, P\}$ together with (whenever $V_\tau \neq \emptyset$) a marked vertex $b_1(\tau) \in \mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H}_\tau)$, called the *fold boundary*, which divides $\mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H}_\tau)$ into the *lower spine* $\{v \in \mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H}_\tau) : v < b_1(\tau)\}$ and the *upper spine* $\{v \in \mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H}_\tau) : v \geq b_1(\tau)\}$.

Across the entire execution, there are P Push steps, P Pop steps (deleting $s = 1, 2, \dots, P$ in increasing order), and some integers $K_{\textsc{Shift}} \geq 0$ of Shift steps and $K_{\mathrm{rot}} \geq 0$ of UpperRot steps satisfying the total upper-spine budget

$$K_L \;:=\; K_{\textsc{Shift}} + K_{\mathrm{rot}} \;<\; 2P,$$

where the four operations act on $(\widetilde{H}, b_1)$ as follows (Figure 1):

(1) Push(w) *(insert a new minimum below the fold boundary;* 0 *rotations):* Inserts a new key $w \in \{1, \dots, P\}$ smaller than all currently active keys ($w < \min V_\tau$ when $V_\tau \neq \emptyset$). If $\widetilde{H} = \emptyset$, set $\widetilde{H} := w(\emptyset, \emptyset)$ and $b_1^{\mathrm{new}} := w$; otherwise let $L_1 := \mathrm{left}_{\widetilde{H}}(b_1^{\mathrm{old}})$, splice w in directly below b_1^{old} by setting $\mathrm{left}_{\widetilde{H}}(b_1^{\mathrm{old}}) := w(\emptyset, L_1)$, and set $b_1^{\mathrm{new}} := w$.

(2) Shift *(advance the fold boundary one step up the left spine;* 0 *rotations):* Applicable whenever $V_\tau \neq \emptyset$ and $b_1 \neq \mathrm{root}(\widetilde{H})$. The BST $\widetilde{H}$ is unchanged, and b_1 moves to its parent on $\mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H})$.

(3) UpperRot *(one right rotation on the upper spine;* 1 *rotation):* Applicable when the upper spine has at least three vertices. Choose a child-parent pair (u, v) on $\mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H})$ at or above b_1 and strictly below the root ($b_1 \leq u < v < \mathrm{root}(\widetilde{H})$, with $u = \mathrm{left}_{\widetilde{H}}(v)$), perform the right single rotation $[u, v]$ on $\widetilde{H}$, and keep b_1 on the same key.

(4) Pop(s) *(delete the minimum key* s *and pair-rotate up the lower spine):* Deletes $s = 1, 2, \dots, P$ in order, with $s = \min V_{s^-}$ at the bottom of $\mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H}_{s^-})$. Let $v_0 < v_1 < \cdots < v_k$ ($k \geq 0$) be the subpath of $\mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H}_{s^-})$ from $v_0 = s$ up to $v_k = b_1(s^-)$, and set $h := \max(0, \lfloor (k-1)/2 \rfloor)$. First splice out s (replacing $s(\emptyset, R)$ by $R := \mathrm{right}_{\widetilde{H}_{s^-}}(s)$):

- if $k = 0$ (so $s = b_1(s^-)$), perform 0 rotations and (when $V_{s^+} \neq \emptyset$) update $b_1(s^+)$ to the parent of $b_1(s^-)$ on $\mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H}_{s^-})$;
- if $k \geq 1$, execute the h vertex-disjoint right single rotations $[v_1, v_2], [v_3, v_4], \dots, [v_{2h-1}, v_{2h}]$ strictly below v_{2h+1} in $\widetilde{H}$, keeping $b_1(s^+) := b_1(s^-)$ when $k = 2h + 1$ is odd (where $v_{2h+1} = b_1(s^-)$) and updating $b_1(s^+) := v_{2h+1}$ when $k = 2h + 2$ is even.

Because PUSH and SHIFT perform 0 rotations and UPPERROT performs $K_{\text{rot}} < 2P$ rotations in total, only the rotations inside POP can be superlinear in P. Each right rotation $e = (x, y, z) = (v_{2j-1}, v_{2j}, v_{2j+1})$ $(1 \le j \le h$, rotating $[x, y]$ strictly below $z)$ in (4) is called an *internal* POP *rotation* (or *cascade rotation*); we write $\mathcal{R}_{\text{int}}(\widetilde{H})$ for the set of all internal POP rotations across the execution and define the process cost $J(\widetilde{H}) := |\mathcal{R}_{\text{int}}(\widetilde{H})|$.

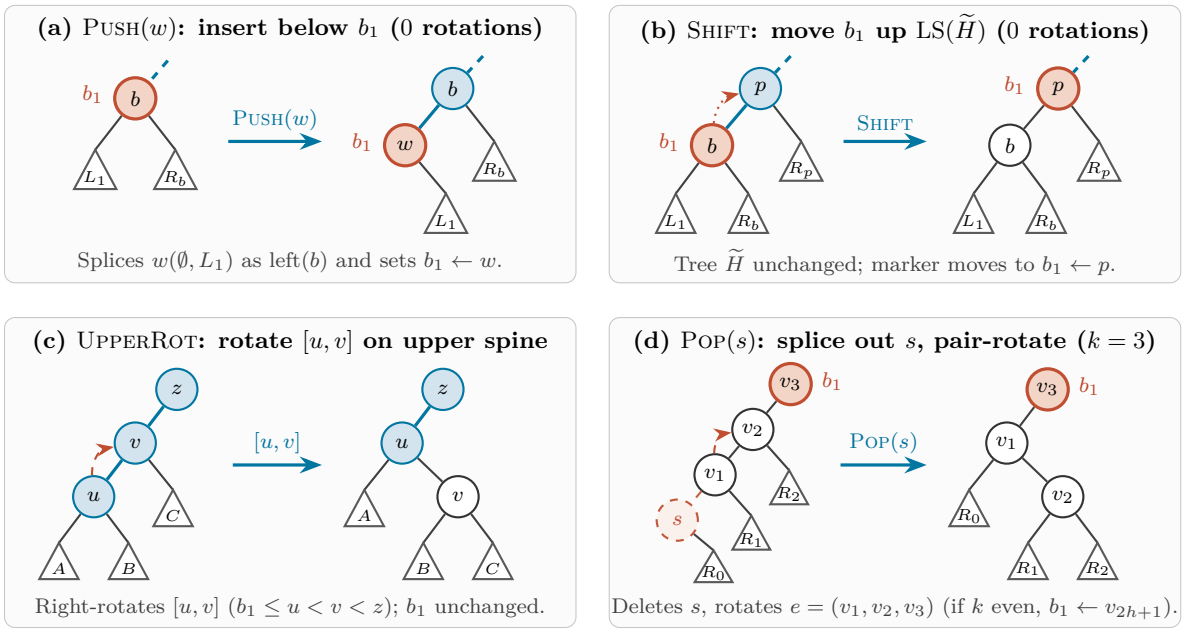


Figure 1: The four operations of a folded POP process $(\widetilde{H}, b_1)$ (Definition 2.1), with upper-spine vertices $(> b_1)$ shaded blue and the fold boundary b_1 shaded red: (a) PUSH(w) splices $w(\emptyset, L_1)$ directly below b_1^{old} and moves b_1 to w; (b) SHIFT leaves $\widetilde{H}$ unchanged and moves b_1 to its parent on $\text{LS}(\widetilde{H})$; (c) UPPERROT performs one right rotation $[u, v]$ on the upper spine $(b_1 \le u < v <$ root$)$ without changing b_1; (d) POP(s) splices out $s = \min V_{s^-}$ and performs $h = \max(0, \lfloor (k-1)/2 \rfloor)$ disjoint right rotations $[v_1, v_2], \ldots, [v_{2h-1}, v_{2h}]$ strictly below v_{2h+1}.

Theorem 2.2 (Reduction to the Folded POP Process)**.** *There exists an absolute constant $C_{\text{red}} > 0$ such that for every n-node BST T_0 $(n \ge 0)$ and every valid m-operation deque sequence S $(m \ge 0)$ with d_L POPs and d_R EJECTs, there exist $\widetilde{H}_L$ and $\widetilde{H}_R$—where $\widetilde{H}_L$ is a folded POP process of size d_L when $d_L \ge 1$ (setting $\widetilde{H}_L := \emptyset$ with $J(\emptyset) := 0$ when $d_L = 0$), and symmetrically for $\widetilde{H}_R$ and d_R—satisfying*

$$\text{Rot}(T_0, S) \;\le\; 2\,J(\widetilde{H}_L) + 2\,J(\widetilde{H}_R) + C_{\text{red}}(n + m).$$

Example (spine folding and folded operations on $P = 7$ keys). Figure 2 illustrates how a one-sided BST H on $\{1, \ldots, 7\}$ with right spine $\text{RS}(H) = (4 < 6 < 7)$ and left subtrees $L_1 = 3(2(1, \emptyset), \emptyset)$, $L_2 = 5(\emptyset, \emptyset)$, and $L_3 = \emptyset$ folds upside-down into $(\widetilde{H}, b_1 = 4)$ with a single left spine $\text{LS}(\widetilde{H}) = (1 < 2 < 3 < 4 < 6 < 7)$:

- PUSH*:* If key 1 were not yet present (so $L_1^{\text{old}} = 3(2, \emptyset)$ under $b_1^{\text{old}} = 4$), executing PUSH(1) would splice $1(\emptyset, 3(2, \emptyset))$ directly below 4 and move the fold boundary to $b_1^{\text{new}} = 1$.
- SHIFT*:* A root left rotation $[6, 4]$ on $\text{RS}(H)$ becomes SHIFT on $(\widetilde{H}, b_1 = 4)$: the BST $\widetilde{H}$ is unchanged and b_1 steps up $\text{LS}(\widetilde{H})$ from 4 to 6.

- UpperRot: A deeper left rotation $[7,6]$ on $\mathrm{RS}(H)$ becomes UpperRot: it performs the upper-spine right rotation $[4,6]$ strictly below 7 on $\widetilde{H}$ while keeping $b_1 = 4$.
- Pop(1): On the pictured $(\widetilde{H}, b_1 = 4)$, Pop(1) sees lower-spine subpath $(v_0, v_1, v_2, v_3) = (1,2,3,4)$ ($k = 3$, $h = 1$), splices out 1, performs the single internal Pop right rotation $e = (2,3,4) \in \mathcal{R}_{\mathrm{int}}(\widetilde{H})$ strictly below $b_1 = 4$, and keeps $b_1 = 4$.

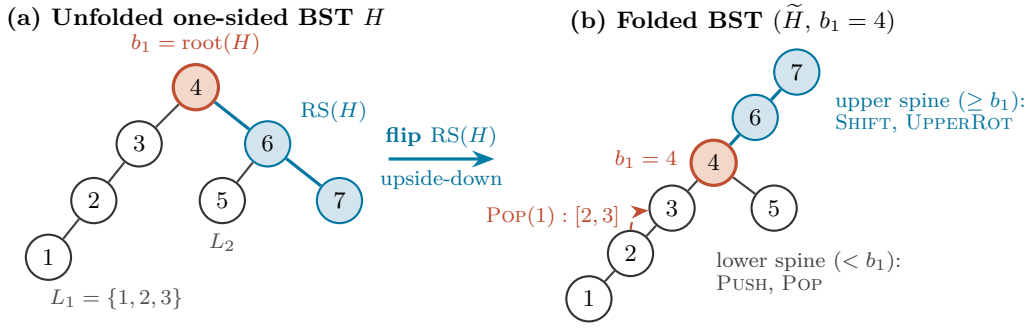


Figure 2: Spine folding on $P = 7$ keys (Section 2.4): flipping the right spine $\mathrm{RS}(H) = (4 < 6 < 7)$ of the unfolded one-sided BST H in (a) upside-down onto the top of $\mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H})$ produces the folded BST $(\widetilde{H}, b_1 = 4)$ in (b), separating $\mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H})$ at $b_1 = 4$ into the upper spine $\{4,6,7\}$ and the lower spine $\{1,2,3\}$.

Proof overview. In a general two-sided execution (T_0, S), Pops and Ejects interact across arbitrary interleavings of Push and Inject. Whereas Sundar [Sun92, Section 3, Theorem 7] and Pettie [Pet08, Section 2] reduce two-sided deques to one-sided half-tree subproblems via size-halving epochs, we observe that because insertions occur only at the global extrema, an *offline nested-interval key assignment* (Lemma 2.5) partitions all at most $n + m$ vertices ever present globally—with *no epochs*—into a *three-way key partition* $V_L < V_M < V_R$: the d_L keys deleted by Pop (in deletion order), the $n + m - 2d$ keys surviving in T_m ($d = d_L + d_R$), and the d_R keys deleted by Eject (in reverse deletion order).

Restricting T_t to V_L, V_M, V_R via LCA-closed projection (Lemma 2.3) gives three induced BSTs (U_t, M_t, W_t). By the path-halving and cascade equivalence of Pop and Eject (Lemma 2.4; cf. [TvL84, Luc90, Luc92], [Sun92, Section 3, Lemma 10], and [Pet08, Section 2, Observation 2.1]), each Pop splices out $\min V(T)$ and performs vertex-disjoint paired right rotations $[v_1, v_2], [v_3, v_4], \ldots$ up $\mathrm{LS}(T)$. Tracking the joint spine potential $|\mathrm{LS}(M_t)| + |\mathrm{RS}(M_t)| + |\mathrm{RS}(U_t)| + |\mathrm{LS}(W_t)|$ (Lemma 2.6) pays $O(n + m)$ for all rotations touching V_M, straddling partition boundaries, or rotating $\mathrm{LS}(W_t)$ during Pops, while bounding Eject-induced left rotations on $\mathrm{RS}(U_t)$ to $\max(0, 2d_L - 2)$. Prepending reverse-spine initialization and a right-spine tail of future Injects (Lemma 2.7) and applying Pettie's spine-folding bijection [Pet08, Section 2, Observation 2.1 and Figure 2] in Section 2.4 then proves Theorem 2.2 and establishes three structural laws of $\widetilde{H}$ (Lemma 2.8) used in Section 4 (routine verifications of Lemmas 2.3, 2.4, and 2.7 and the operation-by-operation check of the spine-folding bijection are deferred to Appendix B).

2.2 BST Interval Projections and Cascade Equivalence

For any rooted BST T with distinct real keys in symmetric order (in-order), we write $V(T)$ for its vertex (key) set, T_v for the subtree rooted at $v \in V(T)$, and $u(A, B)$ for the BST rooted at

u with left subtree $A = \mathrm{left}_T(u)$ and right subtree $B = \mathrm{right}_T(u)$. Recall that $\mathrm{LS}(T)$ and $\mathrm{RS}(T)$ denote the left and right spines of T (visited from $\mathrm{root}(T)$ by following left or right child pointers, respectively, with $\mathrm{LS}(\emptyset) = \mathrm{RS}(\emptyset) = \emptyset$). Following Sundar [Sun92, Section 1.2], define the *left depth* $\mathrm{ld}_T(v)$ of $v \in V(T)$ to be the number of left-child edges on the root-to-v path in T (so $\mathrm{ld}_T(v) = 0$ if and only if $v \in \mathrm{RS}(T)$). Under any right single rotation $[u, v]$ replacing $v(u(A, M), R)$ with $u(A, v(M, R))$, $\mathrm{ld}(w)$ decreases by 1 for every $w \in \{u\} \cup V(A)$ and remains unchanged for every $w \in \{v\} \cup V(M) \cup V(R) \cup (V(T) \setminus V(T_v))$; moreover, $|\mathrm{LS}(T)|$ decreases by 1 if $v \in \mathrm{LS}(T)$ (removing v from $\mathrm{LS}(T)$ while keeping u and $\mathrm{LS}(A)$) and by 0 otherwise. Symmetrically, any left single rotation $[v, u]$ decreases $|\mathrm{RS}(T)|$ by 1 if $u \in \mathrm{RS}(T)$ and by 0 otherwise.

To track how a subset of keys $\mathcal{S} \subseteq \mathbb{R}$ evolves inside a larger dynamic BST T—both for contiguous key intervals (as in [Tar85] and [Sun92, Section 2.1]) and for non-contiguous summary subsets in Section 3—we restrict T to $V(T) \cap \mathcal{S}$ whenever $\mathcal{S}$ has no branching conflicts in T. Write $\mathrm{LCA}_T(x, y)$ for the lowest common ancestor of $x, y \in V(T)$ in T. We say $\mathcal{S} \subseteq \mathbb{R}$ is LCA-*closed* in T if for every pair of vertices $x, y \in V(T) \cap \mathcal{S}$, their lowest common ancestor $\mathrm{LCA}_T(x, y)$ also belongs to $\mathcal{S}$ (for instance, every contiguous interval $I \subseteq \mathbb{R}$ is LCA-closed in every BST T, since $x \le \mathrm{LCA}_T(x, y) \le y$ whenever $x \le y$). When $\mathcal{S}$ is LCA-closed in T, any vertex $u \in V(T) \setminus \mathcal{S}$ can have elements of $\mathcal{S}$ in at most one of its two child subtrees (otherwise $a \in V(\mathrm{left}_T(u)) \cap \mathcal{S}$ and $b \in V(\mathrm{right}_T(u)) \cap \mathcal{S}$ would force $\mathrm{LCA}_T(a, b) = u \notin \mathcal{S}$). Contracting away every vertex outside $\mathcal{S}$ therefore defines a unique *induced BST* $T|_{\mathcal{S}}$ on $V(T) \cap \mathcal{S}$ via $\emptyset|_{\mathcal{S}} := \emptyset$ and

$$u(A, B)\big|_{\mathcal{S}} := \begin{cases} u(A|_{\mathcal{S}},\, B|_{\mathcal{S}}) & \text{if } u \in \mathcal{S}, \\ A|_{\mathcal{S}} & \text{if } u \notin \mathcal{S} \text{ and } V(B) \cap \mathcal{S} = \emptyset, \\ B|_{\mathcal{S}} & \text{if } u \notin \mathcal{S} \text{ and } V(B) \cap \mathcal{S} \neq \emptyset. \end{cases}$$

By structural induction, $T|_{\mathcal{S}}$ is a valid BST with $V(T|_{\mathcal{S}}) = V(T) \cap \mathcal{S}$ that preserves exact ancestor-descendant and left/right-subtree relations on $V(T) \cap \mathcal{S}$.

Lemma 2.3 (BST Projection Under Rotations and Extremum Splicing)**.** *Let T be a BST and let $\mathcal{S} \subseteq \mathbb{R}$ be* LCA-*closed in T.*

(1) Suppose T' is obtained from T by a single rotation $[x, y]$ and $\mathcal{S}$ is also LCA-*closed in T'. If $x, y \in \mathcal{S}$, then $T'|_{\mathcal{S}}$ is obtained from $T|_{\mathcal{S}}$ by the single rotation $[x, y]$; if $\{x, y\} \not\subseteq \mathcal{S}$, then $T'|_{\mathcal{S}} = T|_{\mathcal{S}}$.*

(2) Suppose $T \neq \emptyset$, and let T' be obtained from T by splicing out $x_{\min} := \min V(T)$ (replacing $x_{\min}(\emptyset, R)$ with R) or $x_{\max} := \max V(T)$ (replacing $x_{\max}(L, \emptyset)$ with L). Then $\mathcal{S}$ remains LCA-*closed in T'; if the spliced-out extremum lies in $\mathcal{S}$, it is the corresponding extremum of $T|_{\mathcal{S}}$ and $T'|_{\mathcal{S}}$ is obtained by splicing it out of $T|_{\mathcal{S}}$, whereas otherwise $T'|_{\mathcal{S}} = T|_{\mathcal{S}}$.*

The four-case verification of Lemma 2.3 is deferred to Appendix B. Next, we record the standard equivalence between bottom-up extremum splaying and vertex-disjoint paired single rotations along the spine, adapting the path-halving and cascade simplifications of [TvL84], [Sun92, Section 2 and Section 3, Lemma 10], [Luc92], and [Pet08, Section 2, Observation 2.1] directly to arbitrary two-sided BSTs.

Lemma 2.4 (Cascade Equivalence of Pop and Eject)**.** *Let T be a non-empty BST with left spine $\mathrm{LS}(T) = (v_0 < v_1 < \cdots < v_k)$ from $v_0 = \min V(T)$ to $v_k = \mathrm{root}(T)$ ($k \ge 0$), and set $r := \lfloor k/2 \rfloor$. Executing* Pop *on T performs $k \in \{2r, 2r+1\}$ single rotations and produces the exact same BST as first splicing out v_0 (replacing $v_0(\emptyset, R_0)$ with $R_0 := \mathrm{right}_T(v_0)$) and then performing the r vertex-disjoint right single rotations $[v_1, v_2], [v_3, v_4], \ldots, [v_{2r-1}, v_{2r}]$. Symmetrically,*

if $\mathrm{RS}(T) = (u_k < \cdots < u_1 < u_0)$ *with* $u_0 = \max V(T)$ *and* $r := \lfloor k/2 \rfloor$*, executing* Eject *on* T *performs* $k \in \{2r, 2r+1\}$ *single rotations and produces the exact same BST as splicing out* u_0 *and performing the* r *vertex-disjoint left single rotations* $[u_1, u_2], [u_3, u_4], \ldots, [u_{2r-1}, u_{2r}]$.

The inductive check of Lemma 2.4 is given in Appendix B.

2.3 Three-Way Key Partition via Offline Nested-Interval Assignment

Fix an n-node initial BST T_0 ($n \geq 0$) and a valid sequence $S = (\mathrm{op}_1, \ldots, \mathrm{op}_m)$ of $m \geq 0$ deque operations producing intermediate trees $T_0, T_1, \ldots, T_m$, with d_L Pop deletions, d_R Eject deletions, $d := d_L + d_R$, and $m - d$ insertions (Push and Inject). Because deque operations depend only on the relative symmetric order of active keys, we may choose any real keys for the initial vertices and inserted vertices consistent with symmetric order at insertion time. Unlike the size-halving epoch reductions of Sundar [Sun92, Section 3, Theorem 7] and Pettie [Pet08, Section 2], the following offline key assignment separates all $n + m - d$ vertices ever present globally into a single static three-way partition without epochs.

Lemma 2.5 (Offline Nested-Interval Three-Way Key Assignment)**.** *Let* $\mathcal{V}$ *be the set of all* $n+m-d \leq n+m$ *vertices ever present across* (T_0, S)*. There exists a static key assignment* $\kappa : \mathcal{V} \to \mathbb{R}$ *(with real thresholds* $L_m < R_m$*) under which every* T_t *(*$0 \leq t \leq m$*) is a valid BST and* $\kappa(\mathcal{V}) = V_L \sqcup V_M \sqcup V_R$ *partitions into:*

- $V_L \subseteq (-\infty, L_m]$ *(*$|V_L| = d_L$*), the keys deleted by* Pop*, ordered in exact chronological* Pop *deletion order;*
- $V_M := \kappa(V(T_m)) \subset (L_m, R_m)$ *(*$|V_M| = n + m - 2d$*), the keys surviving in* T_m*;*
- $V_R \subseteq [R_m, +\infty)$ *(*$|V_R| = d_R$*), the keys deleted by* Eject*, ordered in exact reverse chronological* Eject *deletion order;*

so that $x < y < z$ *for all* $x \in V_L$*,* $y \in V_M$*, and* $z \in V_R$.

Proof. Assign the n vertices of T_0 the keys $1, 2, \ldots, n$ in symmetric order, and maintain open bounds (L_t, R_t) initialized to $(L_0, R_0) := (0, n+1)$ so that $L_t < R_t$ and $\kappa(V(T_t)) \subset (L_t, R_t)$ for every $0 \leq t \leq m$:

- If $\mathrm{op}_t =$ Push, keep $(L_t, R_t) := (L_{t-1}, R_{t-1})$ and assign the new key $\frac{1}{2}(L_{t-1} + \min \kappa(V(T_{t-1})))$ when $T_{t-1} \neq \emptyset$, or $\frac{1}{2}(L_{t-1} + R_{t-1})$ when $T_{t-1} = \emptyset$.
- If $\mathrm{op}_t =$ Inject, keep $(L_t, R_t) := (L_{t-1}, R_{t-1})$ and assign the new key $\frac{1}{2}(\max \kappa(V(T_{t-1})) + R_{t-1})$ when $T_{t-1} \neq \emptyset$, or $\frac{1}{2}(L_{t-1} + R_{t-1})$ when $T_{t-1} = \emptyset$.
- If $\mathrm{op}_t =$ Pop deleting $x = \min \kappa(V(T_{t-1}))$, set $(L_t, R_t) := (x, R_{t-1})$.
- If $\mathrm{op}_t =$ Eject deleting $z = \max \kappa(V(T_{t-1}))$, set $(L_t, R_t) := (L_{t-1}, z)$.

On Pop, $L_{t-1} < x < R_{t-1}$ and every $u \in \kappa(V(T_t)) = \kappa(V(T_{t-1})) \setminus \{x\}$ satisfies $x < u < R_{t-1}$, preserving $L_t < R_t$ and $\kappa(V(T_t)) \subset (L_t, R_t)$; Eject is symmetric. Hence $0 = L_0 \leq L_1 \leq \cdots \leq L_m < R_m \leq \cdots \leq R_0 = n + 1$. The d_L keys deleted by Pop are the strictly increasing sequence of step-ups $L_{t-1} < L_t = x \leq L_m$, the $n + (m - d) - d = n + m - 2d$ surviving keys of T_m lie in (L_m, R_m), and the d_R keys deleted by Eject are the strictly decreasing sequence of step-downs $R_m \leq z = R_t < R_{t-1}$. □

Identify $\mathcal{V}$ with $\kappa(\mathcal{V})$ via Lemma 2.5, set $I_L := (-\infty, L_m]$, $I_M := (L_m, R_m)$, and $I_R := [R_m, +\infty)$, and consider the three interval-projected BSTs $U_t := T_t|_{I_L}$, $M_t := T_t|_{I_M}$, and $W_t := T_t|_{I_R}$ ($0 \le t \le m$), which satisfy $V(U_t) = V(T_t) \cap V_L$, $V(M_t) = V(T_t) \cap V_M$, and $V(W_t) = V(T_t) \cap V_R$ (with $U_m = W_m = \emptyset$). In the cascade decomposition of Lemma 2.4, let $C_{\textsc{Pop}}(U)$ denote the total number of cascade right rotations $[v_{2j-1}, v_{2j}] \in V_L \times V_L$ across all Pop steps, and let $C_{\textsc{Eject}}(W)$ denote the total number of cascade left rotations $[u_{2j-1}, u_{2j}] \in V_R \times V_R$ across all Eject steps.

Lemma 2.6 (Uncoupled Spine Potential Accounting)**.** *Across* (T_0, S)*:*

(1) $\mathrm{Rot}(T_0, S) \le 2\, C_{\textsc{Pop}}(U) + 2\, C_{\textsc{Eject}}(W) + 9(n+m)$.

(2) Eject *steps induce at most* $\max(0, 2d_L - 2)$ *left single rotations on* U_t *(each along* $\mathrm{RS}(U_t)$*), and* Pop *steps induce at most* $\max(0, 2d_R - 2)$ *right single rotations on* W_t *(each along* $\mathrm{LS}(W_t)$*).*

Proof. Define the uncoupled spine potential

$$\Psi(t) \;:=\; |\mathrm{LS}(M_t)| + |\mathrm{RS}(M_t)| + |\mathrm{RS}(U_t)| + |\mathrm{LS}(W_t)| \;\ge\; 0 \qquad (0 \le t \le m).$$

At $t = 0$, $\Psi(0) \le 2|V(M_0)| + |V(U_0)| + |V(W_0)| \le 2n$. At each of the $m - d$ insertion steps (Push(w) or Inject(w)), T_t attaches w as the new root with one empty subtree and T_{t-1} as the other subtree, so by Lemma 2.3 (or directly from the recursive definition of $\cdot|_S$) the two projections not containing w are unchanged while the projection containing w acquires w as its new root with at least one empty child subtree: if $w \in V_M$, $|\mathrm{LS}(M_t)| + |\mathrm{RS}(M_t)|$ increases by at most 2 (+2 when $M_{t-1} = \emptyset$, at most +1 when $M_{t-1} \neq \emptyset$); if $w \in V_L$, $|\mathrm{RS}(U_t)|$ changes by +1 on Push ($U_t = w(\emptyset, U_{t-1})$) and by $1 - |\mathrm{RS}(U_{t-1})| \le +1$ on Inject ($U_t = w(U_{t-1}, \emptyset)$); and symmetrically $\Delta|\mathrm{LS}(W_t)| \le +1$ if $w \in V_R$. Hence every insertion satisfies $\Delta\Psi(t) := \Psi(t) - \Psi(t-1) \le 2$, contributing $\sum_{t\ \mathrm{ins}} \Delta\Psi(t) \le 2(m-d)$ in total.

Now consider any Pop step t. Since $\min V(T_{t-1}) \in V_L$ and $I_L = (-\infty, L_m]$ is downward-closed, $\mathrm{LS}(U_{t-1}) = \mathrm{LS}(T_{t-1}) \cap V_L = (v_0 < \cdots < v_p)$ ($p \ge 0$) is a non-empty bottom prefix of $\mathrm{LS}(T_{t-1}) = (v_0 < \cdots < v_k)$ ($k \ge p$). By Lemma 2.4, step t performs $k \le 1 + 2r_t$ single rotations ($r_t := \lfloor k/2 \rfloor$) and transforms T_{t-1} into T_t by splicing out v_0 and executing $[v_1, v_2], [v_3, v_4], \ldots, [v_{2r_t-1}, v_{2r_t}]$. Decompose these r_t pairs into $\lfloor p/2 \rfloor$ internal $V_L \times V_L$ pairs, c_t boundary-straddling pairs (endpoints in different parts of $V_L < V_M < V_R$), m_t internal $V_M \times V_M$ pairs, and $\mathrm{opp}_t(W)$ internal $V_R \times V_R$ pairs:

- *Straddling pairs:* Along $v_1 < v_2 < \cdots < v_{2r_t}$, at most one pair crosses L_m and at most one pair crosses R_m, so $c_t \le 2$.

- *Induced update on U_t:* By Lemma 2.3, $U_{t-1} \to U_t$ splices out $v_0 = \min V(U_{t-1})$ and executes the $\lfloor p/2 \rfloor$ internal $V_L \times V_L$ right rotations $[v_1, v_2], \ldots, [v_{2\lfloor p/2 \rfloor - 1}, v_{2\lfloor p/2 \rfloor}]$ (a standalone Pop cascade on U_{t-1}). If $p = 0$ (which in particular holds on the d_L-th Pop, when $|V(U_{t-1})| = 1$), splicing out $v_0 = \mathrm{root}(U_{t-1})$ removes v_0 from $\mathrm{RS}(U)$ with 0 rotations, giving $\Delta|\mathrm{RS}(U_t)| = -1$. If $p \ge 1$, splicing out $v_0 < v_p = \mathrm{root}(U_{t-1})$ leaves $\mathrm{RS}(U)$ unchanged, and among the $\lfloor p/2 \rfloor$ vertex-disjoint right rotations on $\mathrm{LS}(U_{t-1})$ at most one touches $\mathrm{root}(U_{t-1})$ (adding at most one vertex to $\mathrm{RS}(U)$), so $\Delta|\mathrm{RS}(U_t)| \le +1$ in all cases.

- *Induced updates on M_t and W_t:* Every $y \in \mathrm{LS}(T_{t-1}) \cap V_M$ has all proper ancestors in T_{t-1} strictly greater than y, so any ancestor of y in M_{t-1} contains y in its left subtree; thus $\mathrm{LS}(T_{t-1}) \cap V_M \subseteq \mathrm{LS}(M_{t-1})$, and likewise $\mathrm{LS}(T_{t-1}) \cap V_R \subseteq \mathrm{LS}(W_{t-1})$. By Lemma 2.3, each of the m_t vertex-disjoint pairs in $V_M \times V_M$ rotates right on $\mathrm{LS}(M_{t-1})$, decreasing $|\mathrm{LS}(M)|$ by 1 and increasing $|\mathrm{RS}(M)|$ by 1 only if its upper endpoint is $\mathrm{root}(M_{t-1})$ (at most one pair), giving $m_t + \Delta(|\mathrm{LS}(M_t)| + |\mathrm{RS}(M_t)|) \le 1$. Similarly, the $\mathrm{opp}_t(W)$ pairs in $V_R \times V_R$ rotate right along $\mathrm{LS}(W_{t-1})$, giving $\mathrm{opp}_t(W) + \Delta|\mathrm{LS}(W_t)| = 0$.

Combining these four estimates gives $(c_t + m_t + \mathrm{opp}_t(W)) + \Delta\Psi(t) \le 2+1+1+0 = 4$ on every Pop step t, and mirror symmetry gives $(c_t + m_t + \mathrm{opp}_t(U)) + \Delta\Psi(t) \le 4$ on every Eject step t (where $\mathrm{opp}_t(U)$ counts $V_L \times V_L$ left single rotations along $\mathrm{RS}(U_{t-1})$, with $\mathrm{opp}_t(U) + \Delta|\mathrm{RS}(U_t)| = 0$).

Telescoping $\Psi(m) - \Psi(0) \ge -\Psi(0) \ge -2n$ across all m operations yields

$$\sum_{t \text{ del}} (c_t + m_t + \mathrm{opp}_t) \;\le\; 4d + \Psi(0) + \sum_{t \text{ ins}} \Delta\Psi(t) \;\le\; 4d + 2n + 2(m-d) \;=\; 2n + 2m + 2d.$$

Since $\mathrm{Rot}(T_0, S) \le d + 2\big(C_{\textsc{Pop}}(U) + C_{\textsc{Eject}}(W) + \sum_{t \text{ del}}(c_t + m_t + \mathrm{opp}_t)\big)$ and $d \le m \le n+m$, we obtain $\mathrm{Rot}(T_0, S) \le 2\,C_{\textsc{Pop}}(U) + 2\,C_{\textsc{Eject}}(W) + 4n + 4m + 5d \le 2\,C_{\textsc{Pop}}(U) + 2\,C_{\textsc{Eject}}(W) + 9(n+m)$, proving (1). Finally, tracking $|\mathrm{RS}(U_t)|$ alone shows that when $d_L = 0$ we have $U_t = \emptyset$ and $\mathrm{opp}_t(U) = 0$, whereas when $d_L \ge 1$, $|\mathrm{RS}(U_0)| + \sum_{t \text{ ins}} \Delta|\mathrm{RS}(U_t)| \le |V(U_0)| + (d_L - |V(U_0)|) = d_L$, at most $d_L - 1$ Pops satisfy $\Delta|\mathrm{RS}(U_t)| \le +1$, the d_L-th Pop satisfies $\Delta|\mathrm{RS}(U_t)| = -1$, and $|\mathrm{RS}(U_m)| = 0$, so $\sum_{t \text{ Eject}} \mathrm{opp}_t(U) \le d_L + (d_L - 1) - 1 = 2d_L - 2$; mirror symmetry bounds $\sum_{t \text{ Pop}} \mathrm{opp}_t(W) \le \max(0, 2d_R - 2)$, proving (2). □

2.4 Emptying Simulation, Spine Folding, and Structural Laws of $\widetilde{H}$

Before folding the right spine upside-down, we package the left-end subproblem U_t into a clean unfolded one-sided model that starts and ends at the empty tree. A *one-sided* Pop *execution* H of size $P \ge 1$ starting from $\emptyset$ on $\{1, \dots, P\}$ is a dynamic BST sequence that begins at $H = \emptyset$, ends at $H = \emptyset$, and consists of:

(i) P Push(w) steps ($w \in \{1, \dots, P\}$, with $w < \min V(H)$ when $H \ne \emptyset$), each attaching w at the root via $H \leftarrow w(\emptyset, H)$;

(ii) P Pop steps deleting $s = 1, \dots, P$ in increasing order via the cascade rule of Lemma 2.4 (splicing out $s = \min V(H)$ and executing $\lfloor k/2 \rfloor$ vertex-disjoint right single rotations $[v_1, v_2], \dots$ along $\mathrm{LS}(H) = (v_0 < \cdots < v_k)$); and

(iii) $K_L \ge 0$ right-spine left single rotations $[b_{d+1}, b_d]$ along $\mathrm{RS}(H) = (b_1 < \cdots < b_\beta)$ $(1 \le d \le \beta - 1)$.

Write $C_{\textsc{Pop}}(H)$ for the total number of cascade right rotations across the P Pop steps. Notice in three lines that $K_L < 2P$ holds automatically: $|\mathrm{RS}(H)|$ starts at 0 and ends at 0; each of the P Pushes changes $|\mathrm{RS}(H)|$ by $+1$, each of the first $P-1$ Pops changes $|\mathrm{RS}(H)|$ by at most $+1$, the P-th Pop acts on $|V(H)| = 1$ ($|\mathrm{LS}(H)| = 1$) and changes $|\mathrm{RS}(H)|$ by -1, and each right-spine left rotation $[b_{d+1}, b_d]$ decreases $|\mathrm{RS}(H)|$ by 1, forcing

$$K_L \;\le\; P + (P-1) - 1 \;=\; 2P - 2 \;<\; 2P. \tag{2}$$

For any two BSTs A, B with $\max V(A) < \min V(B)$ whenever both are non-empty, write $A \oplus_R B$ for the BST obtained by attaching B in place of the rightmost external leaf of A (with $\emptyset \oplus_R B := B$ and $A \oplus_R \emptyset := A$).

Lemma 2.7 (Emptying One-Sided Simulation via Reverse-Spine Initialization and Right-Spine Tail)**.**

(1) Any n_0-node BST H_{init} can be constructed from $\emptyset$ using n_0 Push *steps, $n_0 - |\mathrm{RS}(H_{\text{init}})|$ root right-spine left rotations $[b_2, b_1]$, and 0* Pop *steps.*

(2) Whenever $d_L \ge 1$ in (T_0, S), relabeling V_L in chronological Pop *deletion order to $\{1, \dots, P\}$ ($P := d_L$) yields a one-sided* Pop *execution H_L of size P starting from $\emptyset$ with $C_{\textsc{Pop}}(U) = C_{\textsc{Pop}}(H_L)$ and $K_L \le 2P - 2 < 2P$.*

The proof of Lemma 2.7 is deferred to Appendix B.

Spine-folding bijection. Following Pettie [Pet08, Section 2, Observation 2.1 and Figure 2] (building on Sundar [Sun92, Section 3, Lemma 10] and Lucas [Luc90, Luc92]), we map any one-sided Pop execution H of size $P \geq 1$ starting from $\emptyset$ onto a *folded* Pop *process* $\widetilde{H}$ of size P (Definition 2.1). At any timestamp τ, if $H_\tau = \emptyset$ set $\widetilde{H}_\tau := \emptyset$; if $H_\tau \neq \emptyset$ with right spine $\mathrm{RS}(H_\tau) = (b_1 < b_2 < \cdots < b_\beta)$ ($\beta \geq 1$) and left subtrees $L_i := \mathrm{left}_{H_\tau}(b_i)$ ($1 \leq i \leq \beta$), define $\widetilde{H}_\tau$ and its fold boundary $b_1(\tau) := b_1 \in \mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H}_\tau)$ by placing $b_\beta, b_{\beta-1}, \ldots, b_1$ down the top of $\mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H}_\tau)$ with $\mathrm{root}(\widetilde{H}_\tau) := b_\beta$, $\mathrm{right}_{\widetilde{H}_\tau}(b_\beta) := \emptyset$, $\mathrm{left}_{\widetilde{H}_\tau}(b_{i+1}) := b_i$ and $\mathrm{right}_{\widetilde{H}_\tau}(b_i) := L_{i+1}$ for $1 \leq i < \beta$, and $\mathrm{left}_{\widetilde{H}_\tau}(b_1) := L_1$. Because $V(L_1) < b_1 < V(L_2) < b_2 < \cdots < V(L_\beta) < b_\beta$ in H_τ, $\widetilde{H}_\tau$ is a valid BST on $V_\tau := V(H_\tau)$ uniquely recovering H_τ from $(\widetilde{H}_\tau, b_1(\tau))$. As verified across the four step types of H (Push, root right-spine left rotation $\mapsto$ Shift, deeper right-spine left rotation $\mapsto$ UpperRot, and Pop) in Appendix B, $\widetilde{H}$ is a valid folded Pop process of size P satisfying

$$C_{\mathrm{Pop}}(H) \;\leq\; P + J(\widetilde{H}). \tag{3}$$

Proof of Theorem 2.2. By Lemma 2.6(1), $\mathrm{Rot}(T_0, S) \leq 2\,C_{\mathrm{Pop}}(U) + 2\,C_{\mathrm{Eject}}(W) + 9(n+m)$. If $d_L \geq 1$, Lemma 2.7(2) and (3) produce a folded Pop process $\widetilde{H}_L$ of size d_L with $C_{\mathrm{Pop}}(U) = C_{\mathrm{Pop}}(H_L) \leq d_L + J(\widetilde{H}_L)$, whereas if $d_L = 0$ then $C_{\mathrm{Pop}}(U) = 0 = d_L + J(\emptyset)$. Applying the same construction to the order-reversed mirror execution ($x \mapsto -x$, exchanging Push $\leftrightarrow$ Inject, Pop $\leftrightarrow$ Eject, and left/right children) yields $\widetilde{H}_R$ of size d_R (or $\emptyset$ when $d_R = 0$) with $C_{\mathrm{Eject}}(W) \leq d_R + J(\widetilde{H}_R)$. Since $d_L + d_R = d \leq m \leq n + m$, we conclude

$$\mathrm{Rot}(T_0, S) \;\leq\; 2(d_L + J(\widetilde{H}_L)) + 2(d_R + J(\widetilde{H}_R)) + 9(n+m) \;\leq\; 2\,J(\widetilde{H}_L) + 2\,J(\widetilde{H}_R) + 11(n+m),$$

proving Theorem 2.2 with $C_{\mathrm{red}} := 11$. □

We close Section 2 by recording three structural laws of any folded Pop process $\widetilde{H}$ of size $P \geq 1$ (Definition 2.1). To track how keys move upward across right rotations via a single monotone parent pointer, associate to $\widetilde{H}_\tau$ its standard *first-child/right-sibling general ordered tree* L''_τ on $V_\tau \cup \{\top\}$ rooted at a sentinel super-root $\top := P + 1$ (Knuth [Knu97, Section 2.3.2]): x is the first child of $y \in V_\tau$ if and only if $x = \mathrm{left}_{\widetilde{H}_\tau}(y)$ (with $\mathrm{root}(\widetilde{H}_\tau)$ the first child of $\top$ when $V_\tau \neq \emptyset$), and w is the immediate right sibling of x if and only if $w = \mathrm{right}_{\widetilde{H}_\tau}(x)$, so the children of $y \in V_\tau$ in left-to-right order are precisely the right spine $\mathrm{RS}(\mathrm{left}_{\widetilde{H}_\tau}(y))$. Write $\pi_\tau : V_\tau \to V_\tau \cup \{\top\}$ for the parent map of L''_τ. Directly on the BST $\widetilde{H}_\tau$, observe by induction on Definition 2.1 that whenever $V_\tau \neq \emptyset$, $\mathrm{right}_{\widetilde{H}_\tau}(\mathrm{root}(\widetilde{H}_\tau)) = \emptyset$ (every UpperRot and internal Pop rotation occurs strictly below $\mathrm{root}(\widetilde{H}_\tau)$), so $\mathrm{root}(\widetilde{H}_\tau)$ is the unique child of $\top$, and for every $v \in V_\tau$, $\pi_\tau(v)$ is simply the lowest ancestor a of v in $\widetilde{H}_\tau$ whose left subtree contains v (or $\top$ when $v = \mathrm{root}(\widetilde{H}_\tau)$).

Lemma 2.8 (Structural Laws of $(\widetilde{H}, L'')$)**.** *Let $\widetilde{H}$ be any folded* Pop *process of size $P \geq 1$ (Definition 2.1), with general tree L''_τ and parent map $\pi_\tau : V_\tau \to V_\tau \cup \{\top\}$ ($\top := P + 1$).*

(1) (Postorder and parent monotonicity) *At every timestamp τ,* $\mathrm{postorder}(L''_\tau)$ *on V_τ coincides with* $\text{in-order}(\widetilde{H}_\tau)$*, i.e., increasing key order, so $v < \pi_\tau(v)$ for all $v \in V_\tau$. Every right single rotation $[x, y]$ strictly below $z = \pi_{\tau^-}(y)$ (either an* UpperRot *step or an internal* Pop *rotation) updates $\pi(x) : y \mapsto z$ and leaves $\pi(w)$ unchanged for all $w \in V_\tau \setminus \{x\}$; consequently, throughout the lifetime of each $v \in \{1, \ldots, P\}$, $\pi_\tau(v)$ is non-decreasing and the set of ancestors of v in L''_τ shrinks monotonically.*

(2) (Spine interval partition and (x, z) interval-freezing) *Whenever $V_\tau \neq \emptyset$ with $\mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H}_\tau) = (u_1 < \cdots < u_q)$ and $u_{q+1} := P + 1$, we have $\{u_i\} \cup V(\mathrm{right}_{\widetilde{H}_\tau}(u_i)) = V_\tau \cap [u_i, u_{i+1} - 1]$ for all*

$1 \le i \le q$. *Moreover, after any internal* Pop *rotation* $e = (x, y, z) \in \mathcal{R}_{\text{int}}(\widetilde{H})$ *during* $\textsc{Pop}(s)$ *($s < x < y < z$), zero keys strictly greater than x are inserted and $(x, z) \cap \text{LS}(\widetilde{H}_\tau) = \emptyset$ throughout $[s^+, x^-]$ (so no vertex of (x, z) lies on $\text{LS}(\widetilde{H})$ during any* UpperRot *or* $\textsc{Pop}(s')$ *up to and including* $\textsc{Pop}(x)$*).*

(3) (Backward adjacent-pair injectivity) *Let $\mathcal{M}_{\text{base}} \subseteq \mathcal{R}_{\text{int}}(\widetilde{H})$ comprise all internal* Pop *rotations $e = (x, y, z)$ that are either (i) the chronologically first internal* Pop *rotation with promoted key x, (ii) preceded (since x's previous internal* Pop *rotation) by an* UpperRot *step $[x, v]$ promoting x, or (iii) preceded by an internal* Pop *rotation of x that was the topmost ($j = h$) internal rotation of its* Pop *step. Then $|\mathcal{M}_{\text{base}}| \le 2P + K_{\text{rot}} < 4P$, and for every $e = (x, y, z) \in \mathcal{R}_{\text{int}}(\widetilde{H}) \setminus \mathcal{M}_{\text{base}}$ occurring at $\textsc{Pop}(s)$, x's immediately preceding internal* Pop *rotation e_L (at some $\textsc{Pop}(t_L)$ with $t_L < s$) and its immediate upper cascade neighbor $e_R := e_L^+$ in $\textsc{Pop}(t_L)$ satisfy*

$$e_L \;=\; (x, w_1, y) \qquad \textit{and} \qquad e_R \;=\; (y, w_2, z') \qquad \textit{with} \qquad t_L < x < w_1 < y < w_2 < z',$$

and both maps $e \mapsto e_L$ and $e \mapsto e_R$ are globally injective on $\mathcal{R}_{\text{int}}(\widetilde{H}) \setminus \mathcal{M}_{\text{base}}$.

Proof. (1) The identity $\text{postorder}(L''_\tau) = \text{in-order}(\widetilde{H}_\tau)$ is the standard binary-to-general tree traversal equivalence [Knu97, Section 2.3.2], which immediately implies $v < \pi_\tau(v)$. Under any right single rotation $[x, y]$ below $z = \pi_{\tau^-}(y)$, replacing $\text{left}_{\widetilde{H}}(z) = y(x(A, B), C)$ with $x(A, y(B, C))$ changes $\text{RS}(\text{left}_{\widetilde{H}}(z))$ from $\{y\} \cup \text{RS}(C)$ to $\{x, y\} \cup \text{RS}(C)$, changes $\text{RS}(\text{left}_{\widetilde{H}}(y))$ from $\{x\} \cup \text{RS}(B)$ to $\text{RS}(B)$, and leaves $\text{RS}(\text{left}_{\widetilde{H}}(x)) = \text{RS}(A)$ and all other left-child right spines unchanged; hence π changes only at x, from y to $z > y$, bypassing y on the L''-ancestor path of $\{x\} \cup V(A)$ and preserving all other L''-ancestor paths. Meanwhile $\textsc{Push}(w)$ adds a new leaf w to L'', Shift leaves $\widetilde{H}$ unchanged, and splicing out $s = \min V_{s^-}$ at $\textsc{Pop}(s)$ deletes the leaf s ($\text{left}_{\widetilde{H}_{s^-}}(s) = \emptyset$) while replacing $\{s\} \cup \text{RS}(\text{right}_{\widetilde{H}_{s^-}}(s))$ by $\text{RS}(\text{right}_{\widetilde{H}_{s^-}}(s))$ under $\pi_{s^-}(s)$, leaving $\pi(w)$ unchanged for all surviving w.

(2) Since $\text{right}_{\widetilde{H}_\tau}(u_q) = \emptyset$, in-order of $\widetilde{H}_\tau$ decomposes V_τ into the disjoint sets $\{u_i\} \cup V(\text{right}_{\widetilde{H}_\tau}(u_i))$ ($1 \le i \le q$) separated by $u_1 < \cdots < u_q < u_{q+1}$, giving $\{u_i\} \cup V(\text{right}_{\widetilde{H}_\tau}(u_i)) = V_\tau \cap [u_i, u_{i+1} - 1]$. After $e = (x, y, z)$ at $\textsc{Pop}(s)$ ($s < x$), $x \in V_\tau$ holds throughout $[s^+, x^-]$, so every $\textsc{Push}(w)$ up to $\textsc{Pop}(x)$ satisfies $w < \min V_\tau \le x$. At s^+, $x = \text{left}_{\widetilde{H}_{s^+}}(z)$ makes x and z consecutive on $\text{LS}(\widetilde{H}_{s^+})$, so $V_{s^+} \cap (x, z) \subseteq V(\text{right}_{\widetilde{H}_{s^+}}(x))$. Throughout $(s^+, x^-]$, $\textsc{Push}(w)$ ($w < x$), Shift, and splicing out $s' < x$ leave $V(\text{right}_{\widetilde{H}}(x))$ unchanged, while any right single rotation $[a, b]$ sets $\text{right}_{\text{new}}(a) = b(\text{right}_{\text{old}}(a), C) \supseteq \text{right}_{\text{old}}(a)$ and $\text{right}_{\text{new}}(b) = C = \text{right}_{\text{old}}(b)$; hence $V_\tau \cap (x, z) \subseteq V(\text{right}_{\widetilde{H}_\tau}(x))$ is disjoint from $\text{LS}(\widetilde{H}_\tau)$ for every $\tau \in [s^+, x^-]$.

(3) Conditions (i), (ii), and (iii) contribute at most P, K_{rot}, and P rotations respectively (each UpperRot step $[x, v]$ or topmost internal rotation of x can immediately precede at most one next internal Pop rotation of x), so $|\mathcal{M}_{\text{base}}| \le 2P + K_{\text{rot}} \le 2P + K_L < 4P$. For $e = (x, y, z) \in \mathcal{R}_{\text{int}}(\widetilde{H}) \setminus \mathcal{M}_{\text{base}}$ at $\textsc{Pop}(s)$, condition (i) fails so x had an immediately preceding internal Pop rotation $e_L = (v'_{2i-1}, v'_{2i}, v'_{2i+1}) = (x, w_1, u_L)$ at some $\textsc{Pop}(t_L)$ ($t_L < s$), and condition (iii) fails so $i < h'$, giving $e_R = e_L^+ = (v'_{2i+1}, v'_{2i+2}, v'_{2i+3}) = (u_L, w_2, z') \in \mathcal{R}_{\text{int}}(\widetilde{H})$. At $\textsc{Pop}(t_L)$, rotating $[x, w_1]$ makes x the left child of u_L, and rotating $[u_L, w_2]$ keeps $\text{left}_{\widetilde{H}_{t_L^+}}(u_L) = x$, so $\pi_{t_L^+}(x) = u_L$. Because condition (ii) fails, x promotes in no right rotation during (t_L^+, s^-), so Part (1) gives $y = \pi_{s^-}(x) = \pi_{t_L^+}(x) = u_L$. Finally, $e = (x, y, z)$ determines x and hence its immediately preceding win e_L injectively, and $e_L \mapsto e_L^+ = e_R$ is injective within each $\textsc{Pop}(t_L)$, making both $e \mapsto e_L$ and $e \mapsto e_R$ globally injective. □

3 Bounded-Gap Cascades Under Right Rotations

3.1 The Static-BST Cascade Problem and Main Bound

Before analyzing multi-scale partitions of a folded Pop process in Section 4, we isolate a static-BST extremal question: if an N-node BST evolves *only by right single rotations*, how many times can k nearly consecutive pairs along a single left-child path rotate simultaneously? Formally, consider an N-node BST B on $\{1,\dots,N\}$ undergoing only right single rotations (advancing in the *right-rotation order*[1]). For integers $k \ge 1$ and $\Delta' \ge 0$, a *Δ'-gapped right k-cascade* on B is a batch of k simultaneous (vertex-disjoint) right single rotations $[x_1,y_1],\dots,[x_k,y_k]$ ($x_1 < y_1 < \cdots < x_k < y_k$, with $x_r = \mathrm{left}_B(y_r)$) along a single left-child subpath of B such that at most Δ' unrotated gap vertices lie strictly between y_r and x_{r+1} along that subpath for each $1 \le r < k$ (so $\Delta' = 0$ requires adjacent disjoint pairs, while $\Delta' > 0$ permits bounded gaps). Let $C_k^{\Delta'}(N)$ denote the maximum number of Δ'-gapped right k-cascades in any right-rotation sequence on an N-node BST.

Theorem 3.1 (Bounded-Gap Right-Cascade Bound)**.** *There exists an absolute constant $C_{\mathrm{casc}} > 0$ such that for all integers $i \ge 1$, $\Delta' \ge 0$, and $1 \le N \le A_i(1)$,*

$$C_{2i}^{\Delta'}(N) \;\le\; C_{\mathrm{casc}}(\Delta'+1)\,N.$$

Example (reducing an inter-block 1-gapped 4-cascade via preorder-3 summary). Suppose $N = 20$ is partitioned into $K = 5$ contiguous blocks $C_q = \{4q-3,\dots,4q\}$ ($1 \le q \le 5$), and $\Delta' = 1$, so $D := \Delta'+2 = 3$. In Figure 3(a), the left-child subpath $19 \to 16 \to 14 \to 12 \to 11 \to 9 \to 8 \to 6 \to 3$ hosts the 1-gapped right 4-cascade $[3,6],[8,9],[12,14],[16,19]$ in which every pair crosses a block boundary and a single gap vertex $11 \in C_3$ separates $y_2 = 9$ from $x_3 = 12$. Inside $B|_{C_3}$ on $C_3 = \{9,10,11,12\}$, vertex $12 = \mathrm{root}(B|_{C_3})$ has preorder rank 1, gap vertex 11 has rank 2, and $y_2 = 9$ has rank $3 \le D$, whereas $10 = \mathrm{right}_B(9)$ has rank $4 > D$ and is omitted from the summary set $\mathcal{G}(B)$ (retaining the first $D = 3$ preorder vertices per block, $|\mathcal{G}(B)| = 15$). Dropping the two outer pairs $[3,6]$ and $[16,19]$ projects the inner pairs $[8,9],[12,14]$ directly onto a 1-gapped right 2-cascade on $G(B) := B|_{\mathcal{G}(B)}$ in Figure 3(b).

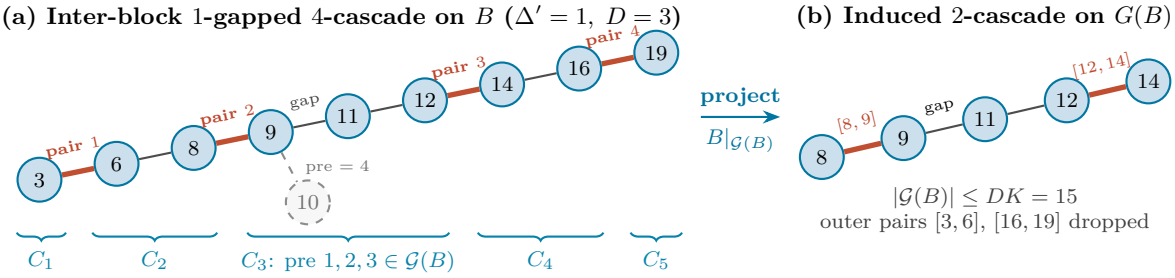


Figure 3: Reducing $(2i)$-cascades to $(2i-2)$-cascades on the preorder-D summary BST ($D = \Delta'+2$): (a) in an inter-block 1-gapped 4-cascade ($i = 2$), every inner endpoint $x_r = \mathrm{root}(B|_{C_{a_r}})$ and y_r ($\mathrm{pre}_{B|_{C_{b_r}}}(y_r) \le \Delta'+2 = 3$) belongs to $\mathcal{G}(B)$, while deeper vertices such as 10 (pre $= 4$) lie outside $\mathcal{G}(B)$; (b) the inner pairs $[8,9],[12,14]$ execute a 1-gapped 2-cascade on $G(B) = B|_{\mathcal{G}(B)}$.

[1] Right-rotation reachability on N-node binary trees is the classical Tamari partial order [Tam62, FT67, HT72, Pal86, BW97, Knu11] (cf. [STT88] for undirected rotation distance); we refer to it simply as the right-rotation order since no lattice operations are needed.

Proof overview. Sundar [Sun92, Theorem 3] bounded 0-gapped right $(2i)$-cascades ($\Delta' = 0$), but naively pigeonholing a Δ'-gapped $(2i)$-cascade into 0-gapped cascades loses an exponential $(\Delta'+1)^{2i}$ factor. To obtain linear dependence on $\Delta'+1$, we combine Sundar's $(2i)$-cascade block recursion [Sun92, Section 2.1] with his preorder-D global-tree summary [Sun92, Section 4.2, Theorem 8] at $D = \Delta'+2$, streamlined via the Tamari right-reach characterization (Proposition 3.2): because right-rotation reachability is characterized pointwise by the right-reach $R_T(v) := \max V(T_v)$, every right rotation on B advances the LCA-closed preorder-D summary BST $G(B) := B|_{\mathcal{G}(B)}$ via right rotations (Lemma 3.3, whose $D = 1$ pure-block-root case is proved inline below since Section 4 uses only $D = 1$). Boundary-straddling cascades with an intra-block edge decrease a truncated left-depth potential $\min(\mathrm{ld}_{B|_C}(v), D)$ (Lemma 3.4), while purely inter-block $(2i)$-cascades project onto $(2i-2)$-cascades on DK vertices, proving Theorem 3.1 (the general-D proof of Lemma 3.3 and the complete proofs of Lemma 3.4 and Theorem 3.1 are deferred to Appendix C).

3.2 Right-Reach Characterization and Preorder-D Summary Trees

To test whether one BST can reach another using only right rotations, we track how far to the right each vertex's subtree extends. For any BST T on an ordered finite key set and any vertex $v \in V(T)$, write T_v for the subtree of T rooted at v and define its *right-reach* $R_T(v) := \max V(T_v)$ to be the largest key in v's subtree (any two n-node BSTs on possibly different ordered key sets are compared by identifying each key set with $\{1,\dots,n\}$ via in-order rank). Every right rotation $[u,v]$ strictly expands $R(u)$ while leaving $R(x)$ unchanged for all $x \neq u$, and the converse holds as well:

Proposition 3.2 (Tamari Right-Reach Characterization)**.** *For any integer $n \geq 1$ and any two BSTs T_1, T_2 on $\{1,\dots,n\}$, T_2 is reachable from T_1 by a (possibly empty) sequence of right single rotations if and only if $R_{T_1}(v) \leq R_{T_2}(v)$ for every $v \in \{1,\dots,n\}$.*

Proof. Any right single rotation $[u,v]$ ($u = \mathrm{left}_T(v)$) replaces $v(u(A,M),R)$ by $u(A,v(M,R))$, strictly increasing $R(u)$ from $\max V(u(A,M)) < v$ to $R_T(v) \geq v$ while leaving $V(T'_x)$ and $R(x)$ unchanged for all $x \neq u$; hence reachability implies $R_{T_1} \leq R_{T_2}$ pointwise.

Conversely, suppose $R_{T_1}(v) \leq R_{T_2}(v)$ for all $v \in \{1,\dots,n\}$. Because $V(\mathrm{right}_T(x)) = \{x+1,\dots,R_T(x)\}$ determines the root of any induced interval $[i,j]$ as the smallest $r \in [i,j]$ with $R_T(r) = j$, $R_{T_1} = R_{T_2}$ implies $T_1 = T_2$. If $T_1 \neq T_2$, pick u with $R_{T_1}(u) < R_{T_2}(u)$ and set $v := R_{T_1}(u)+1 \leq R_{T_2}(u) \leq n$. Since $V(T_{1,u})$ is a contiguous interval ending at $v-1$ that cannot contain a proper ancestor of u, we have $\mathrm{LCA}_{T_1}(u,v) = v$, so $u \in V(\mathrm{left}_{T_1}(v))$ and $a := \mathrm{left}_{T_1}(v)$ satisfies $R_{T_1}(a) = v-1 = R_{T_1}(u)$ and hence $a \leq u \leq v-1 = R_{T_1}(a)$ (as $u < a$ would force $R_{T_1}(u) < a$). In T_2, $u \in [a, R_{T_2}(a)] \subseteq V(T_{2,a})$ gives $R_{T_2}(u) \leq R_{T_2}(a)$ and $v \in [u, R_{T_2}(u)] \subseteq V(T_{2,u})$ gives $R_{T_2}(v) \leq R_{T_2}(u)$, so $R_{T_1}(v) \leq R_{T_2}(v) \leq R_{T_2}(u) \leq R_{T_2}(a)$. Right-rotating $[a,v]$ on T_1 sets $R_{T'_1}(a) = R_{T_1}(v) \in [v, R_{T_2}(a)]$, preserving $R \leq R_{T_2}$ pointwise while strictly decreasing $\sum_{x=1}^{n}(R_{T_2}(x) - R(x)) \geq 0$; induction completes the proof. □

On $\{1,\dots,n\}$, in-order ordering gives $V(\mathrm{right}_T(v)) = \{v+1,\dots,R_T(v)\}$ (empty when $R_T(v) = v$), so $R_T(v) = v + |V(\mathrm{right}_T(v))|$ for all $v \in \{1,\dots,n\}$. Pointwise comparison $R_{T_1}(v) \leq R_{T_2}(v)$ is therefore identical to componentwise comparison of the right-subtree size (bracket) vector characterizing the Tamari right-rotation order [Tam62, FT67] (specifically [HT72, Pal86], [BW97, Section 9], and [Knu11, Section 7.2.1.6], up to left–right reversal in [Pal86]).

Next, when $\{1,\dots,N\}$ is partitioned into K contiguous key blocks $C_1 < \cdots < C_K$, we compress B into a smaller *preorder-D summary BST* $G(B)$ of size at most DK by keeping only the top D vertices of each block's induced subtree $B|_{C_q}$ in preorder: for any non-empty BST T and $w \in V(T)$, write $\mathrm{pre}_T(w) \in \{1,\dots,|V(T)|\}$ for the 1-indexed preorder rank of w in T (visiting

root(T), then left$_T$(root(T)), then right$_T$(root(T)))). Using Proposition 3.2 and Lemma 2.3, we generalize Sundar's global-tree construction [Sun92, Section 4.2, Theorem 8] uniformly to all blocks $C_1, \dots, C_K$ (including C_1) and arbitrary $D \geq 1$.

Lemma 3.3 (Preorder-D Summary BST Simulation)**.** *Let B be an N-node BST on $\{1, \dots, N\}$ partitioned into contiguous key blocks $C_1 < C_2 < \cdots < C_K$, and fix an integer $D \geq 1$. Let $\mathcal{G}(B) := \bigcup_{q=1}^{K} \{w \in C_q : \mathrm{pre}_{B|_{C_q}}(w) \leq D\}$ consist, within each block C_q, of the first $\min(D, |C_q|)$ vertices of $B|_{C_q}$ in preorder.*

(1) $\mathcal{G}(B)$ is LCA*-closed in B, so $G(B) := B|_{\mathcal{G}(B)}$ is a well-defined BST of static size $|\mathcal{G}(B)| = \sum_{q=1}^{K} \min(D, |C_q|) \leq DK$.*

(2) Let B' be obtained from B by any right single rotation $[u, v]$. Identifying $\mathcal{G}(B)$ and $\mathcal{G}(B')$ with $\{1, \dots, |\mathcal{G}(B)|\}$ by in-order rank, $G(B')$ is reachable from $G(B)$ via zero or more right single rotations. Moreover, if u and v lie in different blocks, then $\mathcal{G}(B') = \mathcal{G}(B)$, and $G(B')$ is obtained from $G(B)$ by the right single rotation $[u, v]$ when $u, v \in \mathcal{G}(B)$ and satisfies $G(B') = G(B)$ when $\{u, v\} \not\subseteq \mathcal{G}(B)$.

Because Section 4 invokes Lemma 3.3 solely in the pure-block-root case $D = 1$ (Lemma 4.9), we verify $D = 1$ here in a few lines and defer the general $D \geq 1$ proof (needed only inside the proof of Theorem 3.1) to Appendix C.

Proof of the $D = 1$ case (full proof for all $D \geq 1$ in Appendix C). At $D = 1$, $\mathcal{G}(B) = \{\mathrm{root}(B|_{C_q}) : 1 \leq q \leq K,\ C_q \neq \emptyset\}$ has $|\mathcal{G}(B)| = \sum_{q=1}^{K} \min(1, |C_q|) \leq K$. For (1), given $g_1 < g_2$ in $\mathcal{G}(B)$ ($g_1 \in C_{q_1}, g_2 \in C_{q_2}$ with $q_1 < q_2$), let $w := \mathrm{LCA}_B(g_1, g_2) \in C_{q^*}$ ($q_1 \leq q^* \leq q_2$): if $q_1 < q^* < q_2$, then $g_1 < \min C_{q^*} \leq w \leq \max C_{q^*} < g_2$ with $g_1, g_2 \in V(B_w)$ prevents w from having any proper ancestor in C_{q^*}, forcing $w = \mathrm{root}(B|_{C_{q^*}}) \in \mathcal{G}(B)$; if $q^* \in \{q_1, q_2\}$, then g_1 or g_2 lies in $V(B_w) \cap C_{q^*}$ and is already root$(B|_{C_{q^*}})$, forcing $w \in \{g_1, g_2\} \subseteq \mathcal{G}(B)$.

For (2), if $u \in C_{q_1}$ and $v \in C_{q_2}$ with $q_1 < q_2$, Lemma 2.3(1) gives $B'|_{C_q} = B|_{C_q}$ for every q, so $\mathcal{G}(B') = \mathcal{G}(B)$ and applying Lemma 2.3(1) with $\mathcal{S} = \mathcal{G}(B)$ gives the inter-block claim (0 or 1 right rotation on $G(B)$). If $u, v \in C_q$ ($u = \mathrm{left}_B(v)$, replacing $B_v = v(u(\widehat{A}, \widehat{M}), \widehat{R})$ with $B'_u = u(\widehat{A}, v(\widehat{M}, \widehat{R}))$), then $B'|_{C_{q'}} = B|_{C_{q'}}$ for $q' \neq q$ and $V(\widehat{M}) \subset (u, v) \subseteq C_q$: if $v \neq \mathrm{root}(B|_{C_q})$, then $\mathrm{root}(B'|_{C_q}) = \mathrm{root}(B|_{C_q})$ so $\mathcal{G}(B') = \mathcal{G}(B)$ with $\{u, v\} \cap \mathcal{G}(B) = \emptyset$ and Lemma 2.3(1) gives $G(B') = G(B)$; if $v = \mathrm{root}(B|_{C_q})$, then $u = \mathrm{root}(B'|_{C_q})$ gives $\mathcal{G}(B') = (\mathcal{G}(B) \setminus \{v\}) \cup \{u\}$, and $B_v|_{\mathcal{G}(B)} = v(\widehat{A}|_{\mathcal{G}(B)}, \widehat{R}|_{\mathcal{G}(B)})$ and $B'_u|_{\mathcal{G}(B')} = u(\widehat{A}|_{\mathcal{G}(B')}, \widehat{R}|_{\mathcal{G}(B')})$ agree at the identical in-order rank on $\{1, \dots, |\mathcal{G}(B)|\}$, so $G(B') = G(B)$. □

3.3 Left-Depth Potentials and Recursive Block Contraction for $(2i)$-Cascades

Recall from Section 3.1 that for $k \geq 1$ and $\Delta' \geq 0$, a *Δ'-gapped right k-cascade* on a BST B is a batch of k simultaneous (vertex-disjoint) right single rotations $[x_1, y_1], \dots, [x_k, y_k]$ ($x_1 < y_1 < \cdots < x_k < y_k$) along a single left-child subpath $y_k \to \cdots \to x_1$ of B ($x_r = \mathrm{left}_B(y_r)$ for each $1 \leq r \leq k$, with at most Δ' vertices strictly between y_r and x_{r+1} along that subpath for each $1 \leq r < k$), and $C_k^{\Delta'}(N)$ denotes the maximum number of Δ'-gapped right k-cascades across any right-rotation sequence on an N-node BST. Note first that along any left-child subpath $y_k \to \cdots \to x_1$ of B, each step down moves from a vertex w to $\mathrm{left}_B(w) < w$, so the vertices on the subpath have keys strictly decreasing from y_k down to x_1 (all lying in $[x_1, y_k]$).

Lemma 3.4 (Untruncated and Truncated Left-Depth Potentials)**.**

(1) For any BST T, $\Phi_{\mathrm{ld}}(T) := \sum_{v \in V(T)} \mathrm{ld}_T(v) \in \big[0, \binom{|V(T)|}{2}\big]$ decreases by at least 1 under every right single rotation on T ($\Delta\Phi_{\mathrm{ld}}(T) \le -1$), so any batch of k simultaneous right single rotations on T satisfies $\Delta\Phi_{\mathrm{ld}}(T) \le -k$.

(2) Fix $D := \Delta' + 2 \ge 2$ and contiguous key blocks $C_1 < \cdots < C_K$ partitioning $\{1, \dots, N\}$. For each block $C = C_q$, define

$$\Psi_C(B) \;:=\; |\mathrm{LS}(B|_C)| + \sum_{v \in C} \min\big(\mathrm{ld}_{B|_C}(v),\, D\big) \;\in\; \big[0,\, (D+1)|C|\big].$$

Then $\Psi_C(B)$ is non-increasing under every right single rotation on B, and every Δ'-gapped right k-cascade ($k \ge 2$) on B with $x_1 \in C_{q_{\min}}$, $y_k \in C_{q_{\max}}$ ($q_{\min} < q_{\max}$), and at least one intra-block edge $[x_r, y_r] \subseteq C_q$ decreases $\sum_{q=1}^{K} \Psi_{C_q}(B)$ by at least 1.

With Lemmas 3.3 and 3.4 in hand at $D = \Delta' + 2$, the proof of Theorem 3.1 in Appendix C bounds $C_2^{\Delta'}(N)$ for general $N \ge 1$ by iterated bisection against Φ_{ld} and Ψ_C, defines pure-integer block thresholds $M_i^{(D)}(j) = D\,\mu_i(j) \ge 12D\,A_i(j)$ ($i \ge 2, j \ge 1$), proves $C_{2i}^{\Delta'}\big(M_i^{(D)}(j)\big) \le 3(D{+}1)\,j\,M_i^{(D)}(j)$ by two-parameter induction on (i, j) (recursing intra-block cascades at $(i, j-1)$, discharging mixed boundary-straddling cascades via Ψ_C, and projecting purely inter-block $(2i)$-cascades onto $(2i-2)$-cascades on $G(B)$ of size DK), and chains $\lfloor M_i^{(D)}(1)/N \rfloor$ copies of an N-node BST along a right spine for $1 \le N \le A_i(1)$ to obtain $C_{2i}^{\Delta'}(N) \le 18(\Delta'+1)\,N$ ($C_{\mathrm{casc}} := 18$).

4 Scale-Tree Self-Reduction of a Folded Pop Process

4.1 Valid Scale Trees and the Contraction-Pass Reduction

Our next reduction acts entirely on folded Pop processes. To amortize across M nested partitions $\mathcal{P}_0 \succ \mathcal{P}_1 \succ \cdots \succ \mathcal{P}_M$ of $\{1, \dots, P\}$ at once without letting scale weights blow up, we organize the scales $\{1, \dots, M\}$ as the leaves of a rooted *scale tree* $\mathcal{T}$ of height at most r. Given *any* valid scale tree $\mathcal{T}$ of height at most r, a single multi-scale amortization pass self-reduces a size-P folded Pop process $\widetilde{H}$ to independent leaf folded Pop processes $\{\widetilde{H}^{(Q)}\}_{Q \in \mathcal{P}_M}$ at $+C_{\mathrm{pass}}\,r\,P$ additive cost, with a universal constant C_{pass} independent of P, r, M, and $\mathcal{T}$. This decouples the dynamic BST analysis from the purely arithmetic task of constructing valid scale trees (Section 5).

Definition 4.1 (Scale Tree and Nested Block Partitions)**.** Fix integers $P \ge 1$, $r \ge 1$, and $M \ge 1$.

(1) *Scale tree $\mathcal{T}$ and path weights $w(\xi)$.* A *scale tree of height at most r* on scales $\{1, \dots, M\}$ is a rooted ordered tree $\mathcal{T}$ whose leaves in left-to-right order are the partition scales $\{1, \dots, M\}$ (distinct from the keys $\{1, \dots, P\}$), each at depth $\delta(\ell) \in \{1, \dots, r\}$. To keep the reciprocal leaf weights summable ($\sum_{\ell=1}^{M} w_\ell^{-1} < \frac{1}{2}$) while resetting child counters inside every subtree, the edge from any internal node to its c-th child ($c \ge 1$) carries multiplier $4c^2$, giving each node $\xi \in \mathcal{T}$ path weight $w(\xi) := \prod_{q=1}^{\delta(\xi)} (4c_q^2)$ along the root-to-ξ path (setting $w(\text{root}) := 1$ and writing $w_\ell := w(\ell)$ for leaves $\ell \in \{1, \dots, M\}$).

(2) *Valid nested block partitions $\mathcal{P}_0 \succ \cdots \succ \mathcal{P}_M$.* Setting $S_0 := P$ and starting from the single-block partition $\mathcal{P}_0 := \{\{1, \dots, P\}\}$, we say $\mathcal{T}$ *validly partitions* $\{1, \dots, P\}$ if at each scale $\ell = 1, \dots, M$ the target block size S_ℓ shrinks by at least half according to

$$i_\ell \;:=\; \alpha_0(2S_{\ell-1}) + 1, \qquad S_\ell \;:=\; w_\ell\, i_\ell^2 \;\le\; \frac{1}{2} S_{\ell-1},$$

and $\mathcal{P}_0 \succ \mathcal{P}_1 \succ \cdots \succ \mathcal{P}_M$ is the chain of nested contiguous-interval partitions obtained by splitting each parent block $X \in \mathcal{P}_{\ell-1}$ (which inductively satisfies $|X| \in [S_{\ell-1}, 2S_{\ell-1})$) from left to right into $K_X := \lfloor |X|/S_\ell \rfloor \geq 2$ contiguous sub-blocks, where the first $K_X - 1$ sub-blocks have exact size S_ℓ and the last sub-block absorbs the remainder $|X| - (K_X - 1)S_\ell \in [S_\ell, 2S_\ell)$.

Note that $1 \leq K_X - 1 < K_X < 2S_{\ell-1} \leq A_{i_\ell - 1}(1) < A_{i_\ell}(1)$, directly matching the hypothesis $N \leq A_i(1)$ of Theorem 3.1 at $N = K_X - 1$ and $i = i_\ell$.

Theorem 4.2 (Scale-Tree Contraction Pass and Bisection Bound)**.** *There exists an absolute constant $C_{\text{pass}} > 0$ (independent of P, r, M, and $\mathcal{T}$) such that for every folded* Pop *process $\widetilde{H}$ of size $P \geq 1$:*

(1) For every integer $r \geq 1$ and every scale tree $\mathcal{T}$ of height at most r on $M \geq 1$ scales that validly partitions $\{1, \ldots, P\}$, there exist folded Pop *processes $\{\widetilde{H}^{(Q)}\}_{Q \in \mathcal{P}_M}$ of sizes $1 \leq |Q| < 2S_M$ with $\sum_{Q \in \mathcal{P}_M} |Q| = P$ such that*

$$J(\widetilde{H}) \;\leq\; C_{\text{pass}}\, r\, P \;+\; \sum_{Q \in \mathcal{P}_M} J(\widetilde{H}^{(Q)}).$$

(2) (Elementary bisection bound) *For all $P \geq 1$, $J(\widetilde{H}) \leq P \max\left(0, \lceil \log_2 P \rceil - 1\right)$.*

Example (variable-depth valid scale tree at $P = 3{,}200$ and four-way rotation routing). Even at $P = 3{,}200$ (where $2S_0 = 6{,}400 \in (A_3(1), A_4(1)]$ gives $i_1 = \alpha_0(6{,}400) + 1 = 5$), the height-3 variable-depth tree $\mathcal{T}$ on $M = 2$ scales placing leaf $\ell = 1$ at depth 3 along $c = (1, 1, 1)$ ($w_1 = 4^3 = 64$) and leaf $\ell = 2$ at depth 1 along $c = (2)$ ($w_2 = 4 \cdot 2^2 = 16$, with $w_1^{-1} + w_2^{-1} = \frac{5}{64} < \frac{1}{2}$) validly partitions $\{1, \ldots, 3{,}200\}$: scale 1 has $S_1 = 64 \cdot 5^2 = 1{,}600 \leq \frac{1}{2} S_0$, and scale 2 has $i_2 = \alpha_0(3{,}200) + 1 = 5$ and $S_2 = 16 \cdot 5^2 = 400 \leq \frac{1}{2} S_1 = 800$, decomposing $\widetilde{H}$ into eight 400-key leaf processes $\widetilde{H}^{(Q)}$. Figure 4 illustrates $\text{LCA}_{\mathcal{T}}$ routing on a general scale tree alongside the four-way classification of an internal $\textsc{Pop}(s)$ rotation $e = (x, y, z)$ ($s < x < y < z$) by comparing $\text{sep}(s, x)$ against $\ell = \text{sep}(x, y)$.

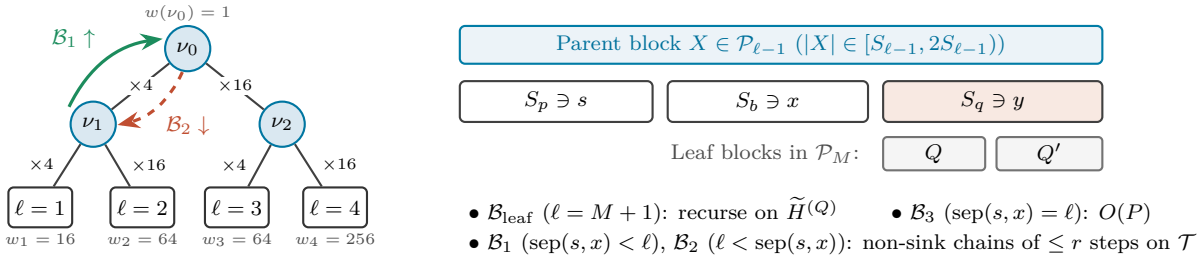


Figure 4: Simultaneous multi-scale amortization on a height-r scale tree $\mathcal{T}$: (a) edge factors $4c^2$ reset to $\times 4, \times 16, \ldots$ inside each fresh subtree while keeping $\sum_\ell w_\ell^{-1} < \frac{1}{2}$, and non-sink split-scale cascade chains move $\nu(e) = \text{LCA}_{\mathcal{T}}(\text{sep}(s, x), \ell)$ strictly up $\mathcal{T}$ in $\mathcal{B}_1$ and strictly down $\mathcal{T}$ in $\mathcal{B}_2$; (b) same-scale rotations $\mathcal{B}_3$ place $s < x < y$ in three sibling sub-blocks $S_p < S_b < S_q$ of $X \in \mathcal{P}_{\ell-1}$ and are bounded in $O(P)$ independently of r and M.

Proof overview. For $u < v$ in $\{1, \ldots, P\}$, let $\text{sep}(u, v) \in \{1, \ldots, M + 1\}$ be the smallest $\ell \leq M$ putting u and v in different blocks of $\mathcal{P}_\ell$ (or $M + 1$ if u, v share a leaf block $Q \in \mathcal{P}_M$). Partition $\mathcal{R}_{\text{int}}(\widetilde{H})$ at $\textsc{Pop}(s)$ ($s < x < y < z$, $\ell := \text{sep}(x, y)$) into four classes by comparing the trigger scale $\text{sep}(s, x)$ against ℓ, bounded along an acyclic chain of $O(P)$ estimates whose implied constants are all independent of r, M, and $\mathcal{T}$:

- *Intra-leaf rotations ($\mathcal{B}_{\text{leaf}}$, $\ell = M+1$):* $x, y \in Q \in \mathcal{P}_M$. Pre-activation rotations ($s < \min Q$) freeze y until $\textsc{Pop}(x)$ with $x \in Q$ ($\le P$), exit rotations ($z > \max Q$) occur at most once per $\textsc{Pop}$ ($\le P$), and active rotations ($s, x, y, z \in Q$) project onto independent folded $\textsc{Pop}$ processes $\widetilde{H}^{(Q)}$.

- *Split-scale rotations—coarse-trigger ($\mathcal{B}_1$, $\text{sep}(s,x) < \ell \le M$) and fine-trigger ($\mathcal{B}_2$, $\ell < \text{sep}(s,x)$):* Route e to $\nu(e) = \text{LCA}_{\mathcal{T}}(\text{sep}(s,x), \ell) \in \mathcal{T}_{\text{int}}$. Along consecutive pairs $e \to e^+$ in the same $\textsc{Pop}$ cascade, unless e freezes a block at a subtree's finest scale (summing to $\Sigma_{\mathcal{T}} = O(P)$ via $\sum_{\nu \in \mathcal{T}_{\text{int}}} w(\nu)^{-1} < 2$, so the sink set $\mathcal{S}_1$ satisfies $|\mathcal{S}_1| = O(P)$) or is topmost ($\le P$), $\nu(e^+)$ is a *strict ancestor* of $\nu(e)$ in $\mathcal{B}_1$ and a *strict descendant* of $\nu(e)$ in $\mathcal{B}_2$ (or exits $\mathcal{B}_2$ into $\mathcal{B}_1 \sqcup \mathcal{B}_3$). Cascade-path sink counting between $\mathcal{B}_1$ and $\mathcal{B}_1 \setminus \mathcal{S}_1$ bounds external entries into $\mathcal{B}_1$ by $|\mathcal{E}_{\text{enter}}| \le |\mathcal{S}_1| + |\mathcal{B}_{\text{leaf,pre}}| = O(P)$ *independently of r and M.*

- *Same-scale (three-block) rotations ($\mathcal{B}_3$, $\text{sep}(s,x) = \ell \le M$, so $s \in S_p < S_b \ni x < S_q \ni y$ inside $X \in \mathcal{P}_{\ell-1}$):* Bounded in $O(P)$ *independently of r and M*:

  (i) *Intra-block ($z \in S_q$):* A two-step parent-confinement potential Φ_{conf} on the first-child/right-sibling tree L'' of $\widetilde{H}$, paired with $|\mathcal{E}_{\text{enter}}| = O(P)$, bounds $|\mathcal{B}_{3,\text{intra}}| = O(P)$.

  (ii) *Post-depletion exits ($z > \max S_q$ after keys initially in S_p are gone):* A block-descendant potential Ψ_{post} on the unfolded BST bounds $|\mathcal{B}_{3,\text{exit,post}}| \le K_L < 2P$.

  (iii) *Active exits ($z > \max S_q$ while S_p still holds pre-existing keys):* Because parent keys in $\widetilde{H}$ only increase under right rotations, each promoted key x can serve as the promoted key in $\mathcal{B}_{3,\text{exit}}$ at *at most one scale ℓ* across the entire execution. Monotone parent-crossing injectivity charges secondary exits A_{esc} and gap-witness sets $\sum_{\ell=1}^{M} |U_\ell|$ in $O(P)$ to base, $\mathcal{B}_{3,\text{intra}}$, and $\mathcal{S}_1$ events; embedding future keys into the insertion-time Cartesian extension $\widetilde{H}^*$ turns lead exits ($\Delta_\ell = i_\ell$, $\Delta'_\ell = 2i_\ell$) into $(2i_\ell)$-cascades on a $(K_X - 1)$-node pure-right-rotation block-root summary BST $\widehat{G}_X$, where Theorem 3.1 ($N = K_X - 1 \le A_{i_\ell}(1)$) and $\sum_{\ell=1}^{M} w_\ell^{-1} < \frac{1}{2}$ bound $\sum |\widetilde{\mathcal{N}}_p^{(\ell)}| = O(P)$ and hence $|\mathcal{B}_3| = O(P)$, closing $|\mathcal{B}_2| = O(rP)$.

Beyond basic interval properties of nested key partitions, the proof below depends only on BST interval projection and emptying initialization (Lemmas 2.3 and 2.7), the three structural laws of $\widetilde{H}$ (Lemma 2.8), and the right-reach characterization, preorder-1 summary BST simulation, and bounded-gap cascade bound of Section 3 (Proposition 3.2, Lemma 3.3, and Theorem 3.1).

4.2 Convergent Leaf and Internal Weights on Height-r Scale Trees

Let $\mathcal{T}$ be a scale tree of height at most r on scales $\{1, \dots, M\}$ that validly partitions $\{1, \dots, P\}$ (Definition 4.1), and let $\mathcal{T}_{\text{int}}$ denote the set of internal nodes of $\mathcal{T}$. Every internal node $\nu \in \mathcal{T}_{\text{int}}$ sits at depth $\delta(\nu) \in \{0, \dots, r-1\}$ from root($\mathcal{T}$) and has $k_\nu \ge 1$ ordered children $\nu_1, \dots, \nu_{k_\nu}$ whose leaf subtrees partition the contiguous scale interval of ν into consecutive child intervals $(m_0, m_1], (m_1, m_2], \dots, (m_{k_\nu - 1}, m_{k_\nu}]$, where we write $M_{\text{end}}(\nu) := m_{k_\nu}$ for the rightmost (finest) scale in ν's subtree:

$$\nu = \text{LCA}_{\mathcal{T}}(\ell_1, \ell_2) \;\; (\text{path weight } w(\nu),\ \delta(\nu) \in \{0, \dots, r-1\})$$

$$\underset{\ni \ell_1}{\underbrace{(m_{c_1 - 1}, m_{c_1}]}} \;\; \underset{\swarrow \times 4c_1^2}{<} \;\; \underset{\ni \ell_2}{\underbrace{(m_{c_2 - 1}, m_{c_2}]}} \;\; \underset{\downarrow \times 4c_2^2}{\le} \;\; \underset{\text{rightmost leaf } m_{k_\nu} = M_{\text{end}}(\nu)}{\underbrace{(m_{k_\nu - 1}, m_{k_\nu}]}} \qquad \searrow \times 4k_\nu^2$$

Notice first that valid partitioning enforces a uniform numerical floor at every scale $\ell \in \{1, \dots, M\}$: since $\delta(\ell) \ge 1$, every leaf has $w_\ell \ge 4$; since $S_{\ell-1} \ge 1$, Definition 1.1 gives $i_\ell = \alpha_0(2S_{\ell-1}) + 1 \ge 2$,

whence $S_\ell = w_\ell i_\ell^2 \geq 16$ and $S_{\ell-1} \geq 2S_\ell \geq 32$. Thus $2S_{\ell-1} \geq 64 > 16 = A_3(1)$, so $\alpha_0(2S_{\ell-1}) \geq 4$ and therefore

$$i_\ell \;\geq\; 5, \qquad S_\ell \;=\; w_\ell\, i_\ell^2 \;\geq\; 25\, w_\ell \;\geq\; 100, \qquad \text{and} \qquad S_{\ell-1} \;\geq\; 2S_\ell \;\geq\; 200 \qquad (1 \leq \ell \leq M). \tag{4}$$

Lemma 4.3 (Height-Independent Weight Convergence)**.** *For every integer $r \geq 1$ and every scale tree $\mathcal{T}$ of height at most r on $M \geq 1$ scales that validly partitions $\{1, \ldots, P\}$, we have*

$$\sum_{\ell=1}^{M} \frac{1}{w_\ell} \;<\; \frac{1}{2}, \qquad \sum_{\nu \in \mathcal{T}_{\text{int}}} \frac{1}{w(\nu)} \;<\; 2, \qquad \textit{and} \qquad \Sigma_{\mathcal{T}} \;:=\; \sum_{\nu \in \mathcal{T}_{\text{int}}} k_\nu \left|\mathcal{P}_{M_{\text{end}}(\nu)}\right| \;<\; \frac{P}{50}.$$

Proof. Observe that $\sum_{c=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{4c^2} = \frac{\pi^2}{24} < \frac{1}{2}$. For any node $\xi \in \mathcal{T}$ of subtree height $q \geq 0$ (the maximum edge distance from ξ to a leaf in $\mathcal{T}_\xi$), induction on q gives $\sum_{\ell \in \text{Leaves}(\mathcal{T}_\xi)} \left(w_\ell / w(\xi)\right)^{-1} \leq 1$, with strict bound $\leq \sum_{c=1}^{k_\xi} \frac{1}{4c^2} \cdot 1 < \frac{1}{2}$ whenever $q \geq 1$; setting $\xi = \text{root}(\mathcal{T})$ ($w(\xi) = 1$, $q \geq 1$) yields $\sum_{\ell=1}^{M} w_\ell^{-1} < \frac{1}{2}$. Likewise, at each depth $\delta \in \{0, \ldots, r-1\}$, summing $w(\nu)^{-1}$ over all nodes $\nu \in \mathcal{T}_{\text{int}}$ with $\delta(\nu) = \delta$ is at most $\left(\sum_{c=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{4c^2}\right)^{\delta} \leq 2^{-\delta}$, so $\sum_{\nu \in \mathcal{T}_{\text{int}}} w(\nu)^{-1} \leq \sum_{\delta=0}^{r-1} 2^{-\delta} < 2$.

Finally, fix $\nu \in \mathcal{T}_{\text{int}}$ and set $\ell^* := M_{\text{end}}(\nu)$. The root-to-$\ell^*$ path in $\mathcal{T}$ traverses the edge from ν to its k_ν-th child (factor $4k_\nu^2$) followed by zero or more edges of factor $\geq 4 \geq 1$, so $w_{\ell^*} \geq 4k_\nu^2\, w(\nu)$. By (4), $i_{\ell^*} \geq 5$, giving $S_{\ell^*} = w_{\ell^*} i_{\ell^*}^2 \geq 100\, k_\nu^2\, w(\nu)$. Since every block in $\mathcal{P}_{\ell^*}$ has size at least S_{ℓ^*}, we have $|\mathcal{P}_{\ell^*}| \leq P / S_{\ell^*}$ and hence

$$k_\nu \left|\mathcal{P}_{M_{\text{end}}(\nu)}\right| \;\leq\; \frac{k_\nu\, P}{100\, k_\nu^2\, w(\nu)} \;\leq\; \frac{P}{100\, w(\nu)}.$$

Summing over $\nu \in \mathcal{T}_{\text{int}}$ via $\sum_{\nu \in \mathcal{T}_{\text{int}}} w(\nu)^{-1} < 2$ gives $\Sigma_{\mathcal{T}} < \frac{2P}{100} = \frac{P}{50}$. □

4.3 Separating Scales, Rotation Classification, and Leaf Subprocess Projection

Let $\mathcal{P}_0 \succ \mathcal{P}_1 \succ \cdots \succ \mathcal{P}_M$ ($M \geq 1$) be *any* nested chain of contiguous-interval partitions of $\{1, \ldots, P\}$ starting from $\mathcal{P}_0 = \{\{1, \ldots, P\}\}$ (no numerical scale condition on block sizes is needed for the definitions below or for Lemma 4.4, allowing Section 6 and Theorem 4.2(2) to invoke them directly on dyadic and bisection partitions). For $u \in \{1, \ldots, P\}$ and $0 \leq \ell \leq M$, let $B_\ell(u) \in \mathcal{P}_\ell$ denote the unique block of $\mathcal{P}_\ell$ containing u; for a block $Q \in \mathcal{P}_{\ell'}$ at a finer level $\ell' \geq \ell$, write $B_\ell(Q) := B_\ell(\min Q)$ for its enclosing block in $\mathcal{P}_\ell$.

For keys $u, v \in \{1, \ldots, P\}$, the *separating scale* $\text{sep}(u, v) \in \{1, \ldots, M+1\}$ records the first (coarsest) scale ℓ at which u and v fall into different blocks (or $M+1$ if they remain together down to the finest leaf partition $\mathcal{P}_M$):

$$\text{sep}(u, v) \;:=\; \begin{cases} M+1 & \text{if } B_M(u) = B_M(v), \\ \min\left\{\ell \in \{1, \ldots, M\} : B_\ell(u) \neq B_\ell(v)\right\} & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

Because $\mathcal{P}_0 = \{\{1, \ldots, P\}\}$, a *smaller* value of $\text{sep}(u, v)$ means u and v separate at a *coarser* scale, whereas a *larger* value means they stay in the same block down to a *finer* scale; whenever $\text{sep}(u, v) = \ell \in \{1, \ldots, M\}$, we have $B_{\ell-1}(u) = B_{\ell-1}(v)$ and $B_\ell(u) \neq B_\ell(v)$. Moreover, for any $1 \leq a < b < c \leq P$ and any $0 \leq \ell \leq M$, interval contiguity of $B_\ell(a)$ gives $B_\ell(a) = B_\ell(c) \iff B_\ell(a) = B_\ell(b) = B_\ell(c)$; taking the minimum ℓ where equality fails yields the *ultrametric identity*

$$\text{sep}(a, c) \;=\; \min\left(\text{sep}(a, b),\, \text{sep}(b, c)\right) \qquad (1 \leq a < b < c \leq P). \tag{5}$$

Every internal Pop rotation $e = (x, y, z) = (v_{2j-1}, v_{2j}, v_{2j+1}) \in \mathcal{R}_{\text{int}}(\widetilde{H})$ $(1 \le j \le h)$ during $\textsc{Pop}(s)$ satisfies $s < x < y < z$, rotating the *promoted key* x above the *displaced key* y strictly below parent z. Comparing the *trigger scale* $\text{sep}(s, x)$ (the scale separating the deleted key s from x) against the *rotation scale* $\ell := \text{sep}(x, y) \in \{1, \dots, M+1\}$ (the scale separating the rotated pair x, y) partitions $\mathcal{R}_{\text{int}}(\widetilde{H})$ into four disjoint classes:

- *Intra-leaf rotations* $\mathcal{B}_{\text{leaf}}$ $(\ell = M+1$, where x and y lie in the same leaf block $Q \in \mathcal{P}_M)$, partitioned further according to whether Q has begun deleting and whether z stays inside Q:
  - $\mathcal{B}_{\text{leaf,pre}}$ (*pre-activation*, $s < \min Q$): triggered before any key of Q is popped;
  - $\mathcal{B}_{\text{leaf,exit}}$ (*leaf-exit*, $s \in Q$ and $z > \max Q$): triggered inside Q, with parent z strictly above Q;
  - $\mathcal{B}_{\text{leaf,act}}$ (*active intra-leaf*, $s, x, y, z \in Q$): occurring entirely within Q.
- *Coarse-trigger split-scale rotations* $\mathcal{B}_1$ $(1 \le \text{sep}(s, x) < \ell \le M)$: s separates from x at a coarser scale than x separates from y (so x and y still share a block at scale $\text{sep}(s, x)$ while s lies in an earlier block).
- *Fine-trigger split-scale rotations* $\mathcal{B}_2$ $(1 \le \ell < \text{sep}(s, x) \le M+1)$: s and x still share a scale-ℓ block while y lies in a later scale-ℓ block.
- *Same-scale (three-block) rotations* $\mathcal{B}_3 = \mathcal{B}_{3,\text{intra}} \sqcup \mathcal{B}_{3,\text{exit}}$ $(1 \le \text{sep}(s, x) = \ell \le M)$: $s < x < y$ lie in three distinct sibling sub-blocks $S_p < S_b < S_q$ of the same parent block $X := B_{\ell-1}(s) \in \mathcal{P}_{\ell-1}$, split into $\mathcal{B}_{3,\text{intra}}$ ($z \in S_q$, parent z stays inside y's sub-block) and $\mathcal{B}_{3,\text{exit}}$ ($z > \max S_q$, parent z lies strictly above S_q).

Lemma 4.4 (Intra-Leaf Rotations and Leaf Subprocess Projection)**.** *For any nested chain of contiguous-interval partitions $\mathcal{P}_0 \succ \cdots \succ \mathcal{P}_M$ of $\{1, \dots, P\}$ with $\mathcal{P}_0 = \{\{1, \dots, P\}\}$, we have $|\mathcal{B}_{\text{leaf,pre}}| \le P$, $|\mathcal{B}_{\text{leaf,exit}}| \le P$, and for each leaf block $Q \in \mathcal{P}_M$ there exists a folded* Pop *process $\widetilde{H}^{(Q)}$ of size $|Q|$ ($\sum_{Q \in \mathcal{P}_M} |Q| = P$, with $1 \le |Q| < 2S_M$ whenever $\mathcal{T}$ validly partitions $\{1, \dots, P\}$) such that*

$$|\mathcal{B}_{\text{leaf}}| \;=\; |\mathcal{B}_{\text{leaf,pre}}| + |\mathcal{B}_{\text{leaf,exit}}| + |\mathcal{B}_{\text{leaf,act}}| \;\le\; 2P + \sum_{Q \in \mathcal{P}_M} J(\widetilde{H}^{(Q)}).$$

Proof. For each $e = (x, y, z) \in \mathcal{B}_{\text{leaf,pre}}$ $(s < \min Q \le x < y \in Q)$, Lemma 2.8(2) freezes $y \in (x, z)$ off $\text{LS}(\widetilde{H}_\tau)$ until $\textsc{Pop}(x)$; since $x \ge \min Q$, every later $\textsc{Pop}(s')$ with y on $\text{LS}(\widetilde{H}_{s'-})$ satisfies $s' \ge x \ge \min Q$, so each key $y \in \{1, \dots, P\}$ is displaced at most once in $\mathcal{B}_{\text{leaf,pre}}$, giving $|\mathcal{B}_{\text{leaf,pre}}| \le P$. Likewise, any $e = (v_{2j-1}, v_{2j}, v_{2j+1}) \in \mathcal{B}_{\text{leaf,exit}}$ at $\textsc{Pop}(s)$ satisfies $v_{2j} \le \max B_M(s) < v_{2j+1}$, which holds for at most one index j along $v_0 < \cdots < v_k$, giving $|\mathcal{B}_{\text{leaf,exit}}| \le P$.

Now fix $Q \in \mathcal{P}_M$, and let H_τ denote the unfolded one-sided BST corresponding to $(\widetilde{H}_\tau, b_1(\tau))$ via the spine-folding bijection of Section 2.4, so $\text{RS}(H_\tau) = (b_1 < \cdots < b_\beta)$ is the upper segment of $\text{LS}(\widetilde{H}_\tau)$ from $b_1(\tau)$ to $\text{root}(\widetilde{H}_\tau)$ and $\text{LS}(H_\tau) = (v_0 < \cdots < v_k)$ is the subpath of $\text{LS}(\widetilde{H}_\tau)$ up to $v_k = b_1(\tau)$. Let $\tau_{\text{start}}(Q) := (\min Q)^-$ be the state immediately before $\textsc{Pop}(\min Q)$. Throughout the window $[\tau_{\text{start}}(Q), (\max Q)^+]$, all keys $< \min Q$ have already been deleted by $\textsc{Pop}(1), \dots, \textsc{Pop}(\min Q - 1)$, so every newly inserted key w satisfies $w > \min Q$ and $V_\tau \cap Q = V_\tau \cap (-\infty, \max Q]$ is a downward-closed interval prefix of V_τ. Define $H_\tau^{\text{win}} := H_\tau|_{(-\infty, \max Q]}$ for $\tau \in [\tau_{\text{start}}(Q), (\max Q)^+]$:

- Let $n_0 := |V_{\tau_{\text{start}}(Q)} \cap Q|$. By Lemma 2.7, $H^{\text{win}}_{\tau_{\text{start}}(Q)}$ can be built from $\emptyset$ using n_0 Push steps, $n_0 - |\text{RS}(H^{\text{win}}_{\tau_{\text{start}}(Q)})|$ root right-spine left rotations (Shift steps in the folded tree), and 0 Pop steps.

- During $[\tau_{\text{start}}(Q), (\max Q)^+]$, each $\textsc{Push}(w)$ on H_τ inserts $w(\emptyset, H_{\tau^-})$ at the root: if $w \le \max Q$ (so $w \in Q$, $|Q| - n_0$ times total), $H^{\text{win}}_{\tau^+} = w(\emptyset, H^{\text{win}}_{\tau^-})$ executes $\textsc{Push}(w)$; if $w > \max Q$, $H^{\text{win}}_{\tau^+} = H^{\text{win}}_{\tau^-}$ is unchanged.

- Each $\textsc{Shift}$ or $\textsc{UpperRot}$ step on $\widetilde{H}_\tau$ performs a left single rotation $[b_{d+1}, b_d]$ along $\mathrm{RS}(H_\tau)$; since $\mathrm{RS}(H_{\tau^-}) \cap (-\infty, \max Q]$ is a top prefix of both $\mathrm{RS}(H_{\tau^-})$ and $\mathrm{RS}(H^{\text{win}}_{\tau^-})$, Lemma 2.3(1) shows that $H^{\text{win}}_{\tau^+}$ either equals $H^{\text{win}}_{\tau^-}$ (when $b_{d+1} > \max Q$, dropped as a no-op) or applies that same right-spine left rotation $[b_{d+1}, b_d]$ to $H^{\text{win}}_{\tau^-}$ (when $b_{d+1} \le \max Q$, so $b_d < b_{d+1} \le \max Q$).

- Each $\textsc{Pop}(s)$ during $[\tau_{\text{start}}(Q), (\max Q)^+]$ deletes $s = \min Q, \dots, \max Q$ in order. Writing $\mathrm{LS}(H^{\text{win}}_{s^-}) = \mathrm{LS}(H_{s^-}) \cap (-\infty, \max Q] = (v_0 < \cdots < v_{k_Q})$ $(0 \le k_Q \le k)$, Lemma 2.3 shows that splicing out $s = v_0$ and rotating $[v_{2j-1}, v_{2j}]$ $(1 \le j \le \lfloor k/2 \rfloor)$ on H_{s^-} transforms $H^{\text{win}}_{s^-}$ by splicing out s and rotating $[v_{2j-1}, v_{2j}]$ for $1 \le j \le \lfloor k_Q/2 \rfloor$ (if $k_Q < k$ is odd, $[v_{k_Q}, v_{k_Q+1}]$ has $v_{k_Q+1} > \max Q$ and leaves H^{win} unchanged), ending at $H^{\text{win}}_{(\max Q)^+} = \emptyset$.

Across the prepended initialization and $[\tau_{\text{start}}(Q), (\max Q)^+]$, $|\mathrm{RS}(H^{\text{win}})|$ starts at 0, ends at 0, increases by $+1$ on $|Q|$ $\textsc{Push}$ steps, changes by $\le +1$ on at most $|Q| - 1$ $\textsc{Pop}$ steps and by -1 on $\textsc{Pop}(\max Q)$, and decreases by 1 on every right-spine left rotation; hence at most $|Q| + (|Q| - 1) - 1 = 2|Q| - 2 < 2|Q|$ right-spine left rotations occur (and $0 < 2|Q|$ when $|Q| = 1$). Relabeling Q to $\{1, \dots, |Q|\}$ in increasing order and refolding yields a valid folded $\textsc{Pop}$ process $\widetilde{H}^{(Q)}$ of size $|Q|$ whose internal $\textsc{Pop}$ rotations at $\textsc{Pop}(s)$ $(s \in Q)$ are $(v_{2j-1}, v_{2j}, v_{2j+1})$ for $1 \le j \le \max(0, \lfloor (k_Q - 1)/2 \rfloor)$—precisely the rotations in $\mathcal{R}_{\text{int}}(\widetilde{H})$ with $s \ge \min Q$ and $v_{2j+1} \le \max Q$, i.e., $\mathcal{B}_{\text{leaf,act}} \cap Q^3$. Summing over $Q \in \mathcal{P}_M$ completes the proof. □

4.4 Coarse-Trigger Rotations ($\mathcal{B}_1$) and Cascade-Path Sink Counting

For an internal $\textsc{Pop}$ rotation $e_j = (v_{2j-1}, v_{2j}, v_{2j+1}) \in \mathcal{R}_{\text{int}}(\widetilde{H})$ with $1 \le j < h$ during $\textsc{Pop}(s)$, write $e_j^+ := e_{j+1} = (v_{2j+1}, v_{2j+2}, v_{2j+3})$ for the immediately following rotation along the same $\textsc{Pop}(s)$ cascade.

Lemma 4.5 ($\mathrm{LCA}_{\mathcal{T}}$ Routing of $\mathcal{B}_1$ and Cascade-Path Sink Counting)**.** *There exists a sink subset $\mathcal{S}_1 \subseteq \mathcal{B}_1$ of size $|\mathcal{S}_1| \le P + 2\Sigma_{\mathcal{T}} < \frac{26}{25} P$ such that:*

(1) $|\mathcal{B}_1| \le r\big(|\mathcal{S}_1| + |\mathcal{B}_{\text{leaf,pre}}|\big) < \frac{51}{25}\, r\, P < 3\, r\, P$.

(2) Defining the external-entry set

$$\mathcal{E}_{\text{enter}} := \Big\{ e \in \mathcal{R}_{\text{int}}(\widetilde{H}) \setminus (\mathcal{B}_1 \setminus \mathcal{S}_1) : e \text{ has a next rotation } e^+ \in \mathcal{B}_1 \sqcup \mathcal{B}_{\text{leaf,pre}} \Big\},$$

we have $|\mathcal{E}_{\text{enter}}| \le |\mathcal{S}_1| + |\mathcal{B}_{\text{leaf,pre}}| < \frac{51}{25} P$, *independently of r, M, and $\mathcal{T}$.*

Proof. Every $e = (x, y, z) = (v_{2j-1}, v_{2j}, v_{2j+1}) \in \mathcal{B}_1$ during $\textsc{Pop}(s)$ satisfies $1 \le \ell_1 := \mathrm{sep}(s, x) < \ell_2 := \mathrm{sep}(x, y) \le M$, routing e to the unique internal node $\nu(e) := \mathrm{LCA}_{\mathcal{T}}(\ell_1, \ell_2) \in \mathcal{T}_{\text{int}}$ and partitioning $\mathcal{B}_1 = \bigsqcup_{\nu \in \mathcal{T}_{\text{int}}} \mathcal{B}_1(\nu)$.

Fix $\nu \in \mathcal{T}_{\text{int}}$ with child scale intervals $(m_0, m_1], \dots, (m_{k_\nu - 1}, m_{k_\nu}]$ $(m_{k_\nu} = M_{\text{end}}(\nu))$. Any $e \in \mathcal{B}_1(\nu)$ has $\ell_1 \in (m_{c_1 - 1}, m_{c_1}]$ and $\ell_2 \in (m_{c_2 - 1}, m_{c_2}]$ for child indices $1 \le c_1 < c_2 \le k_\nu$. Set $Q_2 := B_{m_{k_\nu}}(y) \in \mathcal{P}_{M_{\text{end}}(\nu)}$. Because $\ell_1 \le m_{c_1} \le m_{c_2 - 1} < \ell_2 \le m_{c_2} \le m_{k_\nu}$, we have $B_{m_{c_2-1}}(x) = B_{m_{c_2-1}}(y) = B_{m_{c_2-1}}(Q_2)$ while $B_{m_{c_1}}(s) \ne B_{m_{c_1}}(x)$ and $B_{m_{c_2}}(x) \ne B_{m_{c_2}}(y)$, so

$$s < \min B_{m_{c_2-1}}(Q_2) \le x < \min B_{m_{c_2}}(Q_2) \le \min Q_2 \le y \le \max Q_2.$$

Two consequences follow: (i) throughout $[s^+, x^-]$, key $x < \min Q_2$ remains active, so no PUSH can insert a key into Q_2 up to and including POP(x); and (ii) once POP(x) occurs, every subsequent POP(s') satisfies $s' > x \geq \min B_{m_{c_2-1}}(Q_2)$, so any later rotation (x', y', z') with $y' \in Q_2$ has $\mathrm{sep}(s', x') \geq \mathrm{sep}(s', y') > m_{c_2-1}$ by (5) and therefore cannot lie in $\mathcal{B}_1(\nu)$ with child index c_2. Classify $e \in \mathcal{B}_1(\nu)$ according to z and (when $j < h$) $w := v_{2j+2}$:

- *Case A ($z > \max Q_2$):* By Lemma 2.8(2), $Q_2 \subseteq (x, z)$ stays frozen off $\mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H}_\tau)$ with zero insertions throughout $[s^+, x^-]$ (up to and including POP(x)), so by (ii) Case A occurs at most once per pair (Q_2, c_2) ($\leq k_\nu |\mathcal{P}_{M_{\mathrm{end}}(\nu)}|$ rotations).
- *Case B1 ($z \in Q_2$ and $j = h$):* Since $\{\mathcal{B}_1(\nu)\}_{\nu \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathrm{int}}}$ are pairwise disjoint, $j = h$ occurs at most once per POP(s) across all $\nu \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathrm{int}}$ combined ($\leq P$ rotations globally).
- *Case B2a ($z \in Q_2$, $j < h$, and $w > \max Q_2$):* Here $e^+ = (z, w, u^+)$ has $u^+ > w > \max Q_2$. By Lemma 2.8(2) applied to both e and e^+, $((x, z) \cup (z, u^+)) \cap \mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H}_\tau) = \emptyset$ throughout $[s^+, x^-] \subseteq [s^+, z^-]$ with zero insertions into Q_2, leaving at most one key of Q_2 (namely z) capable of lying on $\mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H}_\tau)$ during $[s^+, x^-]$. Because Case B2a requires two active keys $y < z$ of Q_2 on $\mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H})$ before the POP, by (ii) Case B2a also occurs at most once per pair (Q_2, c_2) ($\leq k_\nu |\mathcal{P}_{M_{\mathrm{end}}(\nu)}|$ rotations).

Let $\mathcal{S}_1 \subseteq \mathcal{B}_1$ collect all rotations in Cases A, B1, and B2a across all $\nu \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathrm{int}}$; Lemma 4.3 yields $|\mathcal{S}_1| \leq P + 2\Sigma_{\mathcal{T}} < \frac{26}{25} P$.

Every remaining rotation $e \in \mathcal{B}_1(\nu) \setminus \mathcal{S}_1$ (*Case B2b*: $j < h$ and $z, w \in Q_2$) has next rotation $e^+ = (z, w, u^+)$ satisfying $\ell_2^+ := \mathrm{sep}(z, w) > m_{k_\nu} = M_{\mathrm{end}}(\nu)$ since $z, w \in Q_2 \in \mathcal{P}_{m_{k_\nu}}$. If $\ell_2^+ = M + 1$, then $s < x < \min Q_2 \leq \min B_M(z)$ places $e^+ \in \mathcal{B}_{\mathrm{leaf,pre}}$. If $m_{k_\nu} < \ell_2^+ \leq M$, then (5) on $s < x < y < z$ gives $\mathrm{sep}(s, z) = \min(\ell_1, \ell_2, \mathrm{sep}(y, z)) = \ell_1 < \ell_2^+$, placing $e^+ \in \mathcal{B}_1(\nu^+)$ for $\nu^+ := \mathrm{LCA}_{\mathcal{T}}(\ell_1, \ell_2^+)$; because ℓ_1 lies inside ν's subtree $(m_0, m_{k_\nu}]$ whereas $\ell_2^+ > m_{k_\nu}$ lies strictly to its right, ν^+ is a *strict proper ancestor* of ν in $\mathcal{T}$ ($0 \leq \delta(\nu^+) < \delta(\nu) \leq r - 1$).

Finally, consider the directed graph $\mathcal{G}^+$ on $\mathcal{R}_{\mathrm{int}}(\widetilde{H})$ formed by all cascade edges $e_j \to e_j^+$ ($1 \leq j < h$), which is a disjoint union of directed paths (each vertex has in-degree at most 1 and out-degree at most 1). Every $e \in \mathcal{B}_1 \setminus \mathcal{S}_1$ has out-degree 1 with $e^+ \in \mathcal{B}_1 \sqcup \mathcal{B}_{\mathrm{leaf,pre}}$, and by definition $\mathcal{E}_{\mathrm{enter}}$ is disjoint from $\mathcal{B}_1 \setminus \mathcal{S}_1$ and also maps via $e \mapsto e^+$ into $\mathcal{B}_1 \sqcup \mathcal{B}_{\mathrm{leaf,pre}}$. Injectivity of $e \mapsto e^+$ gives

$$|\mathcal{B}_1 \setminus \mathcal{S}_1| + |\mathcal{E}_{\mathrm{enter}}| \;\leq\; |\mathcal{B}_1 \sqcup \mathcal{B}_{\mathrm{leaf,pre}}| \;=\; |\mathcal{B}_1| + |\mathcal{B}_{\mathrm{leaf,pre}}|,$$

proving $|\mathcal{E}_{\mathrm{enter}}| \leq |\mathcal{S}_1| + |\mathcal{B}_{\mathrm{leaf,pre}}| < \frac{51}{25} P$ by Lemma 4.4. Moreover, retaining only cascade edges $e \to e^+$ emitted by non-sink vertices $e \in \mathcal{B}_1 \setminus \mathcal{S}_1$, every edge enters $\mathcal{B}_{\mathrm{leaf,pre}}$ or remains in $\mathcal{B}_1$ while strictly decreasing $\delta(\nu) \in \{0, \ldots, r-1\}$, so every maximal directed path contains at most r vertices of $\mathcal{B}_1$ and terminates at a distinct vertex in $\mathcal{S}_1 \sqcup \mathcal{B}_{\mathrm{leaf,pre}}$, yielding $|\mathcal{B}_1| \leq r(|\mathcal{S}_1| + |\mathcal{B}_{\mathrm{leaf,pre}}|)$. □

4.5 Intra-Block Same-Scale Rotations ($\mathcal{B}_{3,\mathrm{intra}}$) via Confinement Potential

Recall from Section 2.4 that in the first-child/right-sibling ordered tree L''_τ of $\widetilde{H}_\tau$ under super-root $\top := P + 1$, the parent $\pi_\tau(v) \in V_\tau \cup \{\top\}$ of $v \in V_\tau$ is the lowest ancestor a of v in $\widetilde{H}_\tau$ with $v \in V(\mathrm{left}_{\widetilde{H}_\tau}(a))$ (or $\top$ if $v \in \mathrm{RS}(\widetilde{H}_\tau) = \{\mathrm{root}(\widetilde{H}_\tau)\}$).

Lemma 4.6 (Height-Independent Bound on $\mathcal{B}_{3,\mathrm{intra}}$)**.** *We have $|\mathcal{B}_{3,\mathrm{intra}}| \leq 2P + K_{\mathrm{rot}} + |\mathcal{E}_{\mathrm{enter}}| < \frac{151}{25} P < 7P$, independently of r, M, and $\mathcal{T}$.*

Proof. Extend $\pi_\tau(\top) := \top$ and $\mathrm{sep}(v, \top) := 0$ for all $v \in \{1, \dots, P\} \cup \{\top\}$, and define the two-step parent-confinement potential $\Phi_{\mathrm{conf}}(\tau) := \sum_{v \in V_\tau} \phi_\tau(v) \geq 0$, where for each $v \in V_\tau$,

$$\phi_\tau(v) \;:=\; \mathbf{1}\Big[1 \leq \mathrm{sep}(v, \pi_\tau(v)) \leq M \;\text{ and }\; \mathrm{sep}(\pi_\tau(v), \pi_\tau(\pi_\tau(v))) > \mathrm{sep}(v, \pi_\tau(v))\Big].$$

Initially $\Phi_{\mathrm{conf}}(0) = 0$, and after $\textsc{Pop}(P)$ we have $V_\tau = \emptyset$ and $\Phi_{\mathrm{conf}}(\tau) = 0$. Let us track $\Delta\Phi_{\mathrm{conf}}$ across each operation of Definition 2.1:

- $\textsc{Push}(w)$*:* Replacing $L_1 = \mathrm{left}_{\widetilde{H}}(b_1)$ by $w(\emptyset, L_1)$ keeps $V(L_1) \subseteq V(\mathrm{left}_{\widetilde{H}}(b_1))$ and preserves $\pi_\tau(u)$ for every $u \in V_{\tau^-}$, adding only $\phi_{\tau^+}(w) \leq 1$ ($\leq +P$ across all P $\textsc{Push}$ steps).
- $\textsc{Shift}$*:* $\widetilde{H}_\tau$ is unchanged, so $\Delta\Phi_{\mathrm{conf}} = 0$.
- $\textsc{UpperRot}$ *on* $[u, v]$ *below* $z = \pi_{\tau^-}(v)$*:* By Lemma 2.8(1), π changes only at u, updating $\pi(u) : v \mapsto z$ ($u < v < z$). For any $a \in V_\tau \setminus \{u\}$ with $\pi_{\tau^-}(a) = u$, (5) gives $\mathrm{sep}(u, z) = \min(\mathrm{sep}(u, v), \mathrm{sep}(v, z)) \leq \mathrm{sep}(u, v)$, so $\Delta\phi(a) \leq 0$; only $\phi(u)$ can increase ($\Delta\Phi_{\mathrm{conf}} \leq +1$, contributing $\leq +K_{\mathrm{rot}}$ total).
- $\textsc{Pop}(s)$*:* Since $\mathrm{left}_{\widetilde{H}_{s^-}}(s) = \emptyset$, splicing out s drops $\phi_{s^-}(s) \geq 0$ without altering π on V_{s^+}. Next, the h internal $\textsc{Pop}$ rotations $e_j = (x_j, y_j, z_j) = (v_{2j-1}, v_{2j}, v_{2j+1})$ ($1 \leq j \leq h$) update $\pi(x_j) : y_j \mapsto z_j$ ($x_j < y_j < z_j$) and leave $\pi(a)$ unchanged for all $a \in V_{s^+} \setminus \{x_1, \dots, x_h\}$ (in particular, $\pi_{s^+}(z_j) = v_{2j+3} =: u_j^+$ for $1 \leq j < h$, and $\pi_{s^+}(z_h) = \pi_{s^-}(z_h)$). For every non-promoted key $a \in V_{s^+} \setminus \{x_1, \dots, x_h\}$, either $\pi^2(a)$ is unchanged or $\pi(a) = x_j$ with $\mathrm{sep}(x_j, z_j) \leq \mathrm{sep}(x_j, y_j)$ by (5), so $\Delta\phi(a) \leq 0$.

Now inspect the promoted keys x_j ($1 \leq j \leq h$) at $\textsc{Pop}(s)$. First, whenever $e_j \in \mathcal{B}_{3,\mathrm{intra}}$ at scale $\ell = \mathrm{sep}(s, x_j) = \mathrm{sep}(x_j, y_j) \in \{1, \dots, M\}$, we have $y_j, z_j \in S_q = B_\ell(y_j)$, so $\mathrm{sep}(y_j, z_j) > \ell = \mathrm{sep}(x_j, y_j)$ and therefore $\phi_{s^-}(x_j) = 1$ *already holds before* $\textsc{Pop}(s)$, forcing $\Delta\phi(x_j) \leq 0$. Second, suppose an interior rotation e_j ($1 \leq j < h$, with $e_j^+ = (z_j, w_j, u_j^+)$) has $\Delta\phi(x_j) = +1$, i.e., $\phi_{s^-}(x_j) = 0$ and $\phi_{s^+}(x_j) = 1$. From $\phi_{s^+}(x_j) = 1$ we obtain $1 \leq \ell' := \mathrm{sep}(x_j, z_j) \leq M$ and $\mathrm{sep}(z_j, u_j^+) > \ell'$; applying (5) to $s < x_j < z_j < w_j < u_j^+$ gives $\mathrm{sep}(s, z_j) \leq \ell' < \mathrm{sep}(z_j, u_j^+) \leq \mathrm{sep}(z_j, w_j)$, so $e_j^+ \in \mathcal{B}_1 \sqcup \mathcal{B}_{\mathrm{leaf,pre}}$. Moreover, $e_j \notin \mathcal{B}_1 \setminus \mathcal{S}_1$, because any $e_j \in \mathcal{B}_1(\nu) \setminus \mathcal{S}_1$ satisfies $z_j \in B_{M_{\mathrm{end}}(\nu)}(y_j) \subseteq B_{\mathrm{sep}(x_j, y_j)}(y_j)$, which would imply $\phi_{s^-}(x_j) = 1$. Hence every interior rotation with $\Delta\phi(x_j) = +1$ lies in $\mathcal{E}_{\mathrm{enter}}$.

Partition $\mathcal{B}_{3,\mathrm{intra}}$ into three disjoint subsets (writing $S_q := B_\ell(y_j)$ at $\ell = \mathrm{sep}(x_j, y_j)$):

(1) *Topmost* ($j = h$)*:* Since $\Delta\phi(x_h) \leq 0$ on $\mathcal{B}_{3,\mathrm{intra}}$, at each $\textsc{Pop}(s)$ at most one of "$e_h \in \mathcal{B}_{3,\mathrm{intra}}$" and "$\Delta\phi(x_h) = +1$" can occur, so $\#\{e_h \in \mathcal{B}_{3,\mathrm{intra}}\} + \#\{\text{topmost } \Delta\phi(x_h) = +1\} \leq P$.

(2) *Interior confined* ($1 \leq j < h$ *and* $w_j \in S_q$)*:* Here $z_j, w_j \in S_q$ gives $\mathrm{sep}(s, z_j) = \ell < \mathrm{sep}(z_j, w_j)$, so $e_j^+ \in \mathcal{B}_1 \sqcup \mathcal{B}_{\mathrm{leaf,pre}}$ and $e_j \in \mathcal{E}_{\mathrm{enter}}$. Because $\Delta\phi(x_j) \leq 0$ on $\mathcal{B}_{3,\mathrm{intra}}$, these rotations are disjoint from all interior $\Delta\phi(x_j) = +1$ rotations (also in $\mathcal{E}_{\mathrm{enter}}$), giving $\#\{\text{type-(2) in } \mathcal{B}_{3,\mathrm{intra}}\} + \#\{\text{interior } \Delta\phi(x_j) = +1\} \leq |\mathcal{E}_{\mathrm{enter}}|$.

(3) *Interior escaping* ($1 \leq j < h$ *and* $w_j > \max S_q$)*:* Here $u_j^+ > w_j > \max S_q$ while $z_j \in S_q$, so $\mathrm{sep}(z_j, u_j^+) \leq \ell = \mathrm{sep}(x_j, z_j)$, giving $\phi_{s^+}(x_j) = 0$ and $\Delta\phi(x_j) = -1$.

Summing $\Delta\Phi_{\mathrm{conf}}$ from 0 to 0 gives $0 \leq P + K_{\mathrm{rot}} + \#\{\text{topmost } +1\} + \#\{\text{interior } +1\} - \#\{\text{type-(3)}\}$. Adding $\#\{\text{type-(1)}\} + \#\{\text{type-(2)}\}$ to both sides yields $|\mathcal{B}_{3,\mathrm{intra}}| \leq 2P + K_{\mathrm{rot}} + |\mathcal{E}_{\mathrm{enter}}| < 2P + 2P + \frac{51}{25}P = \frac{151}{25}P$, by Definition 2.1 ($K_{\mathrm{rot}} \leq K_L < 2P$) and Lemma 4.5(2). □

4.6 Exiting Same-Scale Rotations ($\mathcal{B}_{3,\text{exit}}$): Lead Exits and Parent-Crossing Injectivity

Why can we bound all exiting same-scale rotations across all M scales in $O(P)$ independently of r, M, and $\mathcal{T}$? At scale ℓ, each coarse block $X \in \mathcal{P}_{\ell-1}$ splits into K_X child sub-blocks of size at least $S_\ell = w_\ell i_\ell^2$. If we could represent each sub-block by a single node in a (K_X-1)-node BST evolving purely by right rotations and group every $\Theta(i_\ell)$ exiting rotations into one $(2i_\ell)$-gapped $(2i_\ell)$-cascade, Theorem 3.1 ($K_X - 1 < A_{i_\ell}(1)$) would permit at most $O(i_\ell K_X)$ cascades—hence $O(i_\ell^2 K_X)$ exiting rotations in X; summing over $X \in \mathcal{P}_{\ell-1}$ gives $O(i_\ell^2|\mathcal{P}_\ell|) = O(i_\ell^2 \cdot P/(w_\ell i_\ell^2)) = O(P/w_\ell)$, cancelling i_ℓ^2 so that $\sum_{\ell=1}^{M} w_\ell^{-1} < \frac{1}{2}$ bounds all M scales together in $O(P)$. Four short steps clear the obstacles separating $\widetilde{H}$ from that idealized cascade count (Lemma 4.11): (1) new keys can still be pushed after the keys initially in S_p are deleted (Lemma 4.7); (2) a sub-block S_b can be promoted more than once while S_p empties (Lemma 4.8 reduces to the first promotion of each S_b); (3) future keys are inserted dynamically across $K_X - 1$ deletion phases rather than on one static BST (Lemma 4.9); and (4) those first promotions occur at different Pop steps and may sit more than i_ℓ vertices apart on the left spine (Lemma 4.10).

Concretely, for each scale $\ell \in \{1,\dots,M\}$, parent block $X \in \mathcal{P}_{\ell-1}$ with child sub-blocks $S_1 < \cdots < S_{K_X}$ in $\mathcal{P}_\ell$, and trigger index $1 \le p \le K_X - 1$ ($S_p = [L_p, R_p]$), let L_p^- be the state immediately before $\textsc{Pop}(L_p)$ and R_p^+ the state immediately after $\textsc{Pop}(R_p)$ (so $R_p^+ \le L_{p+1}^-$, as $L_{p+1} = R_p + 1$ with no Pop steps in between). Since $L_p \in V_{L_p^-} \cap S_p$, let $s_{\max} := \max(V_{L_p^-} \cap S_p) \in S_p$ and let $\tau_{\text{empty}}(p) := s_{\max}^+ \in (L_p^-, R_p^+]$ be the state immediately after $\textsc{Pop}(s_{\max})$. Splitting $[L_p^-, R_p^+]$ at $\tau_{\text{empty}}(p)$ into the *active window* $I_p := [L_p^-, \tau_{\text{empty}}(p))$ (during which $V_\tau \cap S_p \neq \emptyset$ continuously, preventing any Push of a key $> R_p$) and the *post-depletion window* $[\tau_{\text{empty}}(p), R_p^+]$ partitions $\mathcal{B}_{3,\text{exit}} = \mathcal{B}_{3,\text{exit,act}} \sqcup \mathcal{B}_{3,\text{exit,post}}$.

Lemma 4.7 (Step 1: Post-Depletion Exits)**.** *Across all scales $1 \le \ell \le M$, we have $|\mathcal{B}_{3,\text{exit,post}}| \le K_L < 2P$.*

Proof. Work on the unfolded one-sided BST H_τ of $(\widetilde{H}_\tau, b_1(\tau))$. For each (ℓ, X, p) ($1 \le p \le K_X - 1$), define $\mathcal{Q}_p^{(\ell)}(\tau) := \emptyset$ when $\tau \notin [\tau_{\text{empty}}(p), R_p^+]$, and for $\tau \in [\tau_{\text{empty}}(p), R_p^+]$ set

$$\mathcal{Q}_p^{(\ell)}(\tau) \;:=\; \Big\{ q \in \{p+1,\dots,K_X\} : \exists\, a \in V_\tau \cap S_q,\ w \in V_\tau \cap S_p \text{ with } w \in V\big((H_\tau)_a\big) \Big\},$$

with total potential $\Psi_{\text{post}}(\tau) := \sum_{\ell=1}^{M} \sum_{X \in \mathcal{P}_{\ell-1}} \sum_{p=1}^{K_X-1} |\mathcal{Q}_p^{(\ell)}(\tau)| \ge 0$. Because $V_{\tau_{\text{empty}}(p)} \cap S_p = \emptyset$ (every key initially in $V_{L_p^-} \cap S_p$ has been deleted, and no key $> s_{\max}$ could be pushed while $s_{\max}$ remained active) and $V_{R_p^+} \cap S_p = \emptyset$, entering or leaving $[\tau_{\text{empty}}(p), R_p^+]$ changes $|\mathcal{Q}_p^{(\ell)}|$ by 0, and $\Psi_{\text{post}}(0) = \Psi_{\text{post}}(\tau_{\text{end}}) = 0$.

- Push(w)*:* $H_{\tau^+} = w(\emptyset, H_{\tau^-})$ places $w < \min V_{\tau^-}$ at the root without altering subtree membership inside H_{τ^-}; if $w \in S_q$ ($q > p$), then $\min V_{\tau^-} > w > R_p$ implies $V_{\tau^-} \cap S_p = \emptyset$, so $\Delta\Psi_{\text{post}} = 0$.
- Shift *or* UpperRot*:* Each corresponds on H_τ to a left single rotation $[b_{d+1}, b_d]$ along $\mathrm{RS}(H_\tau)$, replacing $b_d(A, b_{d+1}(B, C))$ by $b_{d+1}(b_d(A, B), C)$, so only $y := b_{d+1}$ gains descendants. If $q \in \mathcal{Q}_p^{(\ell)}(\tau^+) \setminus \mathcal{Q}_p^{(\ell)}(\tau^-)$, then $y \in S_q$ and $V_{\tau^-} \cap S_p \neq \emptyset$; since $\tau \ge \tau_{\text{empty}}(p) \ge L_p^-$, all keys $< L_p$ are already deleted, forcing $m_0 := \min V_{\tau^-} \in S_p$, which uniquely pins $\ell = \mathrm{sep}(m_0, y)$, $X = B_{\ell-1}(m_0)$, $S_p = B_\ell(m_0)$, and $S_q = B_\ell(y)$. Hence $\Delta\Psi_{\text{post}} \le +1$ ($\le +K_L$ total).

- $\textsc{Pop}(s)$: Along $\mathrm{LS}(H_{s^-}) = (v_0 < \cdots < v_k)$ $(v_0 = s)$, if $s > R_p$ then $V_{s^+} \cap S_p = \emptyset$; if $s \in S_p$, splicing out s and rotating $[v_{2j-1}, v_{2j}]$ $(1 \le j \le \lfloor k/2 \rfloor)$ bottom-up gives only v_{2j-1} new descendants $\{v_{2j}\} \cup V(\mathrm{right}_{H_{s^-}}(v_{2j})) \subseteq (R_p, +\infty)$ whenever $v_{2j-1} > R_p$, so $\mathcal{Q}_p^{(\ell)}(s^+) \subseteq \mathcal{Q}_p^{(\ell)}(s^-)$ for all (ℓ, X, p). Moreover, each $e = (x, y, z) = (v_{2j-1}, v_{2j}, v_{2j+1}) \in \mathcal{B}_{3,\mathrm{exit,post}}$ at $\textsc{Pop}(s)$ $(s \in S_p < S_b \ni x < S_q \ni y,\ z > \max S_q)$ has $s \in V((H_{s^-})_y)$ so $q \in \mathcal{Q}_p^{(\ell)}(s^-)$, whereas in H_{s^+} the rotated subtree $x(C_j, y(R_{2j-1}, R_{2j}))$ has $V(C_j) \subseteq (-\infty, x)$ $(x < \min S_q)$, $V\big(y(R_{2j-1}, R_{2j})\big) \subseteq (x, +\infty)$ $(x > R_p)$, and all proper ancestors of x in H_{s^+} have key $\ge v_{2j+1} = z > \max S_q$, so no vertex of S_q retains a descendant in S_p and $q \notin \mathcal{Q}_p^{(\ell)}(s^+)$ (for distinct q across distinct rotations of $\textsc{Pop}(s)$).

Telescoping Ψ_{post} from 0 to 0 yields $|\mathcal{B}_{3,\mathrm{exit,post}}| \le K_L < 2P$. □

For each (ℓ, X, p) $(1 \le p \le K_X - 1)$, let $V_{X,p}$ denote the set of rotations $e = (x, y, z) \in \mathcal{B}_{3,\mathrm{exit,act}}$ at scale ℓ with $s \in S_p \subseteq X$ (occurring during I_p). Define the set of promoted sub-block indices $\mathcal{F}_p := \{b \in \{p+1, \ldots, K_X\} : \exists\, (x, y, z) \in V_{X,p} \text{ with } x \in S_b\}$, and let the *lead-exit set* $\widetilde{\mathcal{N}}_p^{(\ell)} \subseteq V_{X,p}$ consist, for each $b \in \mathcal{F}_p$, of the chronologically first rotation in $V_{X,p}$ whose promoted key lies in S_b $(|\widetilde{\mathcal{N}}_p^{(\ell)}| = |\mathcal{F}_p|)$.

Lemma 4.8 (Step 2: Unique Scale per Promoted Key and Secondary-Exit Reduction)**.** *There is an escape subset $A_{\mathrm{esc}} \subseteq \mathcal{B}_{3,\mathrm{exit,act}}$ of size $|A_{\mathrm{esc}}| < 18P$ (independent of $r, M, \mathcal{T}$) such that*

$$|\mathcal{B}_{3,\mathrm{exit,act}}| \;\le\; 2 \sum_{\ell=1}^{M} \sum_{X \in \mathcal{P}_{\ell-1}} \sum_{p=1}^{K_X - 1} |\widetilde{\mathcal{N}}_p^{(\ell)}| \;+\; |A_{\mathrm{esc}}|.$$

Proof. Observe first that each key $x \in \{1, \ldots, P\}$ is the promoted key of $\mathcal{B}_3$-rotations at *at most one scale* ℓ: if x is promoted in $(x, y_1, z_1) \in \mathcal{B}_3$ at $\textsc{Pop}(s_1)$ (scale ℓ_1) and later in $(x, y_2, z_2) \in \mathcal{B}_3$ at $\textsc{Pop}(s_2)$ (scale ℓ_2, $s_1 < s_2 < x$), Lemma 2.8(1) gives $y_2 = \pi_{s_2^-}(x) \ge \pi_{s_1^+}(x) = z_1 > y_1 > x$, so (5) yields $\ell_2 = \mathrm{sep}(s_2, x) \ge \mathrm{sep}(s_1, x) = \ell_1$ and $\ell_2 = \mathrm{sep}(x, y_2) \le \mathrm{sep}(x, y_1) = \ell_1$, forcing $\ell_1 = \ell_2$. Moreover, within any fixed $V_{X,p}$, each sub-block S_q $(q > p)$ contains the displaced key y of at most one rotation $e = (x, y, z) \in V_{X,p}$, because $S_q \subseteq (x, z)$ stays frozen off $\mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H}_\tau)$ with zero insertions $> R_p$ throughout $[s^+, x^-] \supseteq [s^+, R_p^+]$ (Lemma 2.8(2)).

Consider any non-lead rotation $e = (x, y, z) \in V_{X,p} \setminus \widetilde{\mathcal{N}}_p^{(\ell)}$ at $\textsc{Pop}(s)$ $(s \in S_p < S_b \ni x < S_q \ni y,\ z > \max S_q,\ \textsc{Pop}(s) \in I_p)$. Since $e \notin \widetilde{\mathcal{N}}_p^{(\ell)}$, an earlier lead rotation $e_1 = (x_1, y_1, z_1) \in \widetilde{\mathcal{N}}_p^{(\ell)}$ occurred at $\textsc{Pop}(s_1) \in I_p$ $(L_p \le s_1 < s)$ with $x_1 \in S_b$ and $z_1 > \max S_b$. Suppose $e \notin \mathcal{M}_{\mathrm{base}}$, and let $e_L = (x, w_1, y)$ and $e_R = e_L^+ = (y, w_2, z')$ at $\textsc{Pop}(t_L)$ $(t_L < s)$ be the backward adjacent pair of Lemma 2.8(3):

- *Active-window containment ($t_L \in S_p$, $\textsc{Pop}(t_L) \in I_p$):* If $x = x_1$, then since e_1 is an internal $\textsc{Pop}$ promotion of x at $s_1 < s$ and e_L is x's immediately preceding internal $\textsc{Pop}$ promotion, $t_L \ge s_1 \ge L_p$. If $x \ne x_1$, then $(x_1, z_1) \supseteq (x_1, \max S_b]$ stayed frozen off $\mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H})$ past I_p, forcing $x < x_1 \le \max S_b < \min S_q \le y$; had $t_L < L_p \le s_1$, rotation $e_L = (x, w_1, y)$ would have frozen $x_1 \in (x, y)$ off $\mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H})$ until $\textsc{Pop}(x)$ $(x > R_p)$, contradicting e_1 at $\textsc{Pop}(s_1)$. Thus $L_p \le t_L < s$, so $t_L \in S_p$ and $\textsc{Pop}(t_L) \in I_p$.

- *Derived rotations ($e_R \in \mathcal{B}_{3,\mathrm{exit,act}}$):* Since $t_L \in S_p$, $y \in S_q$, and $\textsc{Pop}(t_L) \in I_p$, we have $\mathrm{sep}(t_L, y) = \ell$, so $e_R \in \mathcal{B}_{3,\mathrm{exit,act}}$ forces $\mathrm{sep}(y, w_2) = \ell$, i.e., $e_R \in V_{X,p}$ and $q \in \mathcal{F}_p$. Because each $q \in \mathcal{F}_p$ is the displaced sub-block of at most one rotation in $V_{X,p}$, at most $|\mathcal{F}_p| = |\widetilde{\mathcal{N}}_p^{(\ell)}|$ derived rotations occur in $V_{X,p}$.

Let A_{esc} collect all remaining rotations $e \in V_{X,p} \setminus \widetilde{\mathcal{N}}_p^{(\ell)}$ across all (ℓ, X, p), partitioned into five categories:

(a) $e \in \mathcal{M}_{\text{base}}$: at most $|\mathcal{M}_{\text{base}}| \le 2P + K_{\text{rot}} < 4P$ by Lemma 2.8(3).

(b) $e \notin \mathcal{M}_{\text{base}}$ and $w_2 > \max X$: Lemma 2.8(1) gives $z = \pi_{s^-}(y) \ge \pi_{t_L^+}(y) = z' > w_2 > \max X$, setting $\pi_{s^+}(x) = z > \max X$. Any later $\mathcal{B}_3$-rotation promoting x would have displaced key $\ge z > \max X$ (scale $< \ell$), violating the unique-scale property of x; hence e is the last $\mathcal{B}_3$-rotation ever promoting x ($\le P$ globally).

(c) $e \notin \mathcal{M}_{\text{base}}$, $w_2 \in X \setminus S_q$, and $e_R \notin \mathcal{B}_{3,\text{exit,act}}$: here $t_L \in S_p$, $y \in S_q$, and $w_2 \in X \setminus S_q$ ($w_2 > \max S_q$) give $\text{sep}(t_L, y) = \ell = \text{sep}(y, w_2)$; since $\textsc{Pop}(t_L) \in I_p$ and $e_R \notin \mathcal{B}_{3,\text{exit,act}}$, we must have $e_R \in \mathcal{B}_{3,\text{intra}}$. Global injectivity of $e \mapsto e_R$ (Lemma 2.8(3)) bounds Category (c) by $|\mathcal{B}_{3,\text{intra}}|$.

(d) $e \notin \mathcal{M}_{\text{base}}$, $w_2 \in S_q$, and $z' > \max S_q$: here $\text{sep}(t_L, y) = \ell < \text{sep}(y, w_2) =: \ell_R$. If $\ell_R = M + 1$, then $t_L \in S_p < S_q \supseteq B_M(y)$ places $e_R \in \mathcal{B}_{\text{leaf,pre}}$; if $\ell < \ell_R \le M$, then $e_R \in \mathcal{B}_1(\nu_R)$ for $\nu_R = \text{LCA}_{\mathcal{T}}(\ell, \ell_R)$ with $\ell < \ell_R \le M_{\text{end}}(\nu_R)$, so $B_{M_{\text{end}}(\nu_R)}(w_2) \subseteq B_\ell(w_2) = S_q < z'$ places e_R in Case A of $\mathcal{B}_1(\nu_R) \subseteq \mathcal{S}_1$. Injectivity of $e \mapsto e_R$ bounds Category (d) by $|\mathcal{S}_1| + |\mathcal{B}_{\text{leaf,pre}}|$.

(e) $e \notin \mathcal{M}_{\text{base}}$, $w_2 \in S_q$, and $z' \in S_q$: here $\pi_{t_L^+}(y) = z' \le \max S_q$ whereas $\pi_{s^-}(y) = z > \max S_q$. By Lemma 2.8(1), $\pi_\tau(y)$ is non-decreasing and changes only when y is promoted by a right rotation; let $\tilde{e}(e) = (y, \tilde{w}, \tilde{z})$ at timestamp $\tilde{\tau} \in (t_L^+, s^-) \subseteq I_p$ be the unique right rotation promoting y with $\tilde{w} \le \max S_q < \tilde{z}$. Either $\tilde{e}(e)$ is an $\textsc{UpperRot}$ ($\le K_{\text{rot}}$), or $\tilde{e}(e)$ is an internal $\textsc{Pop}$ rotation at $\textsc{Pop}(\tilde{t}) \in I_p$ ($\tilde{t} \in S_p$) with $y < \tilde{w} \in S_q < \tilde{z}$, which lies in $\mathcal{S}_1 \sqcup \mathcal{B}_{\text{leaf,pre}}$ by the check of (d). Moreover, $e \mapsto \tilde{e}(e)$ is injective: at $\tilde{\tau} \in I_p$, $m_0 := \min V_{\tilde{\tau}^-} \in S_p$ and $y \in S_q$ uniquely pin $\ell = \text{sep}(m_0, y)$, $X = B_{\ell-1}(m_0)$, $S_p = B_\ell(m_0)$, and $S_q = B_\ell(y)$, and S_q is displaced at most once in $V_{X,p}$. Thus Category (e) contributes at most $K_{\text{rot}} + |\mathcal{S}_1| + |\mathcal{B}_{\text{leaf,pre}}|$.

Summing (a)–(e) via Lemmas 4.4, 4.5, and 4.6 gives $|A_{\text{esc}}| < (4 + 1 + \frac{151}{25} + \frac{51}{25} + 2 + \frac{51}{25})P = \frac{428}{25}P < 18P$. □

Lemma 4.9 (Step 3: Insertion-Time Cartesian Extension $\widetilde{H}^*$ and Block-Root Summary BST $\widehat{G}_X$)**.** *Fix $\ell \in \{1, \dots, M\}$ and $X \in \mathcal{P}_{\ell-1}$ ($K_X \ge 2$). There exist a $(K_X - p)$-node BST $G^{(p)}(\tau)$ on $\{p+1, \dots, K_X\}$ for each $1 \le p \le K_X - 1$ and $\tau \in [L_p^-, L_{p+1}^-]$, evolving purely by right single rotations, and a single $(K_X - 1)$-node BST $\widehat{G}_X$ on $\{2, \dots, K_X\}$ evolving purely by right single rotations, such that:*

(1) Every rotation $e = (x, y, z) \in V_{X,p}$ ($x \in S_b, y \in S_q$) at $\textsc{Pop}(s)$ executes the right single rotation $[b, q]$ along $\text{LS}(G^{(p)}(s^-))$;

(2) Any pure-right-rotation trajectories connecting $G^{(p)}(L_p^-)$ to $G^{(p)}(L_{p+1}^-)$ ($1 \le p \le K_X - 1$) concatenate sequentially into a single valid pure-right-rotation trajectory on $\widehat{G}_X$.

Proof. Following Sundar's future-insertion pre-embedding [Sun92, Section 3, Lemma 10, Simplification 2], assign each key $u \in \{1, \dots, P\}$ its unique insertion step index $\text{ins}(u)$. By Vuillemin [Vui80], every finite subset $S \subseteq \{1, \dots, P\}$ has a unique BST $\text{Cart}(S)$ forming a min-heap under $\text{ins}(\cdot)$. At any timestamp τ with deleted prefix $\{1, \dots, s_0\}$ and not-yet-inserted set $F_\tau := \{s_0 + 1, \dots, P\} \setminus V_\tau$, define $\widetilde{H}_\tau^*$ on $\{s_0 + 1, \dots, P\}$ from $\widetilde{H}_\tau$ by filling each empty child pointer (external leaf slot (α, β)) of $\widetilde{H}_\tau$ with $\text{Cart}(F_\tau \cap (\alpha, \beta))$ (setting $\widetilde{H}_\tau^* := \text{Cart}(F_\tau)$ when $\widetilde{H}_\tau = \emptyset$), so $\widetilde{H}_\tau^*|_{V_\tau} = \widetilde{H}_\tau$. Under Definition 2.1: $\textsc{Shift}$ leaves $\widetilde{H}_\tau^*$ unchanged; every right rotation $[x, y]$ on $\widetilde{H}_\tau$ ($\textsc{UpperRot}$ or

internal Pop) preserves external slot intervals and executes $[x, y]$ on $\widetilde{H}^*_\tau$; Pop(s) $(s = s_0 + 1)$ splices out the left-childless minimum $s = \min V(\widetilde{H}^*_{s^-})$ and executes $[v_{2j-1}, v_{2j}]$; and Push(w) $(\mathrm{ins}(w) = \min_{u \in F_{\tau^-}} \mathrm{ins}(u))$ satisfies $\widetilde{H}^*_{\tau^+} = \widetilde{H}^*_{\tau^-}$ when $V_{\tau^-} = \emptyset$, while for $V_{\tau^-} \neq \emptyset$ $(m_0 := \min V_{\tau^-})$ key $w = \mathrm{root}(\mathrm{Cart}(F_{\tau^-} \cap (-\infty, m_0))) = \mathrm{left}_{\widetilde{H}^*_{\tau^-}}(m_0)$ rotates up $\mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H}^*_{\tau^-})$ via right single rotations past $[m_0, b_1(\tau^-))$ to become $\mathrm{left}_{\widetilde{H}^*}(b_1(\tau^-))$, yielding $\widetilde{H}^*_{\tau^+}$.

For $1 \le p \le K_X - 1$ and $\tau \in [L_p^-, L_{p+1}^-]$, only keys in $S_p = [L_p, R_p]$ are deleted by Pop, so $B_p(\tau) := \widetilde{H}^*_\tau|_{(R_p, \max X]}$ has static vertex set $S_{p+1} \sqcup \cdots \sqcup S_{K_X}$ and evolves purely by right single rotations (Lemma 2.3(1); moreover, during $I_p \subseteq [L_p^-, L_{p+1}^-)$, every Push$(w)$ has $w \le s_{\max} \le R_p$ and leaves $B_p(\tau)$ unchanged). Applying Lemma 3.3 at $D = 1$ to $B_p(\tau)$ across blocks $S_{p+1} < \cdots < S_{K_X}$ defines $\rho_c(\tau) := \mathrm{root}(B_p(\tau)|_{S_c})$ and gives a $(K_X - p)$-node summary BST $G^{(p)}(\tau)$ on $\{p+1, \ldots, K_X\}$ evolving purely by right rotations (with intra-block rotations inside S_c leaving $G^{(p)}(\tau)$ unchanged at $D = 1$). Every $e = (x, y, z) \in V_{X,p}$ $(x \in S_b, y \in S_q$, with $y > \max S_b$ and $z > \max S_q)$ has $x, y \in \mathrm{LS}(B_p(s^-))$ with parents $y > \max S_b$ and $z > \max S_q$ in $\widetilde{H}^*_{s^-}$, hence $x = \rho_b(s^-)$ and $y = \rho_q(s^-)$, executing $[b, q]$ on $\mathrm{LS}(G^{(p)}(s^-))$ and proving (1).

Finally, at $\tau = L_{p+1}^-$ $(1 \le p \le K_X - 2)$, $B_{p+1}(L_{p+1}^-) = B_p(L_{p+1}^-)|_{(R_{p+1}, \max X]}$ shares the exact block roots $\rho_{p+2}(L_{p+1}^-), \ldots, \rho_{K_X}(L_{p+1}^-)$, so $G^{(p+1)}(L_{p+1}^-) = G^{(p)}(L_{p+1}^-)|_{\{p+2, \ldots, K_X\}}$. Rotating $p+1 = \min V(G^{(p)}(L_{p+1}^-))$ up $\mathrm{LS}(G^{(p)}(L_{p+1}^-))$ via right single rotations produces $(p+1)(\emptyset, G^{(p+1)}(L_{p+1}^-))$ by Lemma 2.3(1) on $\{p+2, \ldots, K_X\}$; inductively maintaining $2 \xrightarrow{R} \cdots \xrightarrow{R} (p+1)$ as a top prefix of $\mathrm{RS}(\widehat{G}_X)$ with empty left subtrees and bottom right subtree $G^{(p+1)}(\tau)$ embeds all $K_X - 1$ phases sequentially into one $(K_X - 1)$-node pure-right-rotation BST $\widehat{G}_X$, proving (2). □

Lemma 4.10 (Step 4: Contiguous Left-Spine Runs and Gap-Witness Sets)**.** *In the setting of Lemma 4.9, fix (ℓ, X, p) $(1 \le p \le K_X - 1)$, set $G_0 := G^{(p)}(L_p^-)$, $G_{\mathrm{end}} := G^{(p)}(\tau_{\mathrm{empty}}(p))$, and $\Pi_0 := \mathrm{LS}(G_0) = (c_1 < \cdots < c_m)$. Then $\mathcal{F}_p \subseteq \{c_1, \ldots, c_{m-1}\}$, and:*

(1) Along every maximal contiguous run $c_a < c_{a+1} < \cdots < c_b$ of $\mathcal{F}_p$ on Π_0 $(b < m$, so $c_{b+1} \in \Pi_0 \setminus \mathcal{F}_p)$, the lead-exit Pop keys $s(c_t) \in S_p$ satisfy $s(c_b) < \cdots < s(c_a)$ and $R_{G_{\mathrm{end}}}(c_t) \ge R_{G_0}(c_{b+1})$ for all $a \le t \le b$.

(2) There exist gap-witness sets $\mathcal{U}_\ell(X, p) \subseteq \Pi_0 \setminus \mathcal{F}_p$ $(U_\ell := \bigsqcup_{X,p} \mathcal{U}_\ell(X, p))$ such that every consecutive gap $c_{a+1} < \cdots < c_{b-1}$ of size $g = b - a - 1 > i_\ell$ between elements $c_a < c_b$ of $\mathcal{F}_p$ on Π_0 contributes at least $g - 3 > \frac{1}{2} i_\ell$ elements to $\mathcal{U}_\ell(X, p)$, and across all scales,

$$\sum_{\ell=1}^{M} |U_\ell| \;\le\; 2\,|\mathcal{B}_{3,\mathrm{intra}}| + |\mathcal{S}_1| + |\mathcal{B}_{\mathrm{leaf,pre}}| + 2K_L + P \;<\; 20\,P. \tag{6}$$

Proof. Right rotations on $G^{(p)}$ never add vertices to $\mathrm{LS}(G^{(p)})$, so $\mathrm{LS}(G^{(p)}(\tau)) \subseteq \Pi_0$ for all $\tau \in [L_p^-, L_{p+1}^-]$. Each $c \in \mathcal{F}_p$ executes its lead-exit rotation $[c, q_c]$ $(c < q_c)$ along $\mathrm{LS}(G^{(p)}(s(c)^-)) \subseteq \Pi_0$ at Pop$(s(c)) \in I_p$, forcing $c \in \{c_1, \ldots, c_{m-1}\}$.

For (1), if $a \le t < b$ had $s(c_t) \le s(c_{t+1})$, then the rotation $[c_t, q_{c_t}]$ at Pop$(s(c_t))$ along $\mathrm{LS}(G^{(p)}(s(c_t)^-)) \subseteq \Pi_0$ satisfies $q_{c_t} \ge c_{t+1}$, which both precludes c_{t+1} from being promoted in a vertex-disjoint pair at Pop$(s(c_t))$ and leaves $c_{t+1} \notin \mathrm{LS}(G^{(p)}(s(c_t)^+))$ thereafter, contradicting $s(c_{t+1}) \ge s(c_t)$. Thus $s(c_b) < \cdots < s(c_a)$. We prove $R_{G^{(p)}(s(c_t)^+)}(c_t) \ge R_{G_0}(c_{b+1})$ by downward induction on $t = b, \ldots, a$: if $q_{c_t} \ge c_{b+1}$ on $\Pi_0 = \mathrm{LS}(G_0)$, then $c_{b+1} \in V((G_0)_{q_{c_t}})$ and Proposition 3.2 give $R_{G^{(p)}(s(c_t)^+)}(c_t) = R_{G^{(p)}(s(c_t)^-)}(q_{c_t}) \ge R_{G_0}(q_{c_t}) \ge R_{G_0}(c_{b+1})$; otherwise $q_{c_t} = c_{t'}$ with $t < t' \le b$, so $s(c_{t'}) < s(c_t)$ and the induction hypothesis give $R_{G^{(p)}(s(c_t)^+)}(c_t) =$

$R_{G^{(p)}(s(c_t)^-)}(c_{t'}) \geq R_{G^{(p)}(s(c_{t'})^+)}(c_{t'}) \geq R_{G_0}(c_{b+1})$. Since $s(c_t)^+ \leq \tau_{\text{empty}}(p)$, Proposition 3.2 gives $R_{G_{\text{end}}}(c_t) \geq R_{G_0}(c_{b+1})$.

For (2), consider any gap $c_{a+1} < \cdots < c_{b-1}$ ($g = b - a - 1 \geq 1$) between consecutive $c_a < c_b$ in $\mathcal{F}_p$ on Π_0, and set $s^\dagger := s(c_a) \in I_p$ and $s^* := s(c_b) \in I_p$. Every $c \in \{c_{a+1}, \ldots, c_{b-1}\} \cap \mathrm{LS}(G^{(p)}(s^{\dagger-}))$ has $\rho_c(s^{\dagger-})$ a proper ancestor of the active key $\rho_{c_a}(s^{\dagger-}) \in V_{s^{\dagger-}}$ in $\widetilde{H}^*_{s^{\dagger-}}$, hence active on $\mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H}_{s^{\dagger-}})$. Partition $\{c_{a+1}, \ldots, c_{b-1}\}$ at $s^{\dagger-}$ into three classes:

(A) $c \notin \mathrm{LS}(G^{(p)}(s^{\dagger-}))$: Since intra-block rotations and Push steps during I_p leave $G^{(p)}$ unchanged, c was evicted from $\mathrm{LS}(G^{(p)})$ during $[L_p^-, s^{\dagger-}) \subseteq I_p$ by an active inter-block right rotation $\tilde{e}_c = [w_c, \rho_c(\tau^-)]$ with $w_c \in S_{c'}$ ($p < c' < c$), uniquely pinning $\ell = \mathrm{sep}(w_c, \rho_c(\tau^-))$, $S_p = B_\ell(\min V_{\tau^-})$, and $S_c = B_\ell(\rho_c(\tau^-))$. Either $\tilde{e}_c \in$ UpperRot, or $\tilde{e}_c = (w_c, \rho_c(\tau^-), z') \in \mathcal{B}_3$ at $\textsc{Pop}(s') \in I_p$ ($s' < s^\dagger$); here $\tilde{e}_c \notin V_{X,p}$ (if $\tilde{e}_c \in V_{X,p}$, then $c' \in \mathcal{F}_p \subseteq \Pi_0$ with $c' < c < c_b$, so $c' \leq c_a$; here $c' = c_a$ contradicts $s^\dagger = s(c_a)$ since $s' < s^\dagger$, and $p < c' < c_a$ would freeze $S_{c_a} \subseteq (w_c, z')$ past I_p), forcing $\tilde{e}_c \in \mathcal{B}_{3,\text{intra}}$.

(B) $c \in \mathrm{LS}(G^{(p)}(s^{\dagger-}))$ and $\rho_c(s^{\dagger-}) < b_1(s^{\dagger-})$: Let $c_{\eta_1} < \cdots < c_{\eta_t}$ be these indices, located at $\rho_{c_{\eta_q}}(s^{\dagger-}) = v_{i_q}$ ($0 < i_1 < \cdots < i_t < k$) above $\rho_{c_a}(s^{\dagger-})$ along $v_0 < \cdots < v_k = b_1(s^{\dagger-})$ on $\mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H}_{s^{\dagger-}})$. Because $\rho_c(s^{\dagger-}) = \mathrm{root}(B_p(s^{\dagger-})|_{S_c})$, every proper ancestor of $\rho_c(s^{\dagger-})$ on $\mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H}_{s^{\dagger-}})$ is $> \max S_c$. Exclude at most three free indices: (i) $q = t$ if $k = 2h + 2$ and $i_t = 2h + 1$; (ii) the unique q (if any) with $i_q = 2j - 1$ odd and $v_{2j} > \max X$; and (iii) $q = 1$ if $i_1 = 2j$ is even and $v_{2j-1} \leq \rho_{c_a}(s^{\dagger-})$. Each remaining q satisfies $1 \leq i_q \leq 2h$:

- *Subcase B1 ($i_q = 2j - 1$ odd, $v_{2j} \in X$):* Since $v_{2j} > \max S_{c_{\eta_q}}$ and $c_{\eta_q} \notin \mathcal{F}_p$, rotation $e_j = (v_{2j-1}, v_{2j}, v_{2j+1})$ has $\mathrm{sep}(s^\dagger, v_{2j-1}) = \ell = \mathrm{sep}(v_{2j-1}, v_{2j})$ and $e_j \notin V_{X,p}$, so $e_j \in \mathcal{B}_{3,\text{intra}}$.
- *Subcase B2 ($i_q = 2j$ even, with $q \geq 2$ or $v_{2j-1} > \rho_{c_a}(s^{\dagger-})$):* Here v_{2j-1} lies above $\rho_{c_a}(s^{\dagger-})$ (hence $> \max S_{c_a}$), so $S_d := B_\ell(v_{2j-1})$ satisfies $c_a < d \leq c_{\eta_q} < c_b$ ($d \notin \mathcal{F}_p$), while $v_{2j+1} > \max S_{c_{\eta_q}}$. If $d < c_{\eta_q}$, then $e_j = (v_{2j-1}, v_{2j}, v_{2j+1}) \in V_{X,p}$ would force $d \in \mathcal{F}_p$; hence $d = c_{\eta_q}$ ($v_{2j-1}, v_{2j} \in S_{c_{\eta_q}}$), pinning $\ell = \mathrm{sep}(s^\dagger, v_{2j-1}) < \mathrm{sep}(v_{2j-1}, v_{2j})$ and placing $e_j \in \mathcal{S}_1 \sqcup \mathcal{B}_{\text{leaf,pre}}$ as in Lemma 4.8(d) (disjoint from $\mathcal{B}_{3,\text{intra}}$, so each element of $\mathcal{B}_{3,\text{intra}}$ is charged at most once in Class A and once in Subcase B1).

(C) $c \in \mathrm{LS}(G^{(p)}(s^{\dagger-}))$ and $\rho_c(s^{\dagger-}) \geq b_1(s^{\dagger-})$: Let $\mathrm{LS}_{\text{up}}(\tau) := \{u \in \mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H}_\tau) : u \geq b_1(\tau)\}$. Here $v := \rho_c(s^{\dagger-}) \in S_c$ lies in $\mathrm{LS}_{\text{up}}(s^{\dagger-})$, whereas at s^{*-} ($c < c_b$) we have $v \leq \max S_c < \rho_{c_b}(s^{*-}) < b_1(s^{*-})$ and hence $v \notin \mathrm{LS}_{\text{up}}(s^{*-})$ ($s^* \neq s^\dagger$). During I_p, $\textsc{Push}(w)$ adds only $w \leq R_p < v$ to $\mathrm{LS}_{\text{up}}(\tau)$ (moving L_1 into $\mathrm{right}_{\widetilde{H}}(w)$ off $\mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H})$), Shift and UpperRot each remove a single key from $\mathrm{LS}_{\text{up}}(\tau)$, and $\textsc{Pop}(s')$ ($s' \in S_p$) adds a key $> R_p$ to $\mathrm{LS}_{\text{up}}(\tau)$ only when $k = 2h + 2 \geq 2$ is even (adding v_{2h+1}). Thus if $s^* < s^\dagger$, v enters $\mathrm{LS}_{\text{up}}(\tau)$ at an even-k $\textsc{Pop}(s')$ during $[s^*, s^\dagger) \subseteq I_p$ ($\ell = \mathrm{sep}(s', v)$, $\leq P$ globally); if $s^\dagger < s^*$, v leaves $\mathrm{LS}_{\text{up}}(\tau)$ at a Shift or UpperRot step $\tau \in [s^{\dagger-}, s^{*-}) \subseteq I_p$ ($\ell = \mathrm{sep}(\min V_{\tau^-}, v)$, $\leq K_L$ globally).

Collecting all non-free indices in (A)–(C) into $\mathcal{U}_\ell(X, p)$, (4) ($i_\ell \geq 5$) implies that every gap $g \geq i_\ell + 1 \geq 6$ contributes at least $g - 3 \geq i_\ell - 2 \geq \frac{3}{5} i_\ell > \frac{1}{2} i_\ell$ elements to $\mathcal{U}_\ell(X, p)$, and summing witness capacities yields (6) ($< (\frac{302}{25} + \frac{51}{25} + 4 + 1)P = \frac{478}{25} P < 20P$). □

Lemma 4.11 (Height-Independent Bound on $\mathcal{B}_{3,\text{exit}}$ and $\mathcal{B}_3$)**.** *Across all scales $1 \leq \ell \leq M$, we have $|\mathcal{B}_{3,\text{exit}}| < (9C_{\text{casc}} + 341)\, P$ and*

$$|\mathcal{B}_3| \;=\; |\mathcal{B}_{3,\text{intra}}| + |\mathcal{B}_{3,\text{exit}}| \;<\; (9C_{\text{casc}} + 348)\, P,$$

where $C_{\text{casc}} > 0$ is the absolute constant of Theorem 3.1 (independent of r, M, and $\mathcal{T}$).

Proof. Fix (ℓ, X, p) ($1 \le \ell \le M$, $X \in \mathcal{P}_{\ell-1}$, $1 \le p \le K_X - 1$), and set $\Delta_\ell := i_\ell$ and $\Delta'_\ell := 2i_\ell$. Cutting $\mathcal{F}_p$ along $\Pi_0 = \mathrm{LS}(G_0)$ at every consecutive gap of size $g > \Delta_\ell$ partitions $\mathcal{F}_p$ into $R_{X,p} \le 1 + \frac{2|\mathcal{U}_\ell(X,p)|}{i_\ell}$ pieces by Lemma 4.10(2). Within the t-th piece $c_{f_1} < c_{f_2} < \cdots < c_{f_{\mu_t}}$ ($f_{q+1} - f_q - 1 \le i_\ell$), select the odd-indexed subset $c_{f_1}, c_{f_3}, \ldots, c_{f_{2k_t-1}}$ ($k_t := \lceil \mu_t/2 \rceil$, $\mu_t \le 2k_t$): the k_t edges $[c_{f_{2q-1}}, c_{f_{2q-1}+1}]$ ($1 \le q \le k_t$) are vertex-disjoint along $\Pi_0 = \mathrm{LS}(G_0)$ with pairwise subpath gaps $(f_{2q+1} - f_{2q} - 1) + (f_{2q} - f_{2q-1} - 1) \le 2i_\ell = \Delta'_\ell$ (and edges from distinct pieces are separated by cut gaps $g > i_\ell \ge 5$).

Executing $\lfloor k_t/(2i_\ell) \rfloor$ disjoint batches of $2i_\ell$ consecutive selected edges within each piece $t = 1, \ldots, R_{X,p}$ from bottom to top along Π_0 performs $\sum_{t=1}^{R_{X,p}} \lfloor k_t/(2i_\ell) \rfloor$ sequential Δ'_ℓ-gapped right $(2i_\ell)$-cascades from G_0, reaching a tree G_1. For each rotated edge $[c_{f_{2q-1}}, c_{f_{2q-1}+1}]$, if $c_a < \cdots < c_b$ is the maximal contiguous run of $\mathcal{F}_p$ on Π_0 containing $c_{f_{2q-1}}$, then $f_{2q-1} + 1 \le b + 1$ places $c_{f_{2q-1}+1} \in V((G_0)_{c_{b+1}})$, so Lemma 4.10(1) gives $R_{G_1}(c_{f_{2q-1}}) = R_{G_0}(c_{f_{2q-1}+1}) \le R_{G_0}(c_{b+1}) \le R_{G_{\mathrm{end}}}(c_{f_{2q-1}})$ (while $R_{G_1}(u) = R_{G_0}(u) \le R_{G_{\mathrm{end}}}(u)$ for all unrotated u). By Proposition 3.2, G_{end} is reachable from G_1 by right single rotations; concatenating across $p = 1, \ldots, K_X - 1$ via Lemma 4.9(2) yields a pure-right-rotation trajectory on the $(K_X - 1)$-node BST $\widehat{G}_X$. Since $1 \le K_X - 1 < 2S_{\ell-1} \le A_{i_\ell - 1}(1) < A_{i_\ell}(1)$ (Definition 4.1), Theorem 3.1 bounds the total number of $(2i_\ell)$-cascades across $p = 1, \ldots, K_X - 1$ by $C_{\mathrm{casc}}(2i_\ell + 1)(K_X - 1)$.

Using $|\widetilde{\mathcal{N}}_p^{(\ell)}| = \sum_{t=1}^{R_{X,p}} \mu_t \le \sum_{t=1}^{R_{X,p}} 4i_\ell(1 + \lfloor k_t/(2i_\ell) \rfloor)$, $\sum_{X \in \mathcal{P}_{\ell-1}} (K_X - 1) < |\mathcal{P}_\ell| \le \frac{P}{S_\ell}$, $S_\ell = w_\ell i_\ell^2$, and $i_\ell \ge 5$ ($\frac{4}{i_\ell} < 1$ and $\frac{8i_\ell + 4}{i_\ell} < 9$), we obtain

$$\begin{aligned}\sum_{X \in \mathcal{P}_{\ell-1}} \sum_{p=1}^{K_X - 1} |\widetilde{\mathcal{N}}_p^{(\ell)}| \;&\le\; 4i_\ell \sum_{X \in \mathcal{P}_{\ell-1}} \left[(K_X - 1) + \frac{2}{i_\ell} \sum_{p=1}^{K_X - 1} |\mathcal{U}_\ell(X,p)| + C_{\mathrm{casc}}(2i_\ell + 1)(K_X - 1) \right] \\ &<\; \left(\frac{4}{i_\ell} + C_{\mathrm{casc}} \frac{8i_\ell + 4}{i_\ell} \right) \frac{P}{w_\ell} + 8\,|U_\ell| \;<\; (9C_{\mathrm{casc}} + 1)\,\frac{P}{w_\ell} + 8\,|U_\ell|.\end{aligned}$$

Summing over $\ell = 1, \ldots, M$ via Lemma 4.3 ($\sum_{\ell=1}^{M} w_\ell^{-1} < \frac{1}{2}$) and (6) ($\sum_{\ell=1}^{M} |U_\ell| < 20P$) gives $\sum_{\ell,X,p} |\widetilde{\mathcal{N}}_p^{(\ell)}| < (\frac{9}{2} C_{\mathrm{casc}} + \frac{321}{2})P$. Substituting into Lemma 4.8 yields $|\mathcal{B}_{3,\mathrm{exit,act}}| < (9C_{\mathrm{casc}} + 339)P$, and adding Lemmas 4.7 and 4.6 gives the stated bounds. □

4.7 Fine-Trigger Rotations ($\mathcal{B}_2$), Scale-Tree Contraction Pass, and Bisection Bound

Lemma 4.12 ($\mathrm{LCA}_{\mathcal{T}}$ Routing of $\mathcal{B}_2$)**.** *There exists a sink subset $\mathcal{S}_2 \subseteq \mathcal{B}_2$ of size $|\mathcal{S}_2| \le P + 2\Sigma_{\mathcal{T}} < \frac{26}{25} P$ such that*

$$|\mathcal{B}_2| \;\le\; P + r(|\mathcal{S}_2| + |\mathcal{E}_{\mathrm{enter}}| + |\mathcal{B}_3|) \;<\; (9C_{\mathrm{casc}} + 353)\, r\, P.$$

Proof. First separate $\mathcal{B}_2^{\mathrm{straddle}} := \{e = (x, y, z) \in \mathcal{B}_2 : \mathrm{sep}(s, x) = M + 1\}$; each such rotation at $\textsc{Pop}(s)$ satisfies $x \le \max B_M(s) < y$, which holds for at most one disjoint cascade pair per $\textsc{Pop}(s)$, so $|\mathcal{B}_2^{\mathrm{straddle}}| \le P$.

Every remaining rotation $e = (x, y, z) = (v_{2j-1}, v_{2j}, v_{2j+1}) \in \mathcal{B}_2 \setminus \mathcal{B}_2^{\mathrm{straddle}}$ during $\textsc{Pop}(s)$ satisfies $1 \le \ell_2 := \mathrm{sep}(x, y) < \ell_1 := \mathrm{sep}(s, x) \le M$, routing e to $\nu(e) := \mathrm{LCA}_{\mathcal{T}}(\ell_2, \ell_1) \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathrm{int}}$ and partitioning $\mathcal{B}_2 \setminus \mathcal{B}_2^{\mathrm{straddle}} = \bigsqcup_{\nu \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathrm{int}}} \mathcal{B}_2(\nu)$. Fix $\nu \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathrm{int}}$ with child scale intervals $(m_0, m_1], \ldots, (m_{k_\nu - 1}, m_{k_\nu}]$ ($m_{k_\nu} = M_{\mathrm{end}}(\nu)$): here $\ell_2 \in (m_{c_2 - 1}, m_{c_2}]$ and $\ell_1 \in (m_{c_1 - 1}, m_{c_1}]$ with $1 \le c_2 < c_1 \le k_\nu$. Let $Q_\nu^* := B_{m_{k_\nu}}(s) \in \mathcal{P}_{M_{\mathrm{end}}(\nu)}$ and define the right shell $\mathrm{Sh}_{c_2}^{(\nu)}(Q_\nu^*) := (\max B_{m_{c_2}}(Q_\nu^*), \max B_{m_{c_2 - 1}}(Q_\nu^*)]$. Because $m_{c_2 - 1} < \ell_2 \le m_{c_2} < \ell_1 \le m_{k_\nu}$, we have $B_{m_{c_2}}(s) = B_{m_{c_2}}(x) \ne B_{m_{c_2}}(y)$, $B_{m_{c_2 - 1}}(s) = B_{m_{c_2 - 1}}(x) = B_{m_{c_2 - 1}}(y)$, and $B_{m_{k_\nu}}(s) \ne B_{m_{k_\nu}}(x)$, so

$$\max Q_\nu^* \;<\; x \;\le\; \max B_{m_{c_2}}(Q_\nu^*) \;<\; y \;\le\; \max B_{m_{c_2 - 1}}(Q_\nu^*), \qquad \text{i.e., } y \in \mathrm{Sh}_{c_2}^{(\nu)}(Q_\nu^*).$$

Thus $x > \max Q_\nu^*$ stays active past all POPs in Q_ν^* and prevents any PUSH into $\mathrm{Sh}_{c_2}^{(\nu)}(Q_\nu^*)$ throughout $[s^+, (\max Q_\nu^*)^+]$:

- *Case 2A ($z > \max \mathrm{Sh}_{c_2}^{(\nu)}(Q_\nu^*)$):* Lemma 2.8(2) freezes $\mathrm{Sh}_{c_2}^{(\nu)}(Q_\nu^*) \subseteq (x, z)$ off $\mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H}_\tau)$ past $\textsc{Pop}(\max Q_\nu^*)$, occurring at most once per (Q_ν^*, c_2) ($\le k_\nu |\mathcal{P}_{M_{\mathrm{end}}(\nu)}|$ rotations).
- *Case 2B1 ($z \in \mathrm{Sh}_{c_2}^{(\nu)}(Q_\nu^*)$ and $j = h$):* at most 1 per $\textsc{Pop}(s)$ across disjoint $\{\mathcal{B}_2(\nu)\}_\nu$ ($\le P$ globally).
- *Case 2B2a ($z \in \mathrm{Sh}_{c_2}^{(\nu)}(Q_\nu^*)$, $j < h$, and $w := v_{2j+2} > \max \mathrm{Sh}_{c_2}^{(\nu)}(Q_\nu^*)$):* Lemma 2.8(2) on e and e^+ freezes $\mathrm{Sh}_{c_2}^{(\nu)}(Q_\nu^*) \setminus \{z\} \subseteq (x, z) \cup (z, v_{2j+3})$ off $\mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H}_\tau)$ past $\textsc{Pop}(\max Q_\nu^*)$ with zero insertions, occurring at most once per (Q_ν^*, c_2) ($\le k_\nu |\mathcal{P}_{M_{\mathrm{end}}(\nu)}|$ rotations).

Collecting Cases 2A, 2B1, and 2B2a into $\mathcal{S}_2$ gives $|\mathcal{S}_2| \le P + 2\Sigma_\mathcal{T} < \frac{26}{25} P$ by Lemma 4.3. Every remaining $e \in (\mathcal{B}_2 \setminus \mathcal{B}_2^{\mathrm{straddle}}) \setminus \mathcal{S}_2$ (*Case 2B2b*: $j < h$ and $z, w \in \mathrm{Sh}_{c_2}^{(\nu)}(Q_\nu^*)$) has $e^+ = (z, w, v_{2j+3})$ satisfying $\ell_1^+ := \mathrm{sep}(s, z) \in (m_{c_2-1}, m_{c_2}]$ and $\ell_2^+ := \mathrm{sep}(z, w) > m_{c_2-1}$: if $\ell_2^+ > \ell_1^+$, then $e^+ \in \mathcal{B}_1 \sqcup \mathcal{B}_{\mathrm{leaf,pre}}$ (since $s \le \max B_{m_{c_2}}(Q_\nu^*) < \min B_M(z)$ when $\ell_2^+ = M+1$) so $e \in \mathcal{E}_{\mathrm{enter}}$; if $\ell_2^+ = \ell_1^+$, then $e^+ \in \mathcal{B}_3$; and if $m_{c_2-1} < \ell_2^+ < \ell_1^+ \le m_{c_2}$, then $e^+ \in \mathcal{B}_2(\nu^+)$ for $\nu^+ := \mathrm{LCA}_\mathcal{T}(\ell_2^+, \ell_1^+)$, which lies inside ν's c_2-th child subtree and is therefore a *strict proper descendant* of ν ($0 \le \delta(\nu) < \delta(\nu^+) \le r - 1$).

Retaining only cascade edges $e \to e^+$ emitted by vertices $e \in (\mathcal{B}_2 \setminus \mathcal{B}_2^{\mathrm{straddle}}) \setminus (\mathcal{S}_2 \cup \mathcal{E}_{\mathrm{enter}})$, every edge enters $\mathcal{B}_3$ or remains in $\mathcal{B}_2 \setminus \mathcal{B}_2^{\mathrm{straddle}}$ while strictly increasing $\delta(\nu) \in \{0, \dots, r-1\}$, so every maximal directed path contains at most r vertices of $\mathcal{B}_2 \setminus \mathcal{B}_2^{\mathrm{straddle}}$ and terminates at a distinct vertex in $\mathcal{S}_2 \cup ((\mathcal{B}_2 \setminus \mathcal{B}_2^{\mathrm{straddle}}) \cap \mathcal{E}_{\mathrm{enter}}) \cup \mathcal{B}_3$. Combining Lemmas 4.5(2) and 4.11 with $r \ge 1$ yields $|\mathcal{B}_2| \le P + r(|\mathcal{S}_2| + |\mathcal{E}_{\mathrm{enter}}| + |\mathcal{B}_3|) < (1 + \frac{77}{25} + 9C_{\mathrm{casc}} + 348) rP < (9C_{\mathrm{casc}} + 353) rP$. □

We now assemble Theorem 4.2. Notice that our constant dependencies form the strict DAG

$$\Sigma_\mathcal{T} \longrightarrow \mathcal{S}_1 \longrightarrow \mathcal{E}_{\mathrm{enter}} \longrightarrow \mathcal{B}_{3,\mathrm{intra}} \longrightarrow \Big(A_{\mathrm{esc}}, \sum_{\ell=1}^{M} |U_\ell|\Big) \longrightarrow \sum_{\ell,X,p} |\widetilde{\mathcal{N}}_p^{(\ell)}| \longrightarrow \mathcal{B}_3 \longrightarrow \mathcal{B}_2,$$

with every intermediate constant completely independent of P, r, M, and $\mathcal{T}$.

Proof of Theorem 4.2. (1) Partitioning $\mathcal{R}_{\mathrm{int}}(\widetilde{H}) = \mathcal{B}_{\mathrm{leaf}} \sqcup \mathcal{B}_1 \sqcup \mathcal{B}_2 \sqcup \mathcal{B}_3$ and summing Lemmas 4.4, 4.5(1), 4.11, and 4.12 using $r \ge 1$ gives

$$\begin{aligned} J(\widetilde{H}) &= |\mathcal{B}_{\mathrm{leaf}}| + |\mathcal{B}_1| + |\mathcal{B}_3| + |\mathcal{B}_2| \\ &\le 2P + \sum_{Q \in \mathcal{P}_M} J(\widetilde{H}^{(Q)}) + 3\,r\,P + (9C_{\mathrm{casc}} + 348)\,P + (9C_{\mathrm{casc}} + 353)\,r\,P \\ &\le (18C_{\mathrm{casc}} + 706)\,r\,P + \sum_{Q \in \mathcal{P}_M} J(\widetilde{H}^{(Q)}), \end{aligned}$$

proving part (1) with $C_{\mathrm{pass}} := 18C_{\mathrm{casc}} + 706$.

(2) For $1 \le P \le 3$, every $\textsc{Pop}(s)$ has $|V_{s^-}| \le 3$, so $k \le 2$ and $h = \max(0, \lfloor (k-1)/2 \rfloor) = 0$, giving $J(\widetilde{H}) = 0$. Induct on $P \ge 4$ using the single-level ($M = 1$) bisection $\mathcal{P}_1 := \{Q_1, Q_2\}$ with $Q_1 := [1, \lfloor P/2 \rfloor]$ and $Q_2 := [\lfloor P/2 \rfloor + 1, P]$ ($|Q_1|, |Q_2| \ge 2$ and $\lceil \log_2 |Q_q| \rceil \le \lceil \log_2 \lceil P/2 \rceil \rceil = \lceil \log_2 P \rceil - 1$). Here $\mathcal{B}_1 = \emptyset$ ($1 \le \mathrm{sep}(s, x) < \mathrm{sep}(x, y) \le 1$ is impossible) and $\mathcal{B}_3 = \emptyset$ ($|\mathcal{P}_1| = 2$ cannot place $s < x < y$ in three distinct blocks). Every rotation $e = (v_{2j-1}, v_{2j}, v_{2j+1}) \in \mathcal{B}_2 \sqcup \mathcal{B}_{\mathrm{leaf,exit}}$ at $\textsc{Pop}(s)$ satisfies $v_{2j+1} \le P = \max Q_2$, forcing $s \in Q_1 \setminus \{\max Q_1\}$ ($s < v_1 \le \max Q_1 < v_{2j+1}$); letting $v_{t^*} = \max(\mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H}_{s^-}) \cap Q_1)$, at most one rotation (either $[v_{t^*}, v_{t^*+1}] \in \mathcal{B}_2$ if t^* is odd, or $[v_{t^*-1}, v_{t^*}] \in \mathcal{B}_{\mathrm{leaf,exit}}$ if $t^* \ge 2$ is even) occurs per $\textsc{Pop}(s)$, so $|\mathcal{B}_2 \sqcup \mathcal{B}_{\mathrm{leaf,exit}}| \le |Q_1| - 1$. Meanwhile

each $e = (x, y, z) \in \mathcal{B}_{\text{leaf,pre}}$ requires $s < \min Q_2 \le x < y \in Q_2$, freezing $y \in Q_2 \setminus \{\min Q_2\}$ off $\mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H})$ until $\textsc{Pop}(x)$ ($x \in Q_2$), so $|\mathcal{B}_{\text{leaf,pre}}| \le |Q_2| - 1$. Applying Lemma 4.4's subprocess projection to Q_1, Q_2 and the induction hypothesis gives

$$J(\widetilde{H}) \;\le\; (|Q_1|-1)+(|Q_2|-1)+\sum_{q=1}^{2}|Q_q|(\lceil\log_2 P\rceil-2) \;=\; P(\lceil\log_2 P\rceil-1)-2 \;<\; P(\lceil\log_2 P\rceil-1).\ \square$$

5 Arithmetic Scale-Tree Construction and Proof of Theorem 1.4

5.1 The Arithmetic Scale-Tree Problem and Contraction Bound

Theorem 4.2 reduces bounding $J(\widetilde{H})$ to a purely arithmetic integer design problem involving no BSTs, rotations, or deque operations: given integers $P \ge 1$ and $r \ge 1$, construct a rooted ordered tree $\mathcal{T}$ of height at most r with edge multipliers $4c^2$ whose leaves $\ell = 1, \dots, M$ in left-to-right order satisfy $S_\ell = w_\ell(\alpha_0(2S_{\ell-1}) + 1)^2 \le \frac{1}{2}S_{\ell-1}$ ($S_0 = P$) and make the finest block bound $2S_M$ as small as possible.

Theorem 5.1 (Variable-Depth Scale-Tree Contraction Bound)**.** *There exists an absolute constant $C_0 \ge 6$ (independent of P and r) such that for all integers $P \ge 1$ and $r \ge 1$, either $P < \frac{1}{2}\big(\max(\alpha_r(P), 2^{C_0^{2r}})\big)^{6^r}$ already, or there exists a scale tree $\mathcal{T}$ of height at most r validly partitioning $\{1, \dots, P\}$ whose finest block bound satisfies*

$$2S_M \;\le\; \Big(\max\big(\alpha_r(P),\ 2^{C_0^{2r}}\big)\Big)^{6^r}.$$

In particular, at $r = \alpha_\omega(P)$ (where $\alpha_r(P) \le 2 < 2^{C_0^{2r}}$ and $6^r C_0^{2r} \le C_0^{3r}$) we obtain sub-blocks of size $< 2^{C_0^{3r}}$, and at $r = 1$ on any $N_0 \ge 1$ we obtain sub-blocks of size $< \max\big(\alpha_1(N_0), 2^{C_0^2}\big)^6$.

Example (exact weight reset in BuildScaleTree at $r = 2$ and three-pass assembly). To see concretely how resetting child indices lets a height-2 tree continue shrinking after a flat leaf loop stalls, trace $\textsc{BuildScaleTree}(0, 1, P)$ (Section 5.2) at $r = 2$ on $P := A_m(1)$ with $m := A_6(1) - 1$ (Figure 5, top):

- Since $A_m(1) < 2P \le A_m(2) = A_{m+1}(1)$, we have $\alpha_0(2S_0) = A_6(1)$ and $i_1 = A_6(1) + 1$. Under the root's first child ν_1 ($c_1 = 1$, $W = 4$), leaf $c_2 = 1$ sets $w_1 = 16$ and $S_1 = 16(A_6(1)+1)^2 \le \frac{1}{2}P$; since $A_6(1) < 2S_1 < A_7(1)$, leaf $c_2 = 2$ has $i_2 = \alpha_0(2S_1) + 1 = 8$, $w_2 = 64$, and $S_2 = 64 \cdot 8^2 = 4{,}096 \le \frac{1}{2}S_1$; iteration $c_2 = 3$ then stalls because $w_{\text{cand}} = 4 \cdot 3^2 \cdot 4 = 144$ and $i_{\text{cand}} = \alpha_0(8{,}192) + 1 = 5$ give $S_{\text{cand}} = 144 \cdot 25 = 3{,}600 > 2{,}048 = \frac{1}{2}S_2$.
- Branching to the root's second child ν_2 ($c_1 = 2$, $W = 16$) *resets* the leaf index to $c_2 = 1$, dropping the candidate weight from 144 down to $w_3 = 4 \cdot 1^2 \cdot 16 = 64$ so that $S_3 = 64 \cdot 5^2 = 1{,}600 \le 2{,}048 = \frac{1}{2}S_2$ succeeds before halting at $M = 3$ with $S_{\text{out}} = 1{,}600$.

Proof overview. Given $P \ge 1$ and target height $r \ge 1$, our top-down greedy procedure BuildScaleTree (Section 5.2) builds a scale tree $\mathcal{T}$ of height at most r whose leaf parent depth $\delta = r - 1$ greedily appends scales until $S_{\text{cand}} > \frac{1}{2}S_{\text{curr}}$ (contracting block size $S \mapsto \text{poly}(W, \alpha_1(S))$), while each internal depth $\delta = r - q$ ($q \ge 2$) loops over $2\,\alpha_q(S_{\text{in}})$ children so every consecutive pair $(2m - 1, 2m)$ of children decreases $\alpha_q(S_{\text{curr}})$ by at least 1 (Lemma 5.2 in Section 5.3). Using only Definition 1.1, Definition 4.1, and Lemma A.1, Section 5.3 proves Theorem 5.1, and Section 5.4 then combines Theorems 2.2, 4.2, and 5.1 to prove Theorem 1.4.

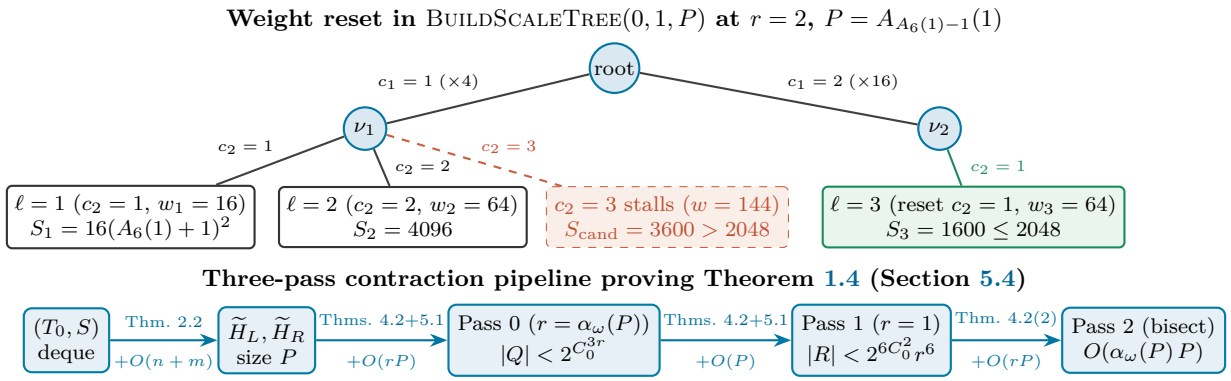


Figure 5: Top: exact trace of BuildScaleTree at $r = 2$ showing how resetting $c_2 = 1$ under sibling ν_2 drops the candidate weight from 144 to 64 so contraction continues past $S_2 = 4096$ to $S_3 = 1600$. Bottom: chaining Sections 2, 4, and 5 across three passes proves Theorem 1.4.

5.2 The Recursive Scale-Tree Builder BuildScaleTree

Fix integers $r \geq 1$ and $P \geq 1$. To construct a valid height-r scale tree top-down, we initialize the global scale counter $M := 0$ and coarse block parameters $S_0 := P$ and $\mathcal{P}_0 := \{\{1, \ldots, P\}\}$, and call $(\tau_{\text{root}}, S_{\text{out}}) := \text{BuildScaleTree}(0, 1, P)$ at the root. Each recursive call $\text{BuildScaleTree}(\delta, W, S_{\text{in}})$ takes the current tree depth $\delta \in \{0, \ldots, r-1\}$, the accumulated path weight $W \geq 1$ from the root, and the current block-size bound $S_{\text{in}} \geq 1$, and returns a pair (τ, S_{out}) consisting of either $\tau = \text{EMPTY}$ (when not even one new leaf scale fits under $\frac{1}{2}S_{\text{in}}$) or a non-empty subtree τ, together with the resulting finest block-size bound $S_{\text{out}} \geq 1$. At leaf-parent depth $\delta = r-1$, it greedily appends leaf scales $c = 1, 2, \ldots$ as long as the candidate size $S_{\text{cand}} = 4c^2 W(\alpha_0(2S_{\text{curr}})+1)^2$ shrinks by at least half; at shallower internal depths $0 \leq \delta \leq r-2$ ($q = r - \delta \geq 2$), it sequentially builds up to $2\,\alpha_q(S_{\text{in}})$ child subtrees (each resetting its own child counter from 1) until a child stalls:

Procedure $\text{BuildScaleTree}(\delta, W, S_{\text{in}})$ $\quad (\delta \in \{0, \ldots, r-1\},\ W \geq 1,\ S_{\text{in}} \geq 1)$

- **Base depth $\delta = r - 1$ ($q := r - \delta = 1$):** Set $S_{\text{curr}} := S_{\text{in}}$. For $c = 1, 2, \ldots$:
  1. Set $w_{\text{cand}} := 4c^2 W$, $i_{\text{cand}} := \alpha_0(2S_{\text{curr}}) + 1$, and $S_{\text{cand}} := w_{\text{cand}}\, i_{\text{cand}}^2$.
  2. If $S_{\text{cand}} \leq \frac{1}{2}S_{\text{curr}}$, increment $M \leftarrow M + 1$, append leaf scale M with parameters $(w_M, i_M, S_M) := (w_{\text{cand}}, i_{\text{cand}}, S_{\text{cand}})$, and update $S_{\text{curr}} \leftarrow S_{\text{cand}}$.
  3. Otherwise ($S_{\text{cand}} > \frac{1}{2}S_{\text{curr}}$), stop the loop: if $c = 1$, return $(\text{EMPTY}, S_{\text{curr}})$; if $c \geq 2$, return (ν, S_{curr}), where ν is an internal node whose ordered children are the $c - 1$ leaves appended during this call.
- **Internal depth $0 \leq \delta \leq r - 2$ ($q := r - \delta \geq 2$):** Set $m^* := \alpha_q(S_{\text{in}}) \geq 1$, $S_{\text{curr}} := S_{\text{in}}$, and an empty ordered child list $\mathcal{C} := []$. For $c = 1, 2, \ldots, 2m^*$:
  1. Call $(\nu_c, S_{\text{next}}) := \text{BuildScaleTree}(\delta + 1, 4c^2 W, S_{\text{curr}})$.
  2. If $\nu_c = \text{EMPTY}$, break out of the loop; otherwise append ν_c to $\mathcal{C}$ and update $S_{\text{curr}} \leftarrow S_{\text{next}}$.

  Return $(\text{EMPTY}, S_{\text{curr}})$ if $\mathcal{C}$ is empty, and otherwise return (ν, S_{curr}), where ν is an internal node with ordered children $\mathcal{C}$.

Termination and structural validity. Every leaf appended at $\delta = r-1$ has $w_{\text{cand}} \geq 4$ and $i_{\text{cand}} \geq 2$, so $16 \leq S_{\text{cand}} \leq \frac{1}{2} S_{\text{curr}}$. In particular, on any call $\textsc{BuildScaleTree}(\delta, W, S_{\text{in}})$ starting with global counter ℓ_0, if $L_{\text{loc}} \geq 1$ leaves $\ell_0+1, \ldots, \ell_0+L_{\text{loc}}$ are appended during that call, their size bounds satisfy $S_{\text{in}} \geq 2S_{\ell_0+1} \geq \cdots \geq 2^{L_{\text{loc}}} S_{\ell_0+L_{\text{loc}}} \geq 16 \cdot 2^{L_{\text{loc}}}$ (while if $L_{\text{loc}} = 0$ then $S_{\text{out}} = S_{\text{in}} \geq 1$); hence the unbounded loop at $\delta = r-1$ always terminates, $1 \leq S_{\text{out}} \leq S_{\text{in}}$, and $\tau = \text{EMPTY}$ if and only if $L_{\text{loc}} = 0$ (in which case $S_{\text{out}} = S_{\text{in}}$).

At the root call $(\tau_{\text{root}}, S_{\text{out}}) := \textsc{BuildScaleTree}(0, 1, P)$, either $M = 0$ and $\tau_{\text{root}} = \text{EMPTY}$, or $M \geq 1$ and $\mathcal{T} := \tau_{\text{root}} \neq \text{EMPTY}$. Whenever $M \geq 1$, every internal node created at depth $\delta \in \{0, \ldots, r-2\}$ has a non-empty list $\mathcal{C}$ of depth-$(\delta+1)$ children, and every internal node created at depth $r-1$ has $c-1 \geq 1$ leaf children at depth r. Because children are visited in left-to-right order and M increments sequentially as leaves are created, the leaves of $\mathcal{T}$ in left-to-right order are precisely $1, \ldots, M$, each at depth $\delta(\ell) = r \in \{1, \ldots, r\}$, so $\mathcal{T}$ is a scale tree of height r (hence at most r). By induction on depth, any call reached from the root along child indices $(c_1, \ldots, c_\delta)$ receives $W = \prod_{t=1}^{\delta}(4c_t^2)$, so each leaf ℓ receives $w_\ell = 4c_r^2 W = \prod_{t=1}^{r}(4c_t^2)$, matching Definition 4.1. Finally, S_{curr} equals $S_{\ell-1}$ immediately before leaf ℓ is appended, so every $\ell \in \{1, \ldots, M\}$ satisfies

$$i_\ell \;=\; \alpha_0(2S_{\ell-1}) + 1 \qquad \text{and} \qquad S_\ell \;=\; w_\ell\, i_\ell^2 \;\leq\; \frac{1}{2} S_{\ell-1}$$

(with $S_M = S_{\text{out}} \leq 2^{-M} P$, so $M \leq \lfloor \log_2 P \rfloor$). Splitting each $X \in \mathcal{P}_{\ell-1}$ ($|X| \in [S_{\ell-1}, 2S_{\ell-1})$) into $K_X := \lfloor |X|/S_\ell \rfloor \geq 2$ contiguous sub-blocks of size S_ℓ (with last sub-block in $[S_\ell, 2S_\ell)$) therefore yields nested partitions $\mathcal{P}_0 \succ \mathcal{P}_1 \succ \cdots \succ \mathcal{P}_M$, and $\mathcal{T}$ validly partitions $\{1, \ldots, P\}$ in the sense of Definition 4.1.

5.3 Degree-6 Contraction Analysis: Proof of Theorem 5.1

Lemma 5.2 (Contraction and Empty-Return Bounds for $\textsc{BuildScaleTree}$)**.** *Fix integers $r \geq 1$ and $P \geq 1$, and set $C_0 := 6$ and $C_q := 2^{C_0^{2q}} = 2^{36^q}$ for $q \in \{1, \ldots, r\}$.*

(1) (Empty-return bound) *Whenever a call $\textsc{BuildScaleTree}(\delta', W', S')$ ($\delta' \in \{0, \ldots, r-1\}$, $q' := r - \delta' \geq 1$, $W' \geq 1$, $S' \geq 1$) returns (EMPTY, S'), the integer $w := 2S'$ satisfies*

$$w \;<\; 4^{q'+1}\, W' \left(\alpha_0(w) + 1\right)^2.$$

(2) (Degree-6 contraction) *For every $\delta \in \{0, \ldots, r-1\}$ ($q := r - \delta \in \{1, \ldots, r\}$), $W \geq 1$, and $S_{\text{in}} \geq 1$, the output (τ, S_{out}) of $\textsc{BuildScaleTree}(\delta, W, S_{\text{in}})$ satisfies*

$$2S_{\text{out}} \;\leq\; \Big(\max\left(W,\; \alpha_q(S_{\text{in}}),\; C_q\right)\Big)^{6^q}.$$

Proof. We first prove (1) by induction on $q' = r - \delta' \geq 1$. At $q' = 1$ ($\delta' = r-1$), the call $\textsc{BuildScaleTree}(r-1, W', S')$ returns EMPTY only if iteration $c = 1$ immediately stops with $S_{\text{curr}} = S'$, meaning $w_{\text{cand}} = 4W'$, $i_{\text{cand}} = \alpha_0(w) + 1$, and $S_{\text{cand}} = 4W'(\alpha_0(w)+1)^2 > \frac{1}{2}S' = \frac{1}{4}w$, i.e., $w < 16W'(\alpha_0(w)+1)^2 = 4^{q'+1}W'(\alpha_0(w)+1)^2$. For $q' \geq 2$, since $m^* = \alpha_{q'}(S') \geq 1$, iteration $c = 1$ always runs and calls $\textsc{BuildScaleTree}(\delta'+1, 4W', S')$; the parent call returns EMPTY only if this first child returns EMPTY, so the $(q'-1)$-hypothesis gives $w < 4^{q'}(4W')(\alpha_0(w)+1)^2 = 4^{q'+1}W'(\alpha_0(w)+1)^2$.

Before proving (2), observe that for every integer $w \geq 2^{216}$, Lemma A.1(1) gives $\alpha_0(w) + 1 < \log_2 w + 2$, and setting $z := \log_2 w \geq 216$ and $g(z) := \frac{z}{6}\ln 2 - 2\ln(z+2)$, we have $(216+2)^2 = 47{,}524 < 2^{36} = 2^{216/6}$ (so $g(216) > 0$) and $g'(z) = \frac{\ln 2}{6} - \frac{2}{z+2} > \frac{0.69}{6} - \frac{2}{218} > 0$ for all $z \geq 216$, whence

$$\left(\alpha_0(w) + 1\right)^2 \;<\; \left(\log_2 w + 2\right)^2 \;<\; w^{1/6} \qquad \text{for all integers } w \geq 2^{216}. \tag{7}$$

We now prove (2) by induction on $q = r - \delta \in \{1, \dots, r\}$.

Base case $q = 1$ ($\delta = r - 1$, $C_1 = 2^{36}$). Set $B := \max(W, \alpha_1(S_{\text{in}}), 2^{36}) \geq 2^{36}$. Let ℓ_0 be the global leaf count on entry and $L_{\text{loc}} \geq 0$ be the number of leaves $\ell_0 + 1, \dots, \ell_0 + L_{\text{loc}}$ appended during this call; write $\widehat{S}_0 := S_{\text{in}}$ and $\widehat{S}_c := S_{\ell_0 + c}$ for $1 \leq c \leq L_{\text{loc}}$ (so $S_{\text{out}} = \widehat{S}_{L_{\text{loc}}}$), and set $u_c := \alpha_0(2\widehat{S}_c)$ ($0 \leq c \leq L_{\text{loc}}$). By Lemma A.1(2), $M^* := \alpha_1(2S_{\text{in}}) \leq \alpha_1(S_{\text{in}}) + 1 \leq B + 1$. If $M^* = 1$, then (1) gives $2S_{\text{out}} \leq 2S_{\text{in}} \leq 4 < B^6$. Assume henceforth $M^* \geq 2$, and set $f(u) := \alpha_0(u) + 1$. Whenever $1 \leq c \leq L_{\text{loc}}$ and $u_{c-1} \geq \max(W, c, 5)$, we have $W \leq u_{c-1}$, $c \leq u_{c-1}$, and $u_{c-1} + 1 \leq 2u_{c-1}$, so

$$2\widehat{S}_c \;=\; 8Wc^2(u_{c-1}+1)^2 \;\leq\; 8u_{c-1}^3(u_{c-1}+1)^2 \;\leq\; 32u_{c-1}^5 \;<\; 2^{20}u_{c-1}^6,$$

and Lemma A.1(3) ($u_{c-1} \geq 5$) yields $u_c = \alpha_0(2\widehat{S}_c) \leq \alpha_0(2^{20}u_{c-1}^6) \leq \alpha_0(u_{c-1}) + 1 = f(u_{c-1})$.

- *Case 1 ($L_{\text{loc}} \geq M^*$):* We claim there exists $c_0 \in \{0, \dots, M^* - 1\}$ with $u_{c_0} \leq \max(W, c_0 + 1, 4)$. Indeed, if $u_{c-1} < \max(W, c, 5)$ for some $1 \leq c \leq M^* - 1$, then $c_0 := c - 1$ satisfies $u_{c_0} \leq \max(W, c_0 + 1, 4)$; otherwise $u_{c-1} \geq \max(W, c, 5)$ holds for every $1 \leq c \leq M^* - 1$, so iterating $u_c \leq f(u_{c-1})$ and applying Lemma A.1(3) (together with $2S_{\text{in}} \leq F_1(M^*) = F_0^{(M^*-1)}(4) \implies \alpha_0^{(M^*-1)}(2S_{\text{in}}) \leq 4$ from Lemma A.1(2)) gives

  $$u_{M^*-1} \;\leq\; f^{(M^*-1)}(u_0) \;\leq\; \alpha_0^{(M^*-1)}(\alpha_0(2S_{\text{in}})) + 2 \;=\; \alpha_0^{(M^*)}(2S_{\text{in}}) + 2 \;\leq\; \alpha_0(4) + 2 \;=\; 4,$$

  so $c_0 := M^* - 1$ satisfies $u_{c_0} \leq 4 \leq \max(W, c_0 + 1, 4)$. Since $c_0 + 1 \leq M^* \leq \min(L_{\text{loc}}, B + 1)$ and $u_{c_0} \leq \max(W, c_0 + 1, 4) \leq B + 1$, monotonicity $\widehat{S}_{L_{\text{loc}}} \leq \widehat{S}_{c_0+1}$ and $B \geq 2^{36}$ give

  $$2S_{\text{out}} \;\leq\; 2\widehat{S}_{c_0+1} \;=\; 8W(c_0+1)^2(u_{c_0}+1)^2 \;\leq\; 8B(B+1)^2(B+2)^2 \;<\; B^6.$$

- *Case 2 ($L_{\text{loc}} \leq M^* - 1$):* The loop stops at $c = L_{\text{loc}} + 1 \leq M^* \leq B + 1$ with $S_{\text{curr}} = S_{\text{out}}$, so $w := 2S_{\text{out}}$ satisfies

  $$w \;<\; 4S_{\text{cand}} \;=\; 16W(L_{\text{loc}}+1)^2\big(\alpha_0(w)+1\big)^2 \;\leq\; 16B(B+1)^2\big(\alpha_0(w)+1\big)^2.$$

  If $w < 2^{216}$, then $w < (2^{36})^6 \leq B^6$. If $w \geq 2^{216}$, then (7) gives $(\alpha_0(w) + 1)^2 < w^{1/6}$, so $w^{5/6} < 16B(B+1)^2 < B^5$ (as $B \geq 2^{36}$) and hence $w < B^6$.

Inductive step $q \geq 2$ ($\delta = r - q$, $C_q = 2^{36^q} \geq 2^{1296}$). Set $m^* := \alpha_q(S_{\text{in}}) \geq 1$, $B_q := \max(W, m^*, C_q) \geq 2^{1296}$, and $M_{\text{floor}} := \max\big(16W(m^*)^2, C_q\big)$. Since $W, m^* \leq B_q$ and $B_q \geq 2^{1296}$, we have $M_{\text{floor}} \leq 16B_q^3 < B_q^6$ and thus $M_{\text{floor}}^{6^{q-1}} < B_q^{6^q}$.

- If $m^* = 1$, then (1) gives $S_{\text{in}} \leq 4$, so $2S_{\text{out}} \leq 2S_{\text{in}} \leq 8 < B_q^{6^q}$.
- If $m^* \geq 2$ and some child $c \in \{1, \dots, 2m^*\}$ returns EMPTY, let c be the first such child, so S_{out} equals that child's input S' and its weight is $W_c = 4c^2W \leq 16W(m^*)^2 \leq 16B_q^3$ at depth $\delta + 1$ ($q' = q - 1$). By (1), $w := 2S_{\text{out}} < 4^q W_c(\alpha_0(w) + 1)^2 \leq 16 \cdot 4^q B_q^3(\alpha_0(w) + 1)^2$. If $w < 2^{216}$, then $w < 2^{1296} \leq B_q < B_q^{6^q}$; if $w \geq 2^{216}$, then (7) and $16 \cdot 4^q = 2^{4+2q} < 2^{2 \cdot 36^q} = C_q^2 \leq B_q^2$ give $w^{5/6} < 16 \cdot 4^q B_q^3 < B_q^5$, so $w < B_q^6 < B_q^{6^q}$.
- Otherwise $m^* \geq 2$ and all $2m^*$ children return non-EMPTY nodes, producing $S_{\text{in}} =: S^{(0)} \geq S^{(1)} \geq \cdots \geq S^{(2m^*)} = S_{\text{out}}$, where each child $c \in \{1, \dots, 2m^*\}$ runs at depth $\delta + 1$ ($q - 1 \geq 1$) with weight $W_c = 4c^2W \leq 16W(m^*)^2 \leq M_{\text{floor}}$ (and $C_{q-1} < C_q \leq M_{\text{floor}}$). Suppose for contradiction that $2S_{\text{out}} > M_{\text{floor}}^{6^{q-1}}$; then $2S^{(c)} > M_{\text{floor}}^{6^{q-1}}$ for every $0 \leq c \leq 2m^*$.

Fix any $m \in \{1, \dots, m^* - 1\}$. Applying the $(q-1)$-hypothesis to child $2m-1$ gives

$$M_{\text{floor}}^{6^{q-1}} \;<\; 2S^{(2m-1)} \;\le\; \Big(\max\big(M_{\text{floor}},\ \alpha_{q-1}(S^{(2m-2)})\big)\Big)^{6^{q-1}},$$

forcing $s_m := \alpha_{q-1}(S^{(2m-2)}) > M_{\text{floor}} \ge 2^{36^q}$ and $2S^{(2m-1)} \le s_m^{6^{q-1}}$. Write $x := \log_2 s_m > 36^q \ge 1296$. Since $6^{q-1}x > 6 \cdot 1296 > 5$, we have $S^{(2m-1)} + 16 \le \frac{1}{2}s_m^{6^{q-1}} + 16 < s_m^{6^{q-1}} = 2^{6^{q-1}x}$, so Lemma A.1(2) (with $\log_2 6 < 3$) gives

$$\alpha_{q-1}(S^{(2m-1)}) \le \alpha_1(S^{(2m-1)}) \le \log_2\log_2(S^{(2m-1)}+16)+2 < \log_2(6^{q-1}x)+2 < \log_2 x + 3q + 1.$$

Because $x > 36^q \ge 1296$ implies $\log_2 x > q\log_2 36 > 5q$ (and $\log_2 x > 10$), we have $3q+1 < \frac{3}{5}\log_2 x + 1 < \log_2 x$, whence $\log_2 x + 3q + 1 < 2\log_2 x$. Moreover, $h(z) := z^{1/2} - 2\log_2 z$ satisfies $h(1296) > 36 - 22 > 0$ (as $1296 < 2^{11}$) and $h'(z) = \frac{z^{1/2} - 4/\ln 2}{2z} > 0$ for all $z \ge 1296$, so $2\log_2 x < x^{1/2}$ and thus $\alpha_{q-1}(S^{(2m-1)}) < x^{1/2}$.

Applying the $(q-1)$-hypothesis to child $2m$ (where $2S^{(2m)} > M_{\text{floor}}^{6^{q-1}}$) similarly forces the inequality $\alpha_{q-1}(S^{(2m-1)}) > M_{\text{floor}}$ and

$$2S^{(2m)} \;\le\; \big(\alpha_{q-1}(S^{(2m-1)})\big)^{6^{q-1}} \;<\; (x^{1/2})^{6^{q-1}} \;=\; 2^{\frac{1}{2}6^{q-1}\log_2 x}.$$

Since $6^q = (36^q)^{1/2} < x^{1/2}$ and $\log_2 x < \frac{1}{2}x^{1/2}$, we obtain $\frac{1}{2}6^{q-1}\log_2 x = \frac{1}{12}6^q \log_2 x < \frac{1}{24}x < x$, whence $S^{(2m)} < 2S^{(2m)} < 2^x = s_m = \alpha_{q-1}(S^{(2m-2)})$. Because $S^{(2m-2)} > \frac{1}{2}M_{\text{floor}}^{6^{q-1}} > 4$, recursion (1) and monotonicity of α_q give $\alpha_q(S^{(2m-2)}) = 1 + \alpha_q(s_m) \ge 1 + \alpha_q(S^{(2m)})$. Summing over $m = 1, \dots, m^* - 1$ yields

$$1 \;\le\; \alpha_q(S^{(2m^*-2)}) \;\le\; \alpha_q(S^{(0)}) - (m^* - 1) \;=\; 1,$$

forcing $S^{(2m^*-2)} \le 4$ and contradicting $2S^{(2m^*-2)} > M_{\text{floor}}^{6^{q-1}} > 8$.

Hence $2S_{\text{out}} \le M_{\text{floor}}^{6^{q-1}} < B_q^{6^q}$ in all cases, completing the induction. □

Proof of Theorem 5.1. Take $C_0 := 6$ and execute $(\tau_{\text{root}}, S_{\text{out}}) := \textsc{BuildScaleTree}(0, 1, P)$ with height parameter $r \ge 1$ ($\delta = 0$, $W = 1$, $q = r$, and $C_r = 2^{C_0^{2r}} = 2^{36^r}$). If $\tau_{\text{root}} = \text{EMPTY}$ ($M = 0$), Lemma 5.2(1) gives $w := 2P < 4^{r+1}(\alpha_0(w)+1)^2$. Either $w < 2^{216} \le 2^{216^r}$ or $w \ge 2^{216}$, where (7) yields $w^{5/6} < 4^{r+1} = 2^{2(r+1)}$ and hence $w < 2^{12(r+1)/5} < 2^{216^r}$; since $216^r = 6^r \cdot 36^r = 6^r C_0^{2r}$, both cases give

$$2P \;=\; w \;<\; (2^{C_0^{2r}})^{6^r} \;\le\; \Big(\max\big(\alpha_r(P),\ 2^{C_0^{2r}}\big)\Big)^{6^r}, \qquad \text{i.e.,} \qquad P \;<\; \frac{1}{2}\Big(\max\big(\alpha_r(P),\ 2^{C_0^{2r}}\big)\Big)^{6^r}.$$

Otherwise $M \ge 1$; as verified in Section 5.2, $\mathcal{T} := \tau_{\text{root}}$ is a scale tree of height at most r validly partitioning $\{1, \dots, P\}$ with $S_M = S_{\text{out}}$, and Lemma 5.2(2) at $(0, 1, P)$ gives $2S_M \le \big(\max(\alpha_r(P), 2^{C_0^{2r}})\big)^{6^r}$.

In particular, at $r = \alpha_\omega(P)$ we have $\alpha_r(P) \le 2 < 2^{C_0^{2r}}$ and $(2^{C_0^{2r}})^{6^r} = 2^{6^r C_0^{2r}} = 2^{C_0^{3r}}$ (for $C_0 = 6$), so either $P < \frac{1}{2} \cdot 2^{C_0^{3r}} < 2^{C_0^{3r}}$ already or every leaf block $Q \in \mathcal{P}_M$ satisfies $|Q| < 2S_M \le 2^{C_0^{3r}}$; likewise, at $r = 1$ on any $N_0 \ge 1$, either $N_0 < \frac{1}{2}\max(\alpha_1(N_0), 2^{C_0^2})^6$ already or every leaf block has size $< 2S_M \le \max(\alpha_1(N_0), 2^{C_0^2})^6$. □

5.4 Three-Pass Cleanup: Proof of Theorem 1.4

Combining Theorems 2.2, 4.2, and 5.1 immediately yields Theorem 1.4:

Proof of Theorem 1.4. For any folded Pop process $\widetilde{H}$ of size $P \geq 1$, set $r := \alpha_\omega(P) \geq 1$:

(1) *Pass 0 (height r):* Applying Theorem 5.1 and Theorem 4.2(1) at height r (treating $\{\widetilde{H}\}$ itself as a single subprocess at 0 pass cost when $P < \frac{1}{2}\big(\max(\alpha_r(P), 2^{C_0^{2r}})\big)^{6^r}$) pays at most $C_{\text{pass}}\, r\, P$ and decomposes $\widetilde{H}$ into folded Pop processes $\{\widetilde{H}^{(Q)}\}$ of sizes $1 \leq N_0 := |Q| < 2^{C_0^{3r}}$ with $\sum_Q |Q| = P$.

(2) *Pass 1 (height 1):* Since $C_0 \geq 6$ and $r \geq 1$ give $N_0 + 16 < 2^{C_0^{3r}+1} \leq 2^{2C_0^{3r}}$, Lemma A.1 yields $\alpha_1(N_0) \leq \log_2 \log_2(N_0 + 16) + 2 < 3r \log_2 C_0 + 3 < 2^{C_0^2}\, r$. Applying Theorem 5.1 and Theorem 4.2(1) at height 1 to each $\widetilde{H}^{(Q)}$ pays at most $C_{\text{pass}} \sum_Q |Q| = C_{\text{pass}}\, P$ and decomposes into folded Pop processes $\{\widetilde{H}^{(R)}\}$ of sizes $1 \leq N_1 := |R| < \max\big(\alpha_1(N_0), 2^{C_0^2}\big)^6 \leq 2^{6C_0^2}\, r^6$ with $\sum_{Q,R} |R| = P$.

(3) *Pass 2 (bisection):* For $1 \leq N_1 < 2^{6C_0^2}\, r^6$, Theorem 4.2(2) and $\log_2 r < r$ ($r \geq 1$) give $J(\widetilde{H}^{(R)}) \leq N_1 \max\big(0, \lceil \log_2 N_1 \rceil - 1\big) \leq N_1 \log_2 N_1 < (6C_0^2 + 6)\, r\, N_1$, so $\sum_{Q,R} J(\widetilde{H}^{(R)}) \leq (6C_0^2 + 6)\, r\, P$.

Since $r \geq 1$, summing gives $J(\widetilde{H}) \leq (2C_{\text{pass}} + 6C_0^2 + 6)\, \alpha_\omega(P)\, P$; substituting into Theorem 2.2 ($J(\emptyset) = 0$ when $d_L = 0$ or $d_R = 0$, and $d_L + d_R \leq m$) yields Theorem 1.4 with $C := \max(C_{\text{red}},\, 4C_{\text{pass}} + 12C_0^2 + 12)$. □

6 Structural Degeneration on the Dyadic Partition

The separating scale $\text{sep}(u, v) \in \{1, \ldots, M+1\}$ and the four-way rotation classification $\mathcal{R}_{\text{int}}(\widetilde{H}) = \mathcal{B}_{\text{leaf}} \sqcup \mathcal{B}_1 \sqcup \mathcal{B}_2 \sqcup \mathcal{B}_3$ of Section 4.3 depend only on a nested chain of contiguous-interval partitions $\mathcal{P}_0 \succ \mathcal{P}_1 \succ \cdots \succ \mathcal{P}_M$ with $\mathcal{P}_0 = \{\{1, \ldots, P\}\}$, and not on the numerical scale law $S_\ell = w_\ell i_\ell^2 \leq \frac{1}{2} S_{\ell-1}$ of Definition 4.1. We record how this classification degenerates on the purely combinatorial *dyadic partition*—which repeatedly bisects $\{1, \ldots, P\}$ into halves down to singletons—and explain why the scale-tree pass of Section 4 does not extend to it.

Proposition 6.1 (Degeneration of $\mathcal{B}_{\text{leaf}}$ and $\mathcal{B}_3$ on the Dyadic Partition)**.** *Given any integer $P \geq 1$, set $M := \lceil \log_2 \max(P, 2) \rceil \geq 1$ and define the* dyadic partition $\mathcal{P}_0 \succ \mathcal{P}_1 \succ \cdots \succ \mathcal{P}_M$ *of $\{1, \ldots, P\}$ inductively from $\mathcal{P}_0 := \{\{1, \ldots, P\}\}$ by splitting each block $X \in \mathcal{P}_{\ell-1}$ ($1 \leq \ell \leq M$) with $|X| \geq 2$ into $K_X = 2$ contiguous sub-blocks of sizes $\lfloor |X|/2 \rfloor$ and $\lceil |X|/2 \rceil$, and keeping singleton blocks $|X| = 1$ intact ($K_X = 1$). Then $\max_{X \in \mathcal{P}_\ell} |X| = \lceil P/2^\ell \rceil$ for every $0 \leq \ell \leq M$; in particular, every leaf block $Q \in \mathcal{P}_M$ satisfies $|Q| = 1$. Under the four-way classification $\mathcal{R}_{\text{int}}(\widetilde{H}) = \mathcal{B}_{\text{leaf}} \sqcup \mathcal{B}_1 \sqcup \mathcal{B}_2 \sqcup \mathcal{B}_3$ of Section 4.3 with respect to $\mathcal{P}_0 \succ \cdots \succ \mathcal{P}_M$, every folded Pop process $\widetilde{H}$ of size P satisfies*

$$\mathcal{B}_{\text{leaf}} = \emptyset \quad \text{and} \quad \mathcal{B}_3 = \emptyset, \quad \text{so} \quad \mathcal{R}_{\text{int}}(\widetilde{H}) = \mathcal{B}_1 \sqcup \mathcal{B}_2 \quad \text{and} \quad J(\widetilde{H}) = |\mathcal{B}_1| + |\mathcal{B}_2|.$$

Proof. We prove $\max_{X \in \mathcal{P}_\ell} |X| = \lceil P/2^\ell \rceil$ by induction on $\ell \in \{0, \ldots, M\}$. At $\ell = 0$, $\mathcal{P}_0 = \{\{1, \ldots, P\}\}$ has size $P = \lceil P/2^0 \rceil$. For $1 \leq \ell \leq M$, each $X \in \mathcal{P}_{\ell-1}$ produces sub-blocks in $\mathcal{P}_\ell$ of maximum size $\lceil |X|/2 \rceil$ (both for $|X| \geq 2$ and for $|X| = 1$). Since $t \mapsto \lceil t/2 \rceil$ is non-decreasing and $\lceil \lceil a/2^{\ell-1} \rceil / 2 \rceil = \lceil a/2^\ell \rceil$ for every integer $a \geq 1$, the induction hypothesis gives $\max_{Y \in \mathcal{P}_\ell} |Y| = \lceil (\max_{X \in \mathcal{P}_{\ell-1}} |X|)/2 \rceil = \lceil P/2^\ell \rceil$. At $\ell = M = \lceil \log_2 \max(P, 2) \rceil$, we have $0 < P/2^M \leq 1$, so $\max_{Q \in \mathcal{P}_M} |Q| = \lceil P/2^M \rceil = 1$ and hence $|Q| = 1$ for every $Q \in \mathcal{P}_M$.

Now consider any internal Pop rotation $e = (x, y, z) \in \mathcal{R}_{\text{int}}(\widetilde{H})$ executed during Pop(s), so $1 \le s < x < y < z \le P$. Because $|Q| = 1$ for every $Q \in \mathcal{P}_M$, distinct keys $x < y$ cannot share a leaf block in $\mathcal{P}_M$, giving $\text{sep}(x, y) \le M$ and $\mathcal{B}_{\text{leaf}} = \emptyset$. Suppose $e \in \mathcal{B}_3$, so $\ell := \text{sep}(s, x) = \text{sep}(x, y) \in \{1, \dots, M\}$. Then $\text{sep}(s, y) = \min\big(\text{sep}(s, x), \text{sep}(x, y)\big) = \ell > \ell - 1$, so $s < x < y$ lie in a common parent block $X \in \mathcal{P}_{\ell-1}$, whereas $\text{sep}(s, x) = \text{sep}(x, y) = \ell$ places s, x, y into three distinct contiguous scale-ℓ sub-blocks $S_p < S_b < S_q$ of X, contradicting $K_X \le 2$. Thus $\mathcal{B}_3 = \emptyset$, leaving $\mathcal{R}_{\text{int}}(\widetilde{H}) = \mathcal{B}_1 \sqcup \mathcal{B}_2$ and $J(\widetilde{H}) = |\mathcal{B}_1| + |\mathcal{B}_2|$. □

Remark 6.2 (Why Section 4 Does Not Bound the Dyadic Partition). Proposition 6.1 is purely a structural observation that $\mathcal{B}_{\text{leaf}}$ and $\mathcal{B}_3$ vanish on the dyadic chain—so asking for $|\mathcal{B}_1| + |\mathcal{B}_2| = O(P)$ on the dyadic partition is simply a restatement of $J(\widetilde{H}) = O(P)$ (which would imply $\text{Rot}(T_0, S) = O(m + n)$ via Theorem 2.2), rather than a non-trivial reduction. Two distinct obstacles prevent the scale-tree pass of Theorem 4.2(1) from bounding $|\mathcal{B}_1| + |\mathcal{B}_2|$ on the dyadic chain:

(1) *Loss of the internal-node sink bound $\Sigma_{\mathcal{T}} = O(P)$:* In Section 4.2, bounding the freeze-sink sum $\Sigma_{\mathcal{T}} = \sum_{\nu \in \mathcal{T}_{\text{int}}} k_\nu |\mathcal{P}_{M_{\text{end}}(\nu)}| = O(P)$ relies directly on the numerical scale law $S_\ell = w_\ell i_\ell^2 \ge 16 k_\nu^2 w(\nu)$ at $\ell = M_{\text{end}}(\nu)$. On the dyadic partition at $P = 2^M$ ($M = \log_2 P$ and $|\mathcal{P}_\ell| = 2^\ell$), a flat height-1 tree has $k_{\text{root}} = M$ and $M_{\text{end}}(\text{root}) = M$, giving $\Sigma_{\mathcal{T}} = MP = P \log_2 P$; even on a balanced binary scale tree of height $r = \lceil \log_2 M \rceil$, every internal node ν along the rightmost root-to-M path has $k_\nu = 2$ and $|\mathcal{P}_{M_{\text{end}}(\nu)}| = |\mathcal{P}_M| = P$, giving $\Sigma_{\mathcal{T}} = \Theta(P \log M) = \Theta(P \log \log P)$.

(2) *Tree-height amplification in $\text{LCA}_{\mathcal{T}}$ chain routing:* At $P = 2^M$ ($M \ge 2$), while a lopsided left-leaning caterpillar tree (placing leaf $M - d$ at depth $d + 1$ for $0 \le d \le M - 3$ and leaves $1, 2$ as siblings at depth $M - 1$) keeps $\Sigma_{\mathcal{T}} < 4P$, it forces tree height $r = M - 1 = \log_2 P - 1$, and the ancestor/descendant chain arguments of Sections 4.4 and 4.7 multiply the sink bounds $|\mathcal{S}_1|$ and $|\mathcal{S}_2|$ by the height r.

AI Disclosure

A Gemini 4 Carbon model with harnesses on top discovered the proof with slight human guidance (Goran Žužić, David P. Woodruff, and Vahab Mirrokni). Goran Žužić and Sorrachai Yingchareonthawornchai cleaned up the paper, and Goran Žužić, David P. Woodruff, and Vahab Mirrokni prepared the Lean 4 verification.

A Elementary Properties of the Star-Iterated Inverse-Ackermann Hierarchy

This appendix provides complete, self-contained proofs of the elementary Ackermann estimates used in Sections 2–5 (following Sundar's indexing [Sun92, Section 1.2]), Proposition 1.3, and the Löb–Wainer fast-growing hierarchy comparison stated in Remark 1.2.

Lemma A.1 (Elementary Ackermann and Iterated-Inverse Estimates)**.** *The functions A_i, α_0, and α_r of Definition 1.1 satisfy:*

(1) For all $i \ge 0$ and $j \ge 1$, $A_i(j) > j$ and $A_i(j)$ is strictly increasing in j; for all $i \ge 1$ and $j \ge 1$, $A_i(j) \ge A_{i-1}(j)$ and $A_i(j) \ge 2^j$; and $A_k(1) \ge 2^k$ for all $k \ge 1$. Consequently, α_0 is well-defined and non-decreasing with $\alpha_0(1) = 1$, $\alpha_0(n) \le \lceil \log_2 n \rceil < \log_2 n + 1$ for all $n \ge 2$, and $\alpha_0(n) < n$ for all $n \ge 3$.

(2) Setting $F_0(k) := A_k(1)$ ($k \geq 1$) and $F_r(1) := 4$, $F_r(k) := F_{r-1}(F_r(k-1))$ ($r \geq 1, k \geq 2$), we have $F_r(k) \geq 2^k$ for all $r \geq 0$ and $k \geq 1$, with $F_r(k)$ strictly increasing in k and non-decreasing in $r \geq 1$. For every $r \geq 1$, α_r is well-defined and non-decreasing with $\alpha_r(n) < n$ for all $n > 4$ (so Definition 1.1's star-operator condition holds at every $r \geq 1$), and for all integers $r, k, n \geq 1$,

$$\alpha_r(n) \leq k \iff n \leq F_r(k), \quad \alpha_1(2n) \leq \alpha_1(n) + 1, \quad \alpha_r(n) \leq \alpha_1(n) \leq \log_2 \log_2(n+16) + 2,$$

and $\alpha_\omega(n) = \min\{r \geq 1 : F_r(2) \geq n\}$.

(3) $\alpha_0(n+2) \leq \alpha_0(n) + 1$ for all $n \geq 1$—consequently, $f(u) := \alpha_0(u) + 1$ satisfies $f^{(m)}(u) \leq \alpha_0^{(m)}(u) + 2$ for all $m, u \geq 1$—and $\alpha_0(2^{20}u^6) \leq \alpha_0(u) + 1$ for all $u \geq 5$.

Proof. (1) At $i = 0$ and $i = 1$, $A_0(j) = 2j > j$ and $A_1(j) = 2^j \geq 2j = A_0(j) > j$ are strictly increasing in $j \geq 1$. Inducting on $i \geq 2$, assume A_{i-1} is strictly increasing with $A_{i-1}(m) > m$. Then $A_i(1) = A_{i-1}(2) > 2 > 1$, and for $j \geq 2$, $A_i(j) = A_{i-1}(A_i(j-1)) > A_i(j-1)$, proving strict monotonicity in j and $A_i(j) > j$. Moreover, $A_i(1) = A_{i-1}(2) > A_{i-1}(1)$, and for $j \geq 2$ inductively $A_i(j-1) \geq A_{i-1}(j-1) \geq j$, so strict monotonicity of A_{i-1} gives $A_i(j) = A_{i-1}(A_i(j-1)) \geq A_{i-1}(j)$, chaining to $A_i(j) \geq A_1(j) = 2^j$. For $A_k(1) \geq 2^k$, note $A_1(1) = 2$, $A_2(1) = A_1(2) = 4$, and for $k \geq 3$ inductively $A_k(1) = A_{k-1}(2) = A_{k-2}(A_{k-1}(1)) \geq 2^{A_{k-1}(1)} \geq 2A_{k-1}(1) \geq 2^k$. Since $A_{k+1}(1) = A_k(2) > A_k(1)$ is strictly increasing and unbounded with $A_1(1) = 2$, α_0 is well-defined and non-decreasing with $\alpha_0(1) = 1$; for $n \geq 2$, $A_{\lceil \log_2 n \rceil}(1) \geq 2^{\lceil \log_2 n \rceil} \geq n$ gives $\alpha_0(n) \leq \lceil \log_2 n \rceil < \log_2 n + 1$, and for $n \geq 3$, $\lceil \log_2 n \rceil < n$ gives $\alpha_0(n) < n$.

(2) At $r = 0$, $F_0(k) = A_k(1) \geq 2^k$ is strictly increasing in k by (1). Inducting on $r \geq 1$, we have $F_r(1) = 4 > 2^1$, and for $k \geq 2$ inductively $F_r(k-1) \geq 2^{k-1} \geq k$, so $F_r(k) = F_{r-1}(F_r(k-1)) \geq 2^{F_r(k-1)} > F_r(k-1)$ with $2^{F_r(k-1)} \geq 2^k$. For $r \geq 2$, $F_r(1) = 4 = F_{r-1}(1)$, and for $k \geq 2$ inductively $F_r(k-1) \geq F_{r-1}(k-1) \geq 2^{k-1} \geq k$ yields $F_r(k) = F_{r-1}(F_r(k-1)) \geq F_{r-1}(k)$.

Next we prove by induction on $r \geq 1$ that α_r is well-defined and non-decreasing, satisfies $\alpha_r(n) \leq k \iff n \leq F_r(k)$ for all $k, n \geq 1$, and satisfies $\alpha_r(n) < n$ for all $n > 4$. At the input to r, α_{r-1} is well-defined and non-decreasing with $\alpha_{r-1}(n) < n$ for all $n > 4$ and $\alpha_{r-1}(n) \leq m \iff n \leq F_{r-1}(m)$ (by (1) when $r = 1$, and by the $(r-1)$-hypothesis when $r \geq 2$). Hence (1) terminates on every $n \geq 1$ and (by strong induction on n) defines a non-decreasing function α_r. Inducting on $k \geq 1$: at $k = 1$, $\alpha_r(n) \leq 1 \iff n \leq 4 = F_r(1)$ by (1); for $k \geq 2$, both sides hold when $n \leq 4$, and when $n > 4$ we have $\alpha_r(n) \leq k \iff \alpha_r(\alpha_{r-1}(n)) \leq k-1 \iff \alpha_{r-1}(n) \leq F_r(k-1) \iff n \leq F_{r-1}(F_r(k-1)) = F_r(k)$. For any $n \geq 5$, $F_r(n-1) \geq 2^{n-1} > n$ implies $\alpha_r(n) \leq n-1 < n$, closing the induction on r.

Setting $k = 2$ gives $\alpha_r(n) \leq 2 \iff n \leq F_r(2)$, and since $F_{r+1}(2) = F_r(4) > F_r(2)$ grows strictly with r, $\alpha_\omega(n) = \min\{r \geq 1 : F_r(2) \geq n\}$ is well-defined for all $n \geq 1$. For $k = \alpha_1(n) \geq 1$, $F_1(k) \geq 4$ gives $F_1(k+1) = A_{F_1(k)}(1) \geq 2^{F_1(k)} > 2F_1(k) \geq 2n$, so $\alpha_1(2n) \leq k+1$. Since $F_r(k) \geq F_1(k)$, we have $\alpha_r(n) \leq \alpha_1(n)$. Observe by induction on $j \geq 1$ that $A_2(j) \geq 2^{2^j}$ ($A_2(1) = 4 = 2^{2^1}$, and $A_2(j+1) = 2^{A_2(j)} \geq 2^{2^{2^j}} \geq 2^{2^{j+1}}$ since $2^j \geq j+1$), and for $m \geq 4$ that $A_m(1) = A_{m-2}(A_{m-1}(1)) \geq A_2(2^{m-1}) \geq A_2(m) \geq 2^{2^m}$. If $n \leq F_1(2) = A_4(1)$, then $\alpha_1(n) \leq 2 < \log_2 \log_2(n+16)+2$; if $n > F_1(2)$, then $k := \alpha_1(n) \geq 3$ and $m := F_1(k-2) \geq \max(4, k-2)$ give $n > F_1(k-1) = A_m(1) \geq 2^{2^m} \geq 2^{2^{k-2}}$, so $\log_2 \log_2(n+16) > k-2$, i.e., $\alpha_1(n) < \log_2 \log_2(n+16) + 2$.

(3) Let $k := \alpha_0(n) \geq 1$, so $n \leq A_k(1)$ and $A_k(1) \geq 2$. Then $A_{k+1}(1) = A_k(2) \geq 2A_k(1) \geq A_k(1) + 2 \geq n + 2$ (at $k = 1$, $A_1(2) = 4 = 2A_1(1)$, and for $k \geq 2$, $A_k(2) = A_{k-1}(A_k(1)) \geq A_0(A_k(1)) = 2A_k(1)$), so $\alpha_0(n+2) \leq k+1$. By induction on $m \geq 1$, $f^{(1)}(u) = \alpha_0(u)+1 < \alpha_0(u)+2$ and $f^{(m+1)}(u) = \alpha_0(f^{(m)}(u)) + 1 \leq \alpha_0(\alpha_0^{(m)}(u) + 2) + 1 \leq \alpha_0^{(m+1)}(u) + 2$. Finally, for $u \geq 5$, since $A_2(1) = 4 < u$, we have $k := \alpha_0(u) \geq 3$ and $u \leq A_k(1)$. If $k = 3$, then $u \leq A_3(1) = A_2(2) = 16$,

so $2^{20}u^6 \le 2^{44} < 2^{65536} = A_2(4) < A_2(16) = A_3(2) = A_4(1)$ (as $A_2(3) = 2^{16} = 65{,}536$), giving $\alpha_0(2^{20}u^6) \le 4 = k+1$. If $k \ge 4$, then $u > A_3(1) = 16$, so $u \ge 17$ and $20 + 6\log_2 u < 20 + 6u < 2^u$, whence $2^{20}u^6 < 2^{2^u} \le A_2(u) \le A_2(A_k(1)) \le A_{k-1}(A_k(1)) = A_k(2) = A_{k+1}(1)$ and $\alpha_0(2^{20}u^6) \le k+1$. □

Proof of Proposition 1.3. Since $A_3(1) = A_2(2) = 16$ and $A_2(3) = 2^{16} = 65{,}536$, we have $F_1(2) = F_0(4) = A_4(1) = A_3(2) = A_2(16) > A_2(4) = 2^{65536}$. By Lemma A.1(2), $\alpha_\omega(n) = \min\{r \ge 1 : F_r(2) \ge n\}$ is non-decreasing with $\alpha_\omega(n) = 1$ for all $1 \le n \le A_4(1)$, and since each $F_r(2)$ is finite while $F_{r+1}(2) = F_r(4) > F_r(2)$, $\lim_{n\to\infty} \alpha_\omega(n) = \infty$.

Observe next that $F_t(2) > 2^{t+2}$ for all $t \ge 1$: at $t = 1$, $F_1(2) = A_4(1) > 2^3$, and inductively for $t \ge 2$, Lemma A.1(2) gives $F_t(2) = F_{t-1}(4) = F_{t-2}(F_{t-1}(3)) \ge 2^{F_{t-1}(3)} > 2^{F_{t-1}(2)} > 2^{2^{t+1}} \ge 2^{t+2}$. Fix any $r \ge 1$; for every $n > F_{r+2}(2)$, setting $s := \alpha_\omega(n) \ge r+3$ (so $s-3 \ge r$ and $s-2 \ge 2$) and using minimality of s together with Lemma A.1(2) yields

$$n \;>\; F_{s-1}(2) \;=\; F_{s-2}(4) \;>\; F_{s-2}(3) \;=\; F_{s-3}\big(F_{s-2}(2)\big) \;\ge\; F_r\big(F_{s-2}(2)\big) \;\ge\; F_r(2^s).$$

Hence $\alpha_r(n) > 2^s = 2^{\alpha_\omega(n)}$, i.e., $\alpha_\omega(n) < \log_2 \alpha_r(n)$ for all $n > F_{r+2}(2)$; since $\alpha_r(n) \to \infty$ as $n \to \infty$, $\alpha_\omega(n) = o(\alpha_r(n))$.

For the diagonal Ackermann variant, set $\widetilde{F}_0(k) := A_k(k)$ $(k \ge 1)$ and $\widetilde{F}_r(1) := 4$, $\widetilde{F}_r(k) := \widetilde{F}_{r-1}(\widetilde{F}_r(k-1))$ $(r \ge 1, k \ge 2)$. By Lemma A.1(1), $\widetilde{F}_0(k) = A_k(k) \ge A_k(1) = F_0(k) \ge 2^k$ is strictly increasing in k $(A_{k+1}(k+1) > A_{k+1}(k) \ge A_k(k))$, so $\widetilde{\alpha}_0(n) = \min\{k \ge 1 : \widetilde{F}_0(k) \ge n\} \le \alpha_0(n)$ satisfies $\widetilde{\alpha}_0(n) < n$ for all $n > 4$. Repeating the induction of Lemma A.1(2) verbatim shows that $\widetilde{F}_r(k) \ge F_r(k) \ge 2^k$ is strictly increasing in k and non-decreasing in $r \ge 1$, and that each $\widetilde{\alpha}_r$ $(r \ge 1)$ defined by (1) is well-defined and non-decreasing with $\widetilde{\alpha}_r(n) < n$ for $n > 4$ and $\widetilde{\alpha}_r(n) \le k \iff n \le \widetilde{F}_r(k)$. In particular, $\widetilde{\alpha}_r(n) \le r \iff n \le \widetilde{F}_r(r)$, so $\widetilde{\alpha}_{\omega,\mathrm{diag}}(n) = \min\{r \ge 1 : \widetilde{F}_r(r) \ge n\}$.

For $k \ge 1$, since $k < 2^{k+1} \le A_{k+1}(1)$, strict monotonicity of A_k gives $F_0(k) = A_k(1) \le A_k(k) = \widetilde{F}_0(k) < A_k(A_{k+1}(1)) = A_{k+1}(2) = A_{k+2}(1) = F_0(k+2)$. We claim $F_r(k) \le \widetilde{F}_r(k) \le F_r(2k-1)$ for all $r, k \ge 1$ by induction on r and k: at $k = 1$, $F_r(1) = 4 = \widetilde{F}_r(1)$; and if $\widetilde{F}_r(k) \le M := F_r(2k-1)$ $(M \ge 4)$, then $F_r(2k) = F_{r-1}(M) \ge 2^M > \max(M+2, 2M-1) \ge \max(\widetilde{F}_r(k)+2, 2\widetilde{F}_r(k)-1)$, giving $\widetilde{F}_1(k+1) = \widetilde{F}_0(\widetilde{F}_1(k)) \le F_0(\widetilde{F}_1(k)+2) \le F_0(F_1(2k)) = F_1(2k+1)$ at $r = 1$ and $\widetilde{F}_r(k+1) = \widetilde{F}_{r-1}(\widetilde{F}_r(k)) \le F_{r-1}(2\widetilde{F}_r(k)-1) \le F_{r-1}(F_r(2k)) = F_r(2k+1)$ for $r \ge 2$. Finally, for every $r \ge 1$, $F_r(2) \le F_{r+1}(2) \le \widetilde{F}_{r+1}(2) \le \widetilde{F}_{r+1}(r+1)$ implies $\widetilde{\alpha}_{\omega,\mathrm{diag}}(n) \le \alpha_\omega(n) + 1$, while $F_{r+1}(3) > F_{r+1}(2) > 2^{r+3} > 2r-1$ implies $\widetilde{F}_r(r) \le F_r(2r-1) < F_r(F_{r+1}(3)) = F_{r+1}(4) = F_{r+2}(2)$, yielding $\alpha_\omega(n) \le \widetilde{\alpha}_{\omega,\mathrm{diag}}(n) + 2$. □

Proposition A.2 (Position of α_0, α_r, and α_ω in the Löb–Wainer Fast-Growing Hierarchy)**.** *Let $\{f_\beta : \mathbb{Z}_{\ge 1} \to \mathbb{Z}_{\ge 1}\}_{\beta \le \omega\cdot 2}$ be the standard fast-growing (Löb–Wainer) hierarchy (originating in [LW70a, LW70b]), defined by $f_0(n) := n+1$, $f_{\beta+1}(n) := f_\beta^{(n)}(n)$, $f_\omega(n) := f_n(n)$, and $f_{\omega\cdot 2}(r) := f_{\omega+r}(r)$, with inverses $f_\beta^{-1}(n) := \min\{k \ge 1 : f_\beta(k) \ge n\}$. Then for every integer $n \ge 1$ and every integer $r \ge 1$,*

$$f_\omega^{-1}(n) \;\le\; \alpha_0(n) \;\le\; f_\omega^{-1}(n) + 2, \qquad \frac{1}{3}\,\alpha_r(n) \;\le\; f_{\omega+r}^{-1}(n) \;\le\; \max\big(\alpha_r(n),\, 2\big),$$

and

$$f_{\omega\cdot 2}^{-1}(n) - 1 \;\le\; \alpha_\omega(n) \;\le\; f_{\omega\cdot 2}^{-1}(n) + 2.$$

Proof. First, we verify by transfinite induction on $\beta \le \omega\cdot 2$ that $f_\beta(1) = 2$, $f_\beta(n) > n$ for all $n \ge 1$, f_β is strictly increasing, and $f_{\beta+1}(n) \ge f_\beta(n)$ for $\beta < \omega \cdot 2$. At $\beta = 0$, $f_0(1) = 2$ and $f_0(n) = n+1 > n$

is strictly increasing. If these properties hold at β, then $f_{\beta+1}(1) = f_\beta^{(1)}(1) = f_\beta(1) = 2$, and since $x \mapsto f_\beta^{(t)}(x)$ is strictly increasing with $f_\beta^{(t+1)}(x) > f_\beta^{(t)}(x) \geq f_\beta(x) > x$, we have $f_{\beta+1}(n) = f_\beta^{(n)}(n) \geq f_\beta(n) > n$ and $f_{\beta+1}(n+1) = f_\beta^{(n+1)}(n+1) > f_\beta^{(n)}(n+1) > f_\beta^{(n)}(n) = f_{\beta+1}(n)$. At the limit levels, $f_\omega(1) = f_1(1) = 2$, $f_\omega(n) = f_n(n) > n$, and $f_\omega(n+1) = f_{n+1}(n+1) \geq f_n(n+1) > f_n(n) = f_\omega(n)$; identically, $f_{\omega\cdot 2}(1) = f_{\omega+1}(1) = 2$, $f_{\omega\cdot 2}(r) = f_{\omega+r}(r) > r$, and $f_{\omega\cdot 2}(r+1) = f_{\omega+r+1}(r+1) \geq f_{\omega+r}(r+1) > f_{\omega+r}(r) = f_{\omega\cdot 2}(r)$. Thus $f_\beta^{-1}(n)$ is well-defined for all $\beta \leq \omega \cdot 2$ and $n \geq 1$, with $f_\beta^{-1}(n) \leq k \iff n \leq f_\beta(k)$.

Step 1 (Finite levels). Note $f_1(n) = 2n = A_0(n)$ and $f_2(n) = n2^n$. We prove $f_{m+1}(n) \geq A_m(n)$ for all $m \geq 1$ and $n \geq 2$ by induction on m: at $m = 1$, $f_2(n) = n2^n > 2^n = A_1(n)$; for $m \geq 2$, setting $y_t := f_m^{(t)}(n)$, the $(m-1)$-hypothesis gives $y_1 = f_m(n) \geq A_{m-1}(n) \geq A_{m-1}(2) = A_m(1) \geq 4 \geq 2$, and inductively $y_t \geq A_m(t) \geq 2$ implies $y_{t+1} = f_m(y_t) \geq A_{m-1}(y_t) \geq A_{m-1}(A_m(t)) = A_m(t+1)$, so $f_{m+1}(n) = y_n \geq A_m(n)$. Next we prove $f_m(u) \leq A_m(3u)$ for all $m \geq 2$ and $u \geq 1$ by induction on m: at $m = 2$, using $A_2(j) \geq 2^{2^j}$ from the proof of Lemma A.1(2), $f_2(u) = u2^u < 2^{2u} < 2^{2^{3u}} \leq A_2(3u)$. For $m \to m+1$ $(m \geq 2)$, $f_{m+1}(1) = 2 < A_{m+1}(3)$; for $u \geq 2$, setting $x_t := f_m^{(t)}(u)$ $(0 \leq t \leq u)$, we have $x_0 = u < A_{m+1}(u)$, and if $x_t \leq M := A_{m+1}(u+2t)$, then $m+1 \geq 3$ and $u+2t \geq 2$ give $M \geq A_3(2) = A_4(1) > 16$, so $3x_t \leq 3M < 2^M \leq A_m(M) = A_{m+1}(u+2t+1)$ and $x_{t+1} = f_m(x_t) \leq A_m(3x_t) \leq A_m(A_{m+1}(u+2t+1)) = A_{m+1}(u+2t+2)$, giving $f_{m+1}(u) = x_u \leq A_{m+1}(3u)$.

Step 2 (Level ω). At $k = 1$, $F_0(1) = A_1(1) = 2 = f_1(1) = f_\omega(1) < 16 = A_3(1) = F_0(3)$. For $k \geq 2$, Step 1 gives $f_\omega(k) = f_k(k) \geq A_{k-1}(k) \geq A_{k-1}(2) = A_k(1) = F_0(k)$, and since $3k < 2^{k+1} \leq A_{k+1}(1)$, $f_\omega(k) = f_k(k) \leq A_k(3k) < A_k(A_{k+1}(1)) = A_{k+1}(2) = A_{k+2}(1) = F_0(k+2)$. Thus $F_0(k) \leq f_\omega(k) \leq F_0(k+2)$ for all $k \geq 1$, which inverts immediately to $f_\omega^{-1}(n) \leq \alpha_0(n) \leq f_\omega^{-1}(n) + 2$.

Step 3 (Levels $\omega + r$, $r \geq 1$). Writing $\omega + 0 := \omega$, we prove $F_r(k) \leq f_{\omega+r}(k)$ for all $r \geq 1$ and $k \geq 2$ by induction on r. Fix $k \geq 2$ and set $y_t := f_{\omega+r-1}^{(t)}(k)$ $(1 \leq t \leq k)$. At $t = 1$: if $r = 1$, $y_1 = f_\omega(k) \geq f_\omega(2) = f_2(2) = 8 \geq 4 = F_1(1)$; if $r \geq 2$, the $(r-1)$-hypothesis gives $y_1 = f_{\omega+r-1}(k) \geq F_{r-1}(k) \geq F_{r-1}(2) \geq F_1(2) = A_4(1) > 4 = F_r(1)$. Inductively for $1 \leq t < k$, $y_t \geq F_r(t) \geq 4 \geq 2$ gives $y_{t+1} = f_\omega(y_t) \geq F_0(y_t) \geq F_0(F_1(t)) = F_1(t+1)$ when $r = 1$ (by Step 2) and $y_{t+1} = f_{\omega+r-1}(y_t) \geq F_{r-1}(y_t) \geq F_{r-1}(F_r(t)) = F_r(t+1)$ when $r \geq 2$, so $f_{\omega+r}(k) = y_k \geq F_r(k)$.

Conversely, we prove $f_{\omega+r}(u) \leq F_r(3u)$ for all $r \geq 1$ and $u \geq 1$ by induction on r. At $u = 1$, $f_{\omega+r}(1) = 2 < 4 = F_r(1) < F_r(3)$. For $u \geq 2$, set $x_t := f_{\omega+r-1}^{(t)}(u)$ $(0 \leq t \leq u)$; then $x_0 = u < 2^u \leq F_r(u)$, and if $x_t \leq M := F_r(u+2t)$, then $u+2t \geq 2$ implies $M \geq F_r(2) \geq A_4(1) > 16$, so $\max(x_t + 2, 3x_t) \leq 3M < 2^M \leq F_{r-1}(M) = F_r(u+2t+1)$ (Lemma A.1(2)). Applying Step 2 at $r = 1$ ($x_{t+1} = f_\omega(x_t) \leq F_0(x_t+2) \leq F_0(F_1(u+2t+1)) = F_1(u+2t+2)$) and the $(r-1)$-hypothesis for $r \geq 2$ ($x_{t+1} = f_{\omega+r-1}(x_t) \leq F_{r-1}(3x_t) \leq F_{r-1}(F_r(u+2t+1)) = F_r(u+2t+2)$) gives $f_{\omega+r}(u) = x_u \leq F_r(3u)$. Inverting $F_r(k) \leq f_{\omega+r}(k)$ $(k \geq 2)$ and $f_{\omega+r}(u) \leq F_r(3u)$ $(u \geq 1)$ via Lemma A.1(2) yields $\frac{1}{3}\,\alpha_r(n) \leq f_{\omega+r}^{-1}(n) \leq \max(\alpha_r(n), 2)$.

Step 4 (Level $\omega \cdot 2$). Let $r := \alpha_\omega(n) \geq 1$, so $n \leq F_r(2)$ by Lemma A.1(2). Since $r+1 \geq 2$, Step 3 and monotonicity give $n \leq F_r(2) \leq F_{r+1}(2) \leq f_{\omega+r+1}(2) \leq f_{\omega+r+1}(r+1) = f_{\omega\cdot 2}(r+1)$, so $f_{\omega\cdot 2}^{-1}(n) \leq r+1 = \alpha_\omega(n)+1$. Conversely, let $q := f_{\omega\cdot 2}^{-1}(n) \geq 1$, so $n \leq f_{\omega\cdot 2}(q) = f_{\omega+q}(q) \leq F_q(3q)$ by Step 3. As shown in the proof of Proposition 1.3, $F_{q+1}(3) > F_{q+1}(2) > 2^{q+3} > 3q$, so strict monotonicity of F_q gives $n \leq F_q(3q) < F_q(F_{q+1}(3)) = F_{q+1}(4) = F_{q+2}(2)$, whence $\alpha_\omega(n) \leq q+2 = f_{\omega\cdot 2}^{-1}(n) + 2$. □

B Deferred Routine Proofs for Section 2

This appendix records the routine induction and case-check verifications deferred from Section 2: Lemmas 2.3, 2.4, and 2.7, together with the four-step check of the spine-folding bijection establishing (3).

Proof of Lemma 2.3. (1) By reversing T and T' for a left rotation, it suffices to check a right single rotation $[x, y]$ ($x < y$) replacing $T_y = y(x(A, B), C)$ with $T'_x = x(A, y(B, C))$; outside this subtree all nodes and LCAs are unchanged, so it suffices to compare $T_y|_{\mathcal{S}}$ and $T'_x|_{\mathcal{S}}$ across the four membership cases of (x, y):

- If $x, y \in \mathcal{S}$, then $T_y|_{\mathcal{S}} = y(x(A|_{\mathcal{S}}, B|_{\mathcal{S}}), C|_{\mathcal{S}})$ and $T'_x|_{\mathcal{S}} = x(A|_{\mathcal{S}}, y(B|_{\mathcal{S}}, C|_{\mathcal{S}}))$, which is the right single rotation $[x, y]$ on $T|_{\mathcal{S}}$.
- If $x \in \mathcal{S}$ and $y \notin \mathcal{S}$, LCA-closure in T forces $V(C) \cap \mathcal{S} = \emptyset$ (else $c \in V(C) \cap \mathcal{S}$ gives $\mathrm{LCA}_T(x, c) = y \notin \mathcal{S}$), so $y(B, C)|_{\mathcal{S}} = B|_{\mathcal{S}}$ and $T_y|_{\mathcal{S}} = x(A|_{\mathcal{S}}, B|_{\mathcal{S}}) = T'_x|_{\mathcal{S}}$.
- If $x \notin \mathcal{S}$ and $y \in \mathcal{S}$, LCA-closure in T' forces $V(A) \cap \mathcal{S} = \emptyset$ (else $a \in V(A) \cap \mathcal{S}$ gives $\mathrm{LCA}_{T'}(a, y) = x \notin \mathcal{S}$), so $x(A, B)|_{\mathcal{S}} = B|_{\mathcal{S}}$ and $T_y|_{\mathcal{S}} = y(B|_{\mathcal{S}}, C|_{\mathcal{S}}) = T'_x|_{\mathcal{S}}$.
- If $x, y \notin \mathcal{S}$, LCA-closure in T and T' implies that at most one of $V(A)$, $V(B)$, and $V(C)$ intersects $\mathcal{S}$, so $T_y|_{\mathcal{S}}$ and $T'_x|_{\mathcal{S}}$ both equal that unique subtree restriction (or $\emptyset$).

(2) Splicing out $x_{\min}(\emptyset, R)$ leaves $\mathrm{LCA}_{T'}(a, b) = \mathrm{LCA}_T(a, b)$ for all surviving $a, b \in V(T) \setminus \{x_{\min}\}$, preserving LCA-closure. Directly from the recursive definition of $\cdot|_{\mathcal{S}}$ along $\mathrm{LS}(T)$, replacing $x_{\min}(\emptyset, R)$ by R replaces $x_{\min}(\emptyset, R|_{\mathcal{S}})$ at the bottom of $\mathrm{LS}(T|_{\mathcal{S}})$ by $R|_{\mathcal{S}}$ when $x_{\min} \in \mathcal{S}$, and replaces $x_{\min}(\emptyset, R)|_{\mathcal{S}} = R|_{\mathcal{S}}$ by $R|_{\mathcal{S}}$ when $x_{\min} \notin \mathcal{S}$. Mirror symmetry handles $x_{\max}$. □

Proof of Lemma 2.4. Write $R_j := \mathrm{right}_T(v_j)$ for $0 \le j \le k$, set $T^{(0)} := R_0$, and define recursively $T^{(j)} := v_{2j-1}(T^{(j-1)}, v_{2j}(R_{2j-1}, R_{2j}))$ for $1 \le j \le r$. During $\mathrm{Splay}(v_0)$, the j-th bottom-up zig-zig step ($[v_{2j-1}, v_{2j}]$ followed by $[v_0, v_{2j-1}]$) transforms $v_{2j}(v_{2j-1}(v_0(\emptyset, T^{(j-1)}), R_{2j-1}), R_{2j})$ into $v_0(\emptyset, T^{(j)})$:

$$v_0 < \underbrace{v_1 < v_2}_{\text{pair 1}} < \underbrace{v_3 < v_4}_{\text{pair 2}} < \cdots < \underbrace{v_{2r-1} < v_{2r}}_{\text{pair } r} (< v_{2r+1}) \longmapsto \begin{cases} T^{(r)} & \text{if } k = 2r, \\ v_{2r+1}(T^{(r)}, R_{2r+1}) & \text{if } k = 2r+1 \end{cases}$$

after the final zig $[v_0, v_{2r+1}]$ (when $k = 2r + 1$) and deletion of v_0. Conversely, splicing out v_0 leaves $T^{(0)} = R_0$ below v_1, and executing the vertex-disjoint right single rotations $[v_1, v_2], \ldots, [v_{2r-1}, v_{2r}]$ from $j = 1$ to r inductively builds the identical subtrees $T^{(1)}, \ldots, T^{(r)}$, yielding $T^{(r)}$ when $k = 2r$ and $v_{2r+1}(T^{(r)}, R_{2r+1})$ when $k = 2r + 1$. Mirror symmetry proves the statement for Eject. □

Proof of Lemma 2.7. (1) Induct lexicographically on $(|V(T)|, |V(T)| - |\mathrm{RS}(T)|)$ for $T = H_{\mathrm{init}}$. If $T = \emptyset$, 0 steps suffice. If $T = u(\emptyset, B)$, construct B ($|\mathrm{RS}(B)| = |\mathrm{RS}(T)| - 1$) and execute Push($u$). If $T = u(a(A_L, A_R), B)$, construct the n_0-node BST $T' := a(A_L, u(A_R, B))$ (which has $|\mathrm{RS}(T')| = |\mathrm{RS}(T)| + 1$) using n_0 Pushes and $n_0 - |\mathrm{RS}(T')|$ root right-spine left rotations, and execute one root right-spine left rotation $[u, a]$ on $\mathrm{RS}(T')$ to obtain T.

(2) Under the order-preserving relabeling $V_L \cong \{1, \ldots, P\}$, let $z_1, \ldots, z_s \in \{1, \ldots, P\}$ be the keys inserted into U_t by Inject steps during S, in chronological Inject order. For any key $u \in \{1, \ldots, P\}$ already present in U_0 or inserted into U before $\mathrm{Inject}(z_q)$ at step t_q, either u was already deleted by Pop before step t_q (hence before $\mathrm{Pop}(z_q)$, giving $u < z_q$) or $u \in V(T_{t_q-1})$ when $\mathrm{Inject}(z_q)$ inserted $z_q > \max V(T_{t_q-1}) \ge u$; thus $\max V(U_0) < z_1 < \cdots < z_s$, and every $\mathrm{Push}(y)$ into V_L at step t satisfies $y < \min V(U_{t-1})$ and $y < z_q$ for all z_q inserted at steps $t_q > t$.

Form the pure right-spine chain $\mathrm{Tail}_0 := z_1(\emptyset, z_2(\emptyset, \ldots, z_s(\emptyset, \emptyset)))$, build $H_0^{\mathrm{sim}} := U_0 \oplus_R \mathrm{Tail}_0$ from $\emptyset$ via (1), and maintain $H_t^{\mathrm{sim}} = U_t \oplus_R \mathrm{Tail}_t$ across $t = 1, \ldots, m$ (where Tail_t holds the not-yet-injected z_q's):

- Steps of S that leave U_t unchanged execute 0 steps.
- $\textsc{Push}(y)$ into V_L satisfies $y < \min V(U_{t-1} \oplus_R \mathrm{Tail}_{t-1})$ and executes $\textsc{Push}(y)$, giving $y(\emptyset, U_{t-1} \oplus_R \mathrm{Tail}_{t-1}) = U_t \oplus_R \mathrm{Tail}_t$.
- Each $\textsc{Eject}$-induced left rotation $[b_{d+1}, b_d]$ on $\mathrm{RS}(U_{t-1})$ $(1 \le d \le |\mathrm{RS}(U_{t-1})| - 1)$ acts on a prefix of $\mathrm{RS}(U_{t-1} \oplus_R \mathrm{Tail}_{t-1})$, preserving $\oplus_R \mathrm{Tail}_{t-1}$.
- $\textsc{Inject}(z_q)$ into V_L finds $\mathrm{Tail}_{t-1} = z_q(\emptyset, \mathrm{Tail}_t)$ at depth $\beta := |\mathrm{RS}(U_{t-1})| \ge 0$ below $\mathrm{RS}(U_{t-1}) = (b_1 < \cdots < b_\beta)$; the β right-spine left rotations $[z_q, b_\beta], \ldots, [z_q, b_1]$ bubble z_q to the root while keeping $\mathrm{right}(z_q) = \mathrm{Tail}_t$, yielding $z_q(U_{t-1}, \mathrm{Tail}_t) = z_q(U_{t-1}, \emptyset) \oplus_R \mathrm{Tail}_t = U_t \oplus_R \mathrm{Tail}_t$.
- $\textsc{Pop}(s)$ occurs with $U_{t-1} \neq \emptyset$, where $\mathrm{LS}(U_{t-1} \oplus_R \mathrm{Tail}_{t-1}) = \mathrm{LS}(U_{t-1})$ because Tail_{t-1} hangs off the rightmost vertex of $\mathrm{RS}(U_{t-1})$; executing $\textsc{Pop}(s)$ on $U_{t-1} \oplus_R \mathrm{Tail}_{t-1}$ performs the exact same $\lfloor (|\mathrm{LS}(U_{t-1})| - 1)/2 \rfloor$ cascade right rotations as on U_{t-1} and yields $U_t \oplus_R \mathrm{Tail}_t$.

At $t = m$, $U_m = \mathrm{Tail}_m = \emptyset$ so $H_m^{\mathrm{sim}} = \emptyset$. Thus $H_L := H^{\mathrm{sim}}$ is an emptying one-sided $\textsc{Pop}$ execution of size $P = d_L$ starting from $\emptyset$ with $C_{\textsc{Pop}}(H_L) = C_{\textsc{Pop}}(U)$, and (2) gives $K_L \le 2P - 2 < 2P$. □

Verification of the spine-folding bijection and (3). Let $(\widetilde{H}_\tau, b_1(\tau))$ be the spine-folded pair of H_τ defined in Section 2.4, with $\mathrm{RS}(H_{\tau^-}) = (b_1 < b_2 < \cdots < b_\beta)$ $(\beta \ge 1)$ and $L_i = \mathrm{left}_{H_{\tau^-}}(b_i)$ $(1 \le i \le \beta)$ whenever $H_{\tau^-} \neq \emptyset$. Checking the four step types of H:

- $\textsc{Push}(w)$: if $H_{\tau^-} = \emptyset$, $H_{\tau^+} = w(\emptyset, \emptyset)$ gives $\widetilde{H}_{\tau^+} = w(\emptyset, \emptyset)$ and $b_1(\tau^+) = w$; if $H_{\tau^-} \neq \emptyset$, $\mathrm{RS}(H_{\tau^+}) = (w < b_1 < \cdots < b_\beta)$ has left subtrees $\emptyset, L_1, \ldots, L_\beta$, replacing $\mathrm{left}_{\widetilde{H}}(b_1)$ with $w(\emptyset, L_1)$ and setting $b_1(\tau^+) := w$, matching Definition 2.1(1).
- Root right-spine left rotation $[b_2, b_1]$ $(d = 1,\ \beta \ge 2)$: replaces $b_1(L_1, b_2(L_2, R_2))$ in H_{τ^-} with $b_2(b_1(L_1, L_2), R_2)$, giving $\mathrm{RS}(H_{\tau^+}) = (b_2 < \cdots < b_\beta)$ with new first left subtree $b_1(L_1, L_2) = \widetilde{H}_{\tau^-, b_1}$; hence $\widetilde{H}_{\tau^+} = \widetilde{H}_{\tau^-}$ is unchanged and $b_1(\tau^+) = b_2$ (the parent of $b_1(\tau^-)$ on $\mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H}_{\tau^-})$), which is a $\textsc{Shift}$ step of Definition 2.1(2).
- Deeper right-spine left rotation $[b_{d+1}, b_d]$ $(2 \le d \le \beta - 1)$: replaces $b_d(L_d, b_{d+1}(L_{d+1}, R_{d+1}))$ in H_{τ^-} with $b_{d+1}(b_d(L_d, L_{d+1}), R_{d+1})$, so $\mathrm{RS}(H_{\tau^+}) = (b_1 < \cdots < b_{d-1} < b_{d+1} < \cdots < b_\beta)$ keeps $b_1(\tau^+) = b_1(\tau^-)$ while changing $\mathrm{left}_{\widetilde{H}}(b_{d+1})$ from $b_d(b_{d-1}(A, L_d), L_{d+1})$ to $b_{d-1}(A, b_d(L_d, L_{d+1}))$. This is the upper-spine right single rotation $[b_{d-1}, b_d]$ strictly below $b_{d+1} \le b_\beta = \mathrm{root}(\widetilde{H})$ with $b_1 \le b_{d-1} < b_d < \mathrm{root}(\widetilde{H})$, i.e., an $\textsc{UpperRot}$ step of Definition 2.1(3), with $K_L = K_{\textsc{Shift}} + K_{\mathrm{rot}} < 2P$ by (2).
- $\textsc{Pop}(s)$ $(s = \min V_{s^-})$: $\mathrm{LS}(H_{s^-}) = (v_0 < v_1 < \cdots < v_k)$ from $v_0 = s$ to $v_k = \mathrm{root}(H_{s^-}) = b_1(s^-)$ $(k \ge 0)$ coincides with the subpath of $\mathrm{LS}(\widetilde{H}_{s^-})$ from s to $b_1(s^-)$; set $h := \max(0, \lfloor (k-1)/2 \rfloor)$, noting $\lfloor k/2 \rfloor \le 1 + h$ for all $k \ge 0$. If $k = 0$, $s = b_1(s^-)$ has $L_1 = \emptyset$ and splicing out s in H_{s^-} leaves $\emptyset$ (if $\beta = 1$) or $\mathrm{RS}(H_{s^+}) = (b_2 < \cdots < b_\beta)$ with first left subtree L_2 (if $\beta \ge 2$), which in $\widetilde{H}_{s^-}$ splices out $s(\emptyset, L_2)$ (or $s(\emptyset, \emptyset)$) with 0 rotations and updates $b_1(s^+) := b_2$ when $V_{s^+} \neq \emptyset$. If $k = 2h + 1 \ge 1$ is odd $(\lfloor k/2 \rfloor = h)$, splicing out v_0 and rotating $[v_1, v_2], \ldots, [v_{2h-1}, v_{2h}]$ acts strictly inside $L_1 = \mathrm{left}_{H_{s^-}}(b_1) = \mathrm{left}_{\widetilde{H}_{s^-}}(v_{2h+1})$, keeping $b_1(s^+) = b_1(s^-)$. If $k = 2h + 2 \ge 2$ is even $(\lfloor k/2 \rfloor = h+1)$, the first h right rotations turn L_1 into $v_{2h+1}(T^{(h)}, R_{2h+1})$ and the $(h+1)$-st right rotation $[v_{2h+1}, b_1]$ in H_{s^-} yields $\mathrm{RS}(H_{s^+}) = (v_{2h+1} < b_1 < b_2 < \cdots < b_\beta)$ with left subtrees $T^{(h)}, R_{2h+1}, L_2, \ldots, L_\beta$, whose folded tree $\widetilde{H}_{s^+}$ keeps $\mathrm{left}_{\widetilde{H}}(b_1) = v_{2h+1}(T^{(h)}, R_{2h+1})$ (performing only the h right rotations $[v_1, v_2], \ldots, [v_{2h-1}, v_{2h}]$ strictly below v_{2h+1} and suppressing $[v_{2h+1}, b_1]$) and updates $b_1(s^+) := v_{2h+1}$, matching Definition 2.1(4).

Summing $\lfloor k/2 \rfloor \le 1 + h$ across all P Pop steps shows that $\widetilde{H}$ is a valid folded Pop process of size P satisfying $C_{\text{Pop}}(H) \le P + J(\widetilde{H})$, establishing (3). □

C Deferred Proofs for Bounded-Gap Cascades (Section 3)

This appendix gives the full general-D proof of Lemma 3.3 ($D \ge 1$), the proof of Lemma 3.4, and the complete recursive block-contraction proof of Theorem 3.1.

Proof of Lemma 3.3 for general $D \ge 1$. (1) Since $\text{pre}_{B|_{C_q}}$ bijects C_q onto $\{1, \dots, |C_q|\}$, $|\mathcal{G}(B)| = \sum_{q=1}^{K} \min(D, |C_q|) \le DK$. Within each C_q, every ancestor of $w \in C_q$ in $B|_{C_q}$ precedes w in preorder of $B|_{C_q}$, so $\mathcal{G}(B) \cap C_q$ is ancestor-closed in $B|_{C_q}$ and (whenever $C_q \ne \emptyset$) contains $\text{root}(B|_{C_q})$. Given $g_1 < g_2$ in $\mathcal{G}(B)$ ($g_1 \in C_{q_1}$, $g_2 \in C_{q_2}$ with $q_1 \le q_2$), let $w := \text{LCA}_B(g_1, g_2) \in C_{q^*}$ ($q_1 \le q^* \le q_2$). If $q_1 < q^* < q_2$, then $g_1 < \min C_{q^*} \le w \le \max C_{q^*} < g_2$ with $g_1, g_2 \in V(B_w)$ prevents w from lying in $\text{left}_B(a)$ or $\text{right}_B(a)$ for any $a \in C_{q^*}$, forcing $w = \text{root}(B|_{C_{q^*}}) \in \mathcal{G}(B)$; if $q^* \in \{q_1, q_2\}$, then w is an ancestor of g_1 or g_2 in $B|_{C_{q^*}}$, so ancestor-closure gives $w \in \mathcal{G}(B)$.

(2) If $u \in C_{q_1}$ and $v \in C_{q_2}$ with $q_1 < q_2$, then $\{u, v\} \not\subseteq C_q$ for every $1 \le q \le K$, so Lemma 2.3(1) gives $B'|_{C_q} = B|_{C_q}$ for all q; hence $\mathcal{G}(B') = \mathcal{G}(B)$, and applying Lemma 2.3(1) with $\mathcal{S} = \mathcal{G}(B)$ proves the inter-block statement.

Now suppose $u, v \in C_q$ ($u = \text{left}_B(v)$), writing $B_v = v(u(\widehat{A}, \widehat{M}), \widehat{R})$ and $B'_u = u(\widehat{A}, v(\widehat{M}, \widehat{R}))$ in B, with $A := \widehat{A}|_{C_q}$, $M := \widehat{M}|_{C_q} = \widehat{M}$ (since $u < V(\widehat{M}) < v$ and $u, v \in C_q$), and $R := \widehat{R}|_{C_q}$. For $q' \ne q$ we have $B'|_{C_{q'}} = B|_{C_{q'}}$, while in $B|_{C_q}$ ($p_0 := \text{pre}_{B|_{C_q}}(v)$) the contiguous preorder segment (v, u, pre(A), pre(M), pre(R)) starting at rank p_0 becomes (u, pre(A), v, pre(M), pre(R)) in $B'|_{C_q}$:

- $p_0 > D$ *or* $p_0 + |V(A)| + 1 \le D$*:* Membership in $\{1, \dots, D\}$ is unchanged on $\{u, v\} \cup V(A)$, so $\mathcal{G}(B') = \mathcal{G}(B)$, and Lemma 2.3(1) gives $G(B') = G(B)$ (when $p_0 > D$) or the right rotation $[u, v]$ on $G(B)$ (when $p_0 + |V(A)| + 1 \le D$).

- $p_0 = D$*:* Here $\mathcal{G}(B') = (\mathcal{G}(B) \setminus \{v\}) \cup \{u\}$, while $V(A) \cup V(M) \cup V(R)$ has preorder ranks $> D$ in both $B|_{C_q}$ and $B'|_{C_q}$. Setting $G_A := \widehat{A}|_{\mathcal{G}(B)} = \widehat{A}|_{\mathcal{G}(B')}$ and $G_R := \widehat{R}|_{\mathcal{G}(B)} = \widehat{R}|_{\mathcal{G}(B')}$ (with $V(\widehat{M}) \cap \mathcal{G}(B) = \emptyset$), we have $B_v|_{\mathcal{G}(B)} = v(G_A, G_R)$ and $B'_u|_{\mathcal{G}(B')} = u(G_A, G_R)$ at the identical in-order rank, so $G(B') = G(B)$ on $\{1, \dots, |\mathcal{G}(B)|\}$.

- $1 \le p_0 < D < p_0 + |V(A)| + 1$*:* Write $\mathcal{G}_{\text{old}} := \mathcal{G}(B)$ and $\mathcal{G}_{\text{new}} := \mathcal{G}(B')$. Here v shifts from $p_0 \le D - 1$ to $p_0 + |V(A)| + 1 > D$, u shifts from $p_0 + 1 \le D$ to $p_0 < D$, and the unique vertex $x' \in V(A) \subseteq C_q$ ($x' < u < v$) with $\text{pre}_{B|_{C_q}}(x') = D + 1$ shifts to $\text{pre}_{B'|_{C_q}}(x') = D$, so $\mathcal{G}_{\text{new}} = (\mathcal{G}_{\text{old}} \setminus \{v\}) \cup \{x'\}$. Let $z_1 < \cdots < z_s < v$ ($s \ge 1$, $z_s = u$) be the elements of $\mathcal{G}_{\text{old}} \cap [x', v]$ ($\subseteq C_q$), occupying contiguous in-order ranks $r_0, \dots, r_0 + s$ in $\mathcal{G}_{\text{old}}$, whereas $x' < z_1 < \cdots < z_s$ occupy ranks $r_0, \dots, r_0 + s$ in $\mathcal{G}_{\text{new}}$ (and all ranks outside $[r_0, r_0 + s]$ correspond to the identical keys in $\mathcal{G}_{\text{old}}$ and $\mathcal{G}_{\text{new}}$). Check $R_{G_{\text{old}}}(j) \le R_{G_{\text{new}}}(j)$ for every $j \in \{1, \dots, |\mathcal{G}_{\text{old}}|\}$:

  (i) $r_0 \le j \le r_0 + s - 1$ *($z_t \in \mathcal{G}_{\text{old}} \cap (x', u]$ at rank $j = r_0 + t - 1$):* Since $z_t \in V(B_u) = V(\text{left}_B(v))$, every key in $V(\text{right}_B(z_t))$ lies in $(z_t, v) \subset C_q$, so $\text{right}_B(z_t) = \text{right}_{B|_{C_q}}(z_t)$. In $B|_{C_q}$, $x' < z_t$ and $\text{pre}_{B|_{C_q}}(z_t) \le D < D + 1 = \text{pre}_{B|_{C_q}}(x')$ force $x' \in V(\text{left}_{B|_{C_q}}(z_t))$ (otherwise $\text{LCA}_{B|_{C_q}}(x', z_t)$ would visit x' in its left subtree before visiting z_t in its right subtree), so every vertex of $\text{right}_{B|_{C_q}}(z_t)$ follows x' in preorder and has rank $> D + 1$. Thus $V(\text{right}_B(z_t)) \cap \mathcal{G}_{\text{old}} = \emptyset$, giving $R_{G_{\text{old}}}(j) = j \le R_{G_{\text{new}}}(j)$.

(ii) $j = r_0 + s$ *(v in G_{old}, u in G_{new}):* Inside C_q, $V(M) \cup V(R)$ follows x' in preorder (disjoint from $\mathcal{G}_{\text{old}} \cup \mathcal{G}_{\text{new}}$), while $V(B_v) = V(B'_u)$ agrees on all keys $> v$; hence $R_{G_{\text{old}}}(r_0 + s) = R_{G_{\text{new}}}(r_0+s)$ (equal to r_0+s if $V(\widehat{R}) \cap \mathcal{G}_{\text{old}} = \emptyset$, and to the common rank of $\max(V(\widehat{R}) \cap \mathcal{G}_{\text{old}})$ otherwise).

(iii) $j > r_0 + s$ *($w > v$ at rank j):* $V(B'_w) = V(B_w)$ and all keys in $\{w\} \cup V(\text{right}_B(w))$ exceed v, where $\mathcal{G}_{\text{old}}$ and $\mathcal{G}_{\text{new}}$ and their ranks agree, giving $R_{G_{\text{old}}}(j) = R_{G_{\text{new}}}(j)$.

(iv) $j < r_0$ *($w < x'$ at rank j):* $w \notin \{u, v\}$ implies $V(B'_w) = V(B_w)$. Let $m_{\text{old}} := \max(V(B_w) \cap \mathcal{G}_{\text{old}})$ (at rank $R_{G_{\text{old}}}(j)$ in $\mathcal{G}_{\text{old}}$). If $m_{\text{old}} \neq v$, then $m_{\text{old}} \in V(B'_w) \cap \mathcal{G}_{\text{new}}$ has rank in $\mathcal{G}_{\text{new}}$ equal to $R_{G_{\text{old}}}(j)$ (if $m_{\text{old}} < x'$ or $m_{\text{old}} > v$) or $R_{G_{\text{old}}}(j) + 1$ (if $m_{\text{old}} \in \{z_1, \ldots, z_s\}$); if $m_{\text{old}} = v$, then $w < v$ and $v \in V(B_w)$ imply $u = \text{left}_B(v) \in V(B_w) = V(B'_w)$ with rank $r_0 + s = R_{G_{\text{old}}}(j)$ in $\mathcal{G}_{\text{new}}$. In all subcases, $R_{G_{\text{old}}}(j) \leq R_{G_{\text{new}}}(j)$.

Proposition 3.2 therefore yields a sequence of right single rotations from $G(B)$ to $G(B')$. □

Proof of Lemma 3.4. (1) Every left-child ancestor a of v in T satisfies $a > v$, so $\text{ld}_T(v) \leq |\{a \in V(T) : a > v\}|$ and $\Phi_{\text{ld}}(T) \leq \binom{|V(T)|}{2}$. As noted in Section 2.2, right-rotating $[u, v]$ decreases $\text{ld}(u)$ by 1, decreases ld by 1 on $V(\text{left}_T(u))$, and leaves all other ld values unchanged, giving $\Delta\Phi_{\text{ld}}(T) \leq -1$; executing k vertex-disjoint right single rotations sequentially drops $\Phi_{\text{ld}}(T)$ by at least k.

(2) By Lemma 2.3(1), any right single rotation on B either leaves $B|_{C_q}$ unchanged or performs a right single rotation on $B|_{C_q}$, which can increase neither $|\text{LS}(B|_{C_q})|$ nor $\text{ld}_{B|_{C_q}}(v)$, so $\Delta\Psi_{C_q}(B) \leq 0$. Now consider a Δ'-gapped right k-cascade $[x_1, y_1], \ldots, [x_k, y_k]$ ($q_{\min} < q_{\max}$) along left-child subpath Π with an intra-block edge:

- If $[x_r, y_r] \subseteq C_q$ for some $q > q_{\min}$, then $x_1 \in C_{q_{\min}}$ lies in $V(\text{left}_B(y_r))$ with $x_1 < \min C_q$, so y_r cannot lie in $\text{right}_B(a)$ for any $a \in C_q$ (which would force $x_1 > a \geq \min C_q$). Thus $y_r \in \text{LS}(B|_{C_q})$, and rotating $[x_r, y_r]$ decreases $|\text{LS}(B|_{C_q})|$ by 1, giving $\Delta\Psi_{C_q}(B) \leq -1$.
- Otherwise every intra-block edge lies in $C := C_{q_{\min}}$. Let $r^* \in \{1, \ldots, k-1\}$ be largest with $x_{r^*}, y_{r^*} \in C$ ($r^* < k$ since $y_k \in C_{q_{\max}} > \max C$), so $y_{r^*+1} > \max C$. Walking up Π from $x_{r^*} \in C$ through y_{r^*}, at most Δ' gap vertices, and x_{r^*+1} to $y_{r^*+1} > \max C$, keys strictly increase, so the last vertex $z^* \in C$ along this segment ($y_{r^*} \leq z^* \leq x_{r^*+1}$) has parent $p^* > \max C$ ($z^* = \text{left}_B(p^*)$) and lies $d_0 \in \{1, \ldots, \Delta' + 2\} = \{1, \ldots, D\}$ left-child steps above x_{r^*}. Every proper ancestor $a \in C$ of z^* in B satisfies $a \leq \max C < p^*$ and therefore contains p^* (and z^*) in $\text{right}_B(a)$, giving $\text{ld}_{B|_C}(z^*) = 0$ and $\text{ld}_{B|_C}(x_{r^*}) = d_0 \in [1, D]$. Right-rotating $[x_{r^*}, y_{r^*}]$ decreases $\text{ld}_{B|_C}(x_{r^*})$ to $d_0 - 1 \leq D - 1$, dropping $\min(\text{ld}_{B|_C}(x_{r^*}), D)$ by 1 and giving $\Delta\Psi_C(B) \leq -1$. □

Proof of Theorem 3.1. Set $D := \Delta' + 2 \geq 2$.

Step 1: General-N bisection bound at $i = 1$. We first show that for *every* integer $N \geq 1$,

$$C_2^{\Delta'}(N) \;\leq\; \Big(\lceil \log_2 \lceil N/D \rceil \rceil + 1\Big)(D+1)\,N \tag{8}$$

(while for $1 \leq N \leq A_1(1) = 2$, a 2-cascade requires 4 distinct vertices, so $C_2^{\Delta'}(N) = 0$ trivially). Set $L := \lceil \log_2 \lceil N/D \rceil \rceil \geq 0$, and form nested contiguous-interval partitions $\mathcal{Q}_0, \ldots, \mathcal{Q}_L$ from $\mathcal{Q}_0 := \{\{1, \ldots, N\}\}$ by bisecting each block $C \in \mathcal{Q}_{t-1}$ ($1 \leq t \leq L$) into $C = C_L \sqcup C_R$ of sizes $\lfloor |C|/2 \rfloor$ and $\lceil |C|/2 \rceil$ (omitting empty halves), so every leaf block $Q \in \mathcal{Q}_L$ satisfies $|Q| \leq \lceil N/2^L \rceil \leq D$. Every Δ'-gapped 2-cascade $[x_1, y_1], [x_2, y_2]$ ($x_1 < y_1 < x_2 < y_2$) with $x_1, y_2 \in Q \in \mathcal{Q}_L$ drops $\sum_{Q \in \mathcal{Q}_L} \Phi_{\text{ld}}(B|_Q)$ by at least 2 via Lemma 3.4(1), occurring at most $\frac{1}{2} \sum_{Q \in \mathcal{Q}_L} \binom{|Q|}{2} \leq \frac{D-1}{4} N < (D+1)N$ times.

Every non-leaf 2-cascade ($L \geq 1$) has a unique level $t \in \{1, \ldots, L\}$ where some $C \in \mathcal{Q}_{t-1}$ splits into $C_L < C_R$ in $\mathcal{Q}_t$ with $x_1 \in C_L$ and $y_2 \in C_R$; since $y_1 < x_2$, either $x_1 < y_1 \in C_L$ or $y_1 < x_2 < y_2 \in C_R$, so at least one of $[x_1, y_1], [x_2, y_2]$ is intra-block in $\mathcal{Q}_t$, dropping $\sum_{C' \in \mathcal{Q}_t} \Psi_{C'}(B) \in [0, (D+1)N]$ by at least 1 via Lemma 3.4(2) ($\leq L(D+1)N$ across all L levels) and proving (8).

Step 2: Pure-integer threshold sequence $\mu_i(j)$ for $i \geq 2$. For integers $i \geq 2$ and $j \geq 1$, define $\mu_i(j)$ recursively by $\mu_2(1) := 48$, $\mu_2(j) := 2^{\mu_2(j-1)/4}\, \mu_2(j-1)$ $(j \geq 2)$, and for $i \geq 3$:

$$\mu_i(1) \;:=\; 12\, \mu_{i-1}(2), \qquad \mu_i(j) \;:=\; \mu_{i-1}(\mu_i(j-1)/12)\, \mu_i(j-1) \quad (j \geq 2),$$

and set $M_i^{(D)}(j) := D\, \mu_i(j)$. By induction on (i, j) $(i \geq 2, j \geq 1)$, $\mu_i(j)$ is a positive integer divisible by 12 (and strictly increasing in j) satisfying $\mu_i(j) \geq 12\, A_i(j) \geq 48$: at $(2, 1)$, $\mu_2(1) = 48 = 12\, A_2(1)$; at $(2, j)$ $(j \geq 2)$, $12 \mid \mu_2(j-1)$ makes $\mu_2(j-1)/4 \geq 3A_2(j-1) > A_2(j-1)$ a positive integer, so $12 \mid \mu_2(j)$ and $\mu_2(j) > 2^{A_2(j-1)} \cdot 12A_2(j-1) > 12\, A_2(j)$; at $(i, 1)$ $(i \geq 3)$, $12 \mid \mu_i(1)$ and $\mu_i(1) \geq 144\, A_{i-1}(2) = 144\, A_i(1) > 12\, A_i(1)$; and at (i, j) $(i \geq 3, j \geq 2)$, $12 \mid \mu_i(j-1)$ makes $J := \mu_i(j-1)/12 \geq A_i(j-1) \geq 4$ a positive integer, so $12 \mid \mu_i(j)$ and $\mu_i(j) \geq \mu_{i-1}(A_i(j-1)) \cdot 12A_i(j-1) > 12\, A_{i-1}(A_i(j-1)) = 12\, A_i(j)$.

Step 3: Inductive bound $C_{2i}^{\Delta'}(M_i^{(D)}(j)) \leq 3(D+1)\, j\, M_i^{(D)}(j)$. We prove this inequality for all $i \geq 2$ and $j \geq 1$ by induction on (i, j). Partition $\{1, \ldots, N\}$ ($N := M_i^{(D)}(j) = K \cdot M_{\mathrm{blk}}$) into K equal contiguous blocks $C_1 < \cdots < C_K$ of size $|C_q| = M_{\mathrm{blk}}$, setting: $(K, M_{\mathrm{blk}}) := (6, 8D)$ for $i = 2, j = 1$; $(K, M_{\mathrm{blk}}) := (2^{\mu_2(j-1)/4},\, M_2^{(D)}(j-1))$ for $i = 2, j \geq 2$; $(K, M_{\mathrm{blk}}) := (\mu_{i-1}(2),\, 12D)$ for $i \geq 3, j = 1$; and $(K, M_{\mathrm{blk}}) := (\mu_{i-1}(J),\, M_i^{(D)}(j-1))$ with $J := \mu_i(j-1)/12$ for $i \geq 3, j \geq 2$. Since $M_{\mathrm{blk}} \geq 8D > D$ in every case, the preorder-D summary BST $G(B) = B|_{\mathcal{G}(B)}$ of Lemma 3.3 has static size $|\mathcal{G}(B)| = DK$. Classify each Δ'-gapped right $(2i)$-cascade $[x_1, y_1], \ldots, [x_{2i}, y_{2i}]$ on B ($x_1 \in C_{q_{\min}}, y_{2i} \in C_{q_{\max}}$) into three types:

- *Type A ($q_{\min} = q_{\max} = q$):* The entire $(2i)$-cascade lies in C_q and projects via Lemma 2.3(1) onto $B|_{C_q}$. When $j = 1$, Lemma 3.4(1) drops $\sum_{q=1}^{K} \Phi_{\mathrm{ld}}(B|_{C_q})$ by at least $2i$, bounding Type A by $\frac{K}{4}\binom{8D}{2} < 8D^2K = DN < (D+1)N$ at $i = 2$ and by $\frac{K}{2i}\binom{12D}{2} \leq \frac{K}{6}\binom{12D}{2} < 12D^2K = DN < (D+1)N$ at $i \geq 3$. When $j \geq 2$, the $(i, j-1)$ hypothesis on each $B|_{C_q}$ ($|C_q| = M_i^{(D)}(j-1)$) bounds Type A by $K \cdot 3(D+1)(j-1)M_i^{(D)}(j-1) = 3(D+1)(j-1)N$.

- *Type B ($q_{\min} < q_{\max}$, with at least one intra-block edge):* Lemma 3.4(2) drops $\sum_{q=1}^{K} \Psi_{C_q}(B)$ by at least 1, bounding Type B by $(D+1)N$.

- *Type C ($q_{\min} < q_{\max}$, with every edge inter-block: $x_r \in C_{a_r}, y_r \in C_{b_r}$ and $a_r < b_r$ for all $1 \leq r \leq 2i$):* Fix any $r \in \{2, \ldots, 2i-1\}$. First, $a_1 < b_1 \leq a_r < b_r$ gives $x_1 < \min C_{a_r} \leq x_r \leq \max C_{a_r} < y_r$: since $x_r = \mathrm{left}_B(y_r)$ with $y_r > \max C_{a_r}$ and $x_1 \in V(\mathrm{left}_B(x_r))$ with $x_1 < \min C_{a_r}$, x_r has no proper ancestor in C_{a_r}, so $x_r = \mathrm{root}(B|_{C_{a_r}}) \in \mathcal{G}(B)$. Second, $b_r \leq a_{r+1} < b_{r+1}$ gives $y_{r+1} > \max C_{b_r}$ while $x_1 < \min C_{b_r}$: along the left-child subpath from $y_r \in C_{b_r}$ up to $y_{r+1} > \max C_{b_r}$, the highest vertex $z_r \in C_{b_r}$ ($y_r \leq z_r \leq x_{r+1}$) has parent $p_r > \max C_{b_r}$ and descendant $x_1 < \min C_{b_r}$, forcing $z_r = \mathrm{root}(B|_{C_{b_r}})$ ($\mathrm{pre}_{B|_{C_{b_r}}}(z_r) = 1$); walking at most $\Delta' + 1$ left-child pointers in $B|_{C_{b_r}}$ down from z_r to y_r increments preorder rank by 1 per step, giving $\mathrm{pre}_{B|_{C_{b_r}}}(y_r) \leq \Delta' + 2 = D$ and $y_r \in \mathcal{G}(B)$. Finally, any left-subpath vertex $z \notin \mathcal{G}(B)$ between x_2 and y_{2i-1} satisfies $x_2 \in V(\mathrm{left}_B(z)) \cap \mathcal{G}(B)$, so $V(\mathrm{right}_B(z)) \cap \mathcal{G}(B) = \emptyset$ and z contracts out of $G(B)$ while preserving the left-child subpath and keeping each inter-pair

gap at most Δ'. Executing the commuting inter-block batch $[x_2, y_2], \ldots, [x_{2i-1}, y_{2i-1}]$ before $[x_1, y_1], [x_{2i}, y_{2i}]$ therefore executes a Δ'-gapped right $(2i-2)$-cascade on $G(B)$ ($|\mathcal{G}(B)| = DK$) by Lemma 3.3(2), bounding Type C by $C^{\Delta'}_{2i-2}(DK)$:

(i) $i = 2, j = 1$ ($DK = 6D$): (8) gives $C^{\Delta'}_2(6D) \le (\lceil \log_2 6 \rceil + 1)(D+1)(6D) = 24D(D+1) = \frac{1}{2}(D+1)N$.

(ii) $i = 2, j \ge 2$ ($K = 2^{\mu_2(j-1)/4}$, $\mu_2(j-1) \ge 48$): (8) gives $C^{\Delta'}_2(DK) \le (\frac{1}{4}\mu_2(j-1)+1)(D+1)DK < \mu_2(j-1)DK(D+1) = (D+1)N$.

(iii) $i \ge 3, j = 1$ ($DK = D\,\mu_{i-1}(2) = M^{(D)}_{i-1}(2)$): induction at $(i-1, 2)$ yields $C^{\Delta'}_{2i-2}(M^{(D)}_{i-1}(2)) \le 6(D+1)D\,\mu_{i-1}(2) = \frac{1}{2}(D+1)N$.

(iv) $i \ge 3, j \ge 2$ ($DK = D\,\mu_{i-1}(J) = M^{(D)}_{i-1}(J)$ with $J = \mu_i(j-1)/12$): the $(i-1, J)$ hypothesis gives $C^{\Delta'}_{2i-2}(M^{(D)}_{i-1}(J)) \le 3(D+1)\frac{\mu_i(j-1)}{12}DK = \frac{1}{4}(D+1)N$.

In all four cases, summing Types A, B, and C gives at most $(3j - \frac{1}{2})(D+1)N < 3(D+1)\,j\,N$, completing the induction.

Step 4: Deduction for $1 \le N \le A_i(1)$. At $i = 1$, $1 \le N \le A_1(1) = 2$ has $C^{\Delta'}_2(N) = 0$. For $i \ge 2$ and $1 \le N \le A_i(1)$, set $M := M^{(D)}_i(1) = D\,\mu_i(1) \ge 12D\,A_i(1) \ge 24N > N$. Chaining $q := \lfloor M/N \rfloor$ disjoint copies of an N-node BST on $(0, N], (N, 2N], \ldots, ((q-1)N, qN]$ (plus $M - qN$ static nodes on $(qN, M]$) along a right spine via $\oplus_R$ [Sun92, Section 2.1, Lemma 1(c)] shows that $q\,C^{\Delta'}_{2i}(N) \le C^{\Delta'}_{2i}(M)$: right-spine edges connecting consecutive copies are right-child pointers, so they never enter any left-child subpath and are untouched by right rotations inside each copy, preserving pure right rotations and Δ'-gaps inside every copy. Since $M/N \ge 24 > 2$ implies $\lfloor M/N \rfloor > M/(2N)$ and $\Delta' + 3 \le 3(\Delta' + 1)$ for all $\Delta' \ge 0$, Step 3 at $j = 1$ yields

$$C^{\Delta'}_{2i}(N) \;\le\; \frac{C^{\Delta'}_{2i}(M)}{\lfloor M/N \rfloor} \;<\; \frac{3(D+1)\,M}{M/(2N)} \;=\; 6(\Delta'+3)\,N \;\le\; 18(\Delta'+1)\,N,$$

proving Theorem 3.1 with $C_{\text{casc}} := 18$. □

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